

National Aluminium Co. Ltd. (NATIONALUM)

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(Finance) In-Charge, Mr. Srimanta Panda. Myself, Bharat Sahu, the Company Secretary of NALCO. I would appreciate if you could kindly introduce yourself before we proceed with the formal meeting.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. A very good afternoon to all of you. Thank you so much for having us today. I am the lead analyst at YES Securities, looking after the metals and mining sector. We wanted to formally introduce ourselves in order to build a relationship and get a chance to know more about the company, its business operations, and future plans. We are looking forward to stay connected with you as we develop our partnership.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Thank you, Manav, and thanks to the NALCO management for this opportunity, as well as to Chintan, who facilitated this meeting. At the outset, I would like to congratulate the entire management team for their recent outstanding performance at the company level. We have observed very positive results and are truly appreciative. As a significant investor in your company, we generally pursue long-term value. Our senior partner, Shri Hitesh Doshi, runs this family-owned business. We don't interface with clients but manage approx. ₹3,000 crores of assets under management (AUM) within this family-owned investment portfolio. NALCO appears to be a very promising and long-term story for us. Today's meeting aims to help us better understand your business operations, views, cost matrix, and strategic vision, especially in the global context. That's our brief introduction. Over to you, sir.

Shri RC Joshi: A very good afternoon to all our esteemed investors. At the very outset, I welcome each one of you to this Investors Meet. I feel privileged

to interact with our partners in progress

who share a common vision of building a robust, resilient, and financially sound NALCO which is future-ready, synchronized with its values and beliefs, and inspiring all stakeholders in order to dream and achieve more. The journey of NALCO has been one of the consistent growth and transformation. The steady growth of the organisation has been made possible because of the trust, support, and commitment of all our stakeholders and partners. I am delighted to share insights into our performance and discuss our strategic plans for the future. As we move forward, our focus remains on expanding our alumina and aluminum capacities by early completion of ongoing expansion projects. Our commitment is to drive significant growth through innovation and adoption of best practices to minimize waste, ensuring that our operations remain cost-efficient, profitable, and also environmentally responsible. I want to extend my gratitude to each one of you for your continued support and belief in NALCO. Together, we have achieved several milestones, and I am confident that we will achieve even greater progress in the near future.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Thank you so much for this kind introduction, sir. In the interest of time, I will ask my questions in a very sequential and orderly manner, and I hope you will be happy to answer them. Starting with the cost of production and the conversion ratio, since these are the backbone of our industry. Could you help us understand the average cost of production for bauxite, alumina, and aluminum? If you could broadly share these figures, it would be very helpful.

Page | 2

Shri RC Joshi: Sure. According to the Wood Mackenzie report, we are the lowest-cost producer of bauxite and alumina in the world. While these are price-sensitive figures, I can still share a broad range for the products we are producing.

The cost of production for bauxite ranges from ₹1,000 to ₹1,100.

For power, it ranges from ₹3 to ₹3.30 per unit.

The cost of producing alumina ranges from ₹23,000 to ₹25,000.

For metal, it ranges from ₹1,65,000 to ₹1,85,000.

Nirzar Securities LLP: That's very helpful, sir. Can you share the conversion ratio on which we operate? For instance, how much bauxite is required to produce 1 ton of alumina?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, for producing 1 ton of alumina, we would require about 3.5 tons of bauxite.

Nirzar Securities LLP: And for producing 1 ton of metal?

Shri RC Joshi: For 1 ton of metal, we need 2 tons of alumina.

Nirzar Securities LLP: And broadly, what would be the power consumption in terms of units for producing alumina?

Shri Srimanta Panda: It's 14,500 units.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, approximately 14,500 units.

Nirzar Securities LLP: And, sir, in the overall cost matrix, could you break down the cost components for alumina and aluminum? For example, what percentage is allocated to raw materials, power, etc.?

Shri RC Joshi: Sure, for metal:

Raw material: 42%,

Power and fuel: 37%,

Staff costs: 11% (roughly),

Depreciation: 3%,

Other costs: 6%,

For alumina: Raw material: 39%,

Power and fuel: 40%,

Employee costs: 13%,

Page | 3

Depreciation: 3%,

Other costs: 5%,

Nirzar Securities LLP: Thank you, sir. This brings me to my next question. As we are about to expand and build new facilities, such as the upcoming alumina refinery, will these cost metrics remain constant? Or will there be any changes, such as savings in employee costs or other efficiencies?

Shri RC Joshi: As you know, we are expanding our alumina capacity by 1 million tons, which is expected to be commissioned by September 2025. While legacy costs may remain for existing facilities, we anticipate some efficiencies and potential savings in areas like employee costs for the new facilities. However, the broad cost metrics should remain in line with our current operations.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay.

Shri RC Jo

shi: The entire project cost is being funded through internal sources. We have not borrowed any money.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: This means there is no interest component involved. The only additional cost will be some extra depreciation. However, we are using better and more advanced technology, which will result in some savings. As mentioned earlier, there will also be savings in employee costs, as proportionate employee costs will not be incurred. The primary additional cost will be depreciated, given our investment of ₹7,600 crores. Compared to our current costs, the overall cost is expected to increase by about ₹2,000 to ₹2,500 per ton.

Nirzar Securities LLP: The cost will increase for the new facility, right?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, approximately ₹2,000 per ton.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay, that was very helpful, sir. As of now, what is the landed cost of caustic? Since we have a joint venture (JV) for caustic with GSCS.

Shri RC Joshi: The landed cost of caustic is currently ₹36,700.

Nirzar Securities LLP: This seems slightly higher than our peers. We've been tracking Hindalco for comparison purposes. Do you have any understanding of why our cost is on the higher side? Do they have better sourcing arrangements or some other advantage?

Shri RC Joshi: It may be due to the location. I'm referring to the landed cost, which includes transportation logistics.

Nirzar Securities LLP: So, primarily because of transportation and logistics costs?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, exactly.

Page | 4

Shri Srimanta Panda: Good afternoon. The transportation cost from our JV to our alumina refinery itself is around ₹6,000 to ₹6,500. This contributes significantly to the landed cost.

Shri Hitesh: Good afternoon, sir.

Shri RC Joshi: Good afternoon, Hitesh.

Shri Hitesh: I believe the higher cost is due to the distance from the source of the caustic.

Shri RC Joshi: That's correct. It's primarily an extra logistics cost.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Thank you, sir. I'll now move to the CAPEX part. Regarding the proposed 1-million-ton alumina refinery, are you on track to commence operations by the end of FY2023-24?

Shri RC Joshi: Our target is September 2025, and we are on track so far.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay. And, in the initial years of operation, what is your view on production capacity utilization for the new facility?

Shri RC Joshi: In the first year, that is FY 2025-26, we aim to achieve around 3 lakh tons of production.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Right.

Shri RC Joshi: From the next year onwards, we will achieve full capacity.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Also, sir, there were cost overruns and slight delays associated with our proposed CAPEX. As noted in our annual report, in FY23, we had a budgeted CAPEX of around ₹6,500 crores, which has increased slightly in FY24. This could be due to factors like changes in scope or regulatory approvals. Can you guide us on what factors led to this increase in CAPEX? Could you provide a breakup, including cost escalations?

Shri RC Joshi: The increase is mainly due to project delays.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: However, this is now the final figure, and we are hopeful that we'll see some savings from within this budget as certain projects are coming under cost. So, within the allocated CAPEX, we plan to complete the project.

Nirzar Securities LLP: What kind of savings can we achieve broadly, sir?

Shri RC Joshi: Mainly due to changes in scope. Some reductions in the initial scope of work are helping us save costs.

Nirzar Securities LLP: We've also went through the Central Project Monitoring website, which mentions that roughly 67-68% of our work has been completed. They have stated an expenditure of around ₹5,700 crores so far. However, in our annual report, it is mentioned ₹8,200 crores.

Could you clarify?

Page | 5

Shri RC Joshi: The final figure will be less than ₹8,000 crores.

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Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay. Does this figure include the power plant cost as well?

Shri RC Joshi: No, it does not.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: It includes only the refinery and the Pottangi mines.

Shri Srimanta Panda: No, the power plant is internal.

Shri RC Joshi: The power plant for the refinery, specifically the steam power plant, is included in this cost.

Nirzar Securities LLP: How much of this is allocated to the Pottangi mines?

Shri RC Joshi: ₹2,100 crores.

Nirzar Securities LLP: ₹2,100 crores. Okay. And the conveyor belt we are planning from the Panchpatmali mines—is it included in this figure?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, it is included in the ₹2,100 crores.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay. How much of the budget is allocated to the power project?

Shri RC Joshi: I don't have the exact breakup right now.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Okay. The conveyor belt we are planning from the Panchpatmali mines, since we are about to start operations at the Pottangi mine, what benefits do you foresee from this additional conveyor belt for the fifth stream of alumina?

Shri RC Joshi: It's not a question of benefits; it's a necessity. As per environmental clearance (EC), transportation must be done through the conveyor belt.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Right.

Shri RC Joshi: Moreover, the conveyor belt is the cheapest mode of transportation.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Are we expecting some delays in the commencement of operations at Pottangi? Is this why we are considering the conveyor belt?

Shri RC Joshi: No. We have already taken an in-principle decision to engage an MDO. The Board has already approved the engagement of an MDO. We have also given the order for transaction advisors. Once they submit their report, we will float our NIT to put the MDO in place.

Nirzar Securities LLP: So, for Pottangi, do we have all clearances and approvals in place?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, all clearances are in place. Only a few more permissions are required. One is for opening the mining operations. Additionally, there is some delay because the conveyor belt

Page | 6

will take time. Until it is operational, we will transport by road. However, the EC (Environmental Clearance) specifically states that transportation must be done via conveyor belt only.

Shri Srimanta Panda: Conveyor belt.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, so we need to amend the EC, among other clearances, which will take some time.

Shri Srimanta Panda: Also, DGMS (Directorate General of Mines Safety) clearance is required for safety. Otherwise, all other clearances are in place.

Nirzar Securities LLP: That's very heartening to hear, Sir. Now, after Pottangi mines commence, we will be having two sources for the 5th stream: one conveyor belt we're planning from Panchpatmali mines and Pottangi mines. Will there be a double source?

Shri RC Joshi: Panchpatmali will cater only to the existing refinery. Pottangi will be solely for the new 5th stream refinery.

Nirzar Securities LLP: So, Panchpatmali to the new conveyor belt, plus Pottangi—both sources will provide bauxite?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, but the bauxite from Panchpatmali will meet the needs of the current refinery, and Pottangi will cater solely to the new 5th stream refinery.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Sir, Panchpatmali is already sufficient to run the current operations. Are we expanding Panchpatmali?

Shri RC Joshi: No. We are not expanding Panchpatmali. Expansion is at Pottangi.

Nirzar Securities LLP: There was some confusion that the conveyor belt is from Panchpatmali to the 5th stream.

Shri RC Joshi: No. The conveyor belt is from Pottangi to the 5th stream.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Thank you for clarifying. So, there's no expansion planned at Panchpatmali mines?

Shri RC Joshi: No.

Nirzar Securities LLP: But in the annual report, it mentioned potential delays in commencing Pottangi operations, which is why a conveyor belt from Panchpatmali to the 5th stream

at a cost

of ₹450 crores was proposed.

Shri Srimanta Panda: That's an alternate system.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, it's an alternate sourcing of bauxite. As of now, we are on track with Pottangi

operations. The commissioning is planned for September 2025, and we will be ready by then. The alternate sourcing may or may not be required.

Page | 7

Nirzar Securities LLP: So in the future, we will have extra bauxite capacity. Will we use it for brownfield expansion, or is there another plan?

Shri RC Joshi: No, there's no scope for further brownfield expansion.

Nirzar Securities LLP: On the reserves, the 2009 data shows 376 million tons of bauxite ore. What's the current estimate, and is there any potential for re-evaluation?

Shri RC Joshi: We'll provide updated data shortly. Re-evaluation is happening because IBM (Indian Bureau of Mines) is changing their guidelines. Earlier, reserves were calculated for ore with 3-4% silica content. Now, with 7% silica permissible, reserves have increased. This has raised caustic soda consumption and production costs, but reserves have grown accordingly. The current estimate for Panchpatmali Bauxite Mines is 150 million tons of reserve left and for Pottangi Mines, it is 110 million tons.

Nirzar Securities LLP: With this change from 4% to 7% silica, production costs rise by around \$20-\$30 per ton?

Shri RC Joshi: Mainly, there's an increase in caustic soda consumption. Other costs remain unchanged.

Nirzar Securities LLP: So, the sensitivity is around \$10 per ton for every 1% increase in silica?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, approximately \$10.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Regarding Utkal D and E, the combined capacity EC is obtained. What's the current status?

Shri RC Joshi: The combined capacity of 4 million tons will be operated from this month or maybe in a week time. Utkal D alone produced 2 million tons. For the remaining three months, we expect an additional 1.3 million tons, bringing total production to 3.3 million tons this year.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Are there any reassessments of Utkal D and E reserves?

Shri RC Joshi: No reassessment is planned.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Any plans for acquiring new bauxite or coal mines?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, we are participating in auctions for mines as they become available.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Since 2015, and especially post-2021, there has been a shift where mines are no longer reserved for PSUs. Is that correct?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, all mines are now obtained through the auction process only.

Shri Hitesh: Is there any preference or preferential treatment?

Shri RC Joshi: No. No more dispensers, Sir. No more dispensers.

Page | 8

Shri Hitesh: When we talk to many PSUs at conferences in Bombay, we've learned that under the leadership of Modi Ji's government, almost all PSUs have hired big consultancy firms. This is to help them grow, become leaner, more efficient, and evolve into globally admired companies. Have we hired a global consultant in recent times to take NALCO to the next level? I don't need the name, but just to confirm, have we hired someone for this purpose?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, we have hired consultants. We have prepared our Vision documents through them. For auctions, we also hire their services to guide us in acquiring mines. It's a regular practice here to hire such big firms.

Shri Hitesh: So, would this hiring have been done one or two years ago, or much earlier?

Shri RC Joshi: It's a regular feature. Whenever we have mining auctions, we hire their expertise as needed.

Shri Srimanta Panda: Even for manpower assessment.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, in 2024, we hired consultants for manpower assessment. In 2018, we hired them for corporate planning, and we regularly engage them for mining auctions.

Shri Hitesh: Other PSUs, like SJVN, hired consultants to significantly scale their operations. For instance, SJVN is moving from 1-2 GW to 25 GW in just 10 years. Sim

ilarly, China produces 45

million tons of aluminum annually. With India, aspiring to be the third-largest economy, we have substantial bauxite reserves, competitive power rates, and good coal mines. How does NALCO plan to capitalize on this and scale aluminum production?

Shri RC Joshi: With the expansion of our alumina capacity, we'll reach 3.1 million tons. We've also planned a 0.5 million-ton smelter with a CAPEX of ₹17,300 crores has already been approved by the board. We are in discussions with NTPC for power sourcing through a joint venture, and the MOU has been signed. A consultant is preparing the DPR, and the project's zero date is May 2026. It will take about three years to complete the 0.5 million tons of smelter.

Shri Hitesh: How do we typically handle alumina and aluminum sales? What proportion is spot sales versus long-term contracts? And how do we link these to LME pricing?

Shri RC Joshi: There's no fixed strategy. Generally, roughly 40% of sales are through term contracts, and 60% are spot sales. However, this year, alumina prices are abnormally high, so we've capitalized by focusing on spot sales.

Shri Hitesh: What was the average realization last quarter?

Shri RC Joshi: Till November, it was \$529.

Nirzar Securities LLP: What about current pricing?

Shri RC Joshi: It is higher than this, around more than \$600.

Nirzar Securities LLP: While transferring alumina to the aluminum division, at what price is it done?

Page | 9

Shri RC Joshi: At the cost price, based on the cost of production.

Nirzar Securities LLP: Maybe Manav, you can take the next question and I will get back in the queue.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Thank you. On the royalty rates, can you explain how does the bauxite royalty system works? There are significant fluctuations in royalty payments. How does such things work-out?

Shri RC Joshi: Royalties based on three parameters - the quality of bauxite (ATH), LME prices, and exchange rates. These variables cause month-to-month fluctuations in royalty payments.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: I read that royalties are roughly 0.6% of LME rates. Is that correct?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Unlike other minerals, does NALCO pay any domestic royalty premiums for mining?

Shri RC Joshi: No, we pay standard royalties without any premiums.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: What impact does Supreme Court's ruling on the royalty regime have on NALCO?

Shri RC Joshi: We fall under the ruling's domain, but the act hasn't been enacted yet, so it's hard to assess. We haven't disclosed anything in our annual reports because of this.

Shri Srimanta Panda: State governments have also announced on the floor of the house that the act needs reform. The Supreme Court hasn't made specific pronouncements on the act, and the government appears hesitant to proceed as it could harm the mining industry.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. Yes.

Shri Hitesh: So, is it the mindset of the state government or the central government, sir?

Shri Srimanta Panda: No, it is the mindset of the government. The state government is in sync with the central government on this issue because they belong to the same year. It's not like Jharkhand or West Bengal, where they want to maximize their revenue. They are in sync.

Shri RC Joshi: Because both governments are the same. They are in sync.

Shri Srimanta Panda: And there is no question of recovering from the customer. It is not possible.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Sure. Sure.

Shri Srimanta Panda: One more thing, even for companies, even if it is retrospectively given a pack, they cannot recover from us. Because as far as the FSA is concerned, the coal price is frozen. For any change in royalty, they cannot recover or pass it over to Nalco.

Page | 10

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Sure. Sure.

Shri Hitesh: Manav, just one minute. So, you mea

n to say that the state government is not in favor of retrospective or prospective changes? Is that your concern?

Shri Srimanta Panda: Yes. As of now, whatever has been reported in the media, that is the understanding or impression.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yeah. Sure. So, one question on the Pottangi mines. What would be the expected annual production capacity run rate from those mines?

Shri Srimanta Panda: 3.5 million tons.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: 3.5 million tons. And it's to suffice the need for your refinery. Additionally, you mentioned that you will be doing this through MDO.

Shri RC Joshi: We'll be doing it through MDO.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yeah. Yeah. Through MDO. So, there will be some cost shift taking place on the MDO from the earlier deposit to 1,100 Rs. per ton. This cost shift might go up a bit.

Shri RC Joshi: Yeah. There will be some increase in cost, definitely.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. So, a fair option should be around 1,500-1,600 Rs. per ton for the mines.

Shri RC Joshi: Oh, no. It will not be that high. Around 1,400 Rs..

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: 1,400 Rs. Okay. So, I wanted to talk a little bit about how the global supply and pricing scenario for alumina is. Considering the prices have been higher than average over the last 10 years, especially this particular year, we wanted to know if the global alumina industry is seeing a supply deficit of roughly 1 million to 1.5 million tons. But we have seen that some of the remaining expenditures in China have shut down and also announced production cuts. So, do you see that the pricing situation can be expected to cool off from these highs of 70,650 levels? What do you think?

Shri RC Joshi: I expect that this price level will continue until at least March 2025.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Okay. Post that, because even Nalco's 1 million tons refinery is coming in, right? We have another refinery coming in Russia, adding 2.5 million tons, if I'm not wrong. So, do you think that we may go back to the original 450 levels or below that?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. We will go back to that price level, definitely. This is an abnormally high price. It will not sustain. Smelters will not sustain with these prices.

Shri Srimanta Panda: This abnormal alumina price was driven by four factors. There was a production disruption in Australia, then there was carbon export of bauxite from Guinea to China. So, there was a demand for alumina. Then, there was another issue in Brazil as well. Recently, it

Page | 11

has softened by more than \$100 due to a smelter production shut down of around 2.5 lakh announced in Mozambique. So, that has taken a demand of around 7.7 lakh tons off the market. So, that has softened the price. Now, coming to China, yes, as the winter approaches, there will be carbon production restrictions because of environmental concerns and emissions. So, that may again reduce some of the demand, but that will play out in a month. We are still expecting more than \$600 for the remaining period.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: For the side only? But in the longer term, I can expect it to be around 16-17% of how the LME aluminum prices behave, right? That would be much more interesting.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: One question on the proposed CAPEX for the aluminum smelter, which you have guided for 17,000 crores. Can you give us a broad breakup in terms of machinery expenses planned and what regulatory approvals are taking place here?

Shri RC Joshi: Right now, I don't have the breakup with me.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Okay. But, where are we in the process? When will the EC (Environmental Clearance) be granted?

Shri RC Joshi: No, no. Now the status is...

Shri Hitesh: And a related question to what Manav Gogia, YES Securities: just asked is regarding this CAPEX of 17,000 crores. Have we also included the alumina

capacity that would

be required, like 4.5 million tons? That would require, what, 1 million tons?

Shri RC Joshi: That will be coming from our refinery plant.

Shri Hitesh: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: That 1 million tons we are planning to source.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: So, the 17,000 crores is only for the smelter?

Shri RC Joshi: Only for the smelter.

Shri Hitesh: And any recycling plans or is this a future-ready plan? Meaning, if there are any future expansions, the infrastructure would be ready for that initial CAPEX.

Shri RC Joshi: This will be a brownfield expansion. This will be a brownfield expansion.

Shri RC Joshi: And there is no further land in the same place. We will have to go to another location. It will be a brownfield.

Shri Srimanta Panda: Beyond this point.

Shri RC Joshi: Beyond this point. Right?

Shri Hitesh: Okay. Because this comes to mind, the 17,000 crore CAPEX, from what we study and understand from the public domain information for our industry and other peers, it seems

Page | 12

quite steep. I just wanted to understand whether it is for the future, because recently, Hindalco and others have announced their CAPEX plans. They are incurring 8,000-9,000 crore for 1 million tons of capacity, half a million tons, I mean.

Shri Srimanta Panda: They have announced for the expansion of 180 pots with the same technology, AP 300, but our endeavor is to go for AP 500. They have not commercialized AP 500 yet, so we might go for AP 600. So, discussions are ongoing. Our capacity expansion is for something different, not just expanding the existing technology by another 180 pots.

Shri Hitesh: Could you just explain this once again? My concern is, sir, if we are spending roughly double the amount to produce the same thing, what kind of technology benefits and cost savings can we expect, given that you are upgrading the technology, as you mentioned?

Shri Srimanta Panda: Yes, in terms of power efficiency, it is much cheaper. In terms of output, it will be much higher. This is the latest technology available in the world. It will be 600.

Shri Hitesh: So, we can save 8,000-10,000 crores per year for producing half a million tons. How much is half a million?

Shri Srimanta Panda: No, we don't have their breakup of what comprises 8,000 or 8,500 crores. Our 17,000 crores is different.

Shri RC Joshi: 8,000 crores seems very low for 1.5 million tons. It's not possible to build 5 million tons of capacity at 8,000 crores.

Shri Hitesh: We'll send you whatever we have read through published information and whatever presentation they have given to other investors.

Shri RC Joshi: Okay.

Shri Srimanta Panda: We can update it after that.

Shri RC Joshi: Please share it. We'll update it. We'll update. Please share that.

Shri Hitesh: I just want to know. Nothing else.

Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. So, on the CAPEX guidance, what numbers can we expect for the next 3 fiscal years? I mean, this fiscal, then FY 26 and FY 27, if you could broadly share those?

Shri RC Joshi: This fiscal, it is 2,000 crores. Next fiscal, it is 2,200 crores. And for FY 27, we haven't planned anything so far.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: I'm guessing that in FY 27, it might start peaking since the smelter will be operational. So, more details will come down the line, right?

Shri RC Joshi: Right. Yes.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: One thing, you mentioned earlier, about the Utkal coal D and Utkal coal E blocks, right? The combined capacity is 2 million tons per annum for each.

Page | 13

Shri RC Joshi: 4 million tons. The combined capacity is 4 million tons.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: 2 million tons for each, right?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. 2 million tons for each.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: And what would be the current blend of coal requirements? How much are we sourcing from Coal India through contracts, and how much is sourced through

ough

the e-auction route?

Shri RC Joshi: Our requirement is about 7.5 million tons of coal in total. We have about 4.5 million tons under FSA with Coal India. So, besides that, whatever is required, we are taking it from our mines. We are not procuring anything through e-auction right now.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: So, that is the saving we are getting in coal.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Okay. And with the Utkal mines kicking in, what per-ton cost savings can we expect on the coal front?

Shri RC Joshi: Per ton?

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. I think it's going to replace the 4.5 million tons you're currently sourcing from coal. Could you provide me with the number of how much that quantity will be replaced, and on what basis?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. So roughly, if you compare it with the e-auction price, it's about ₹800 to ₹900 per ton in savings on full cost.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: ₹800 to ₹900.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Eventually, with the Utkal mines running at full ramp-up capacity, what would be the targeted coal blend in our requirements? I think 7.5 remains the same?

Shri RC Joshi: Yeah, that remains the same. So, whatever we get from NCL as FSA, anything additional will be sourced from Utkal D and E.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Okay.

Shri RC Joshi: It's roughly 3 to 3.2 million tons.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: One question, I think I'm probably done with that. The mining ECs are completed on the Pottangi mine, right? It should be up and running by May 2025?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, April-May, 2025, we may start mining.

Page | 14

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. And we did the project for that alternative sources of bauxite, right? That should also be in line with the aluminum sales mix?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. That is in line for September 2025.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Good. And regarding that aluminum sales mix, what portion of it will be domestic versus exports?

Shri RC Joshi: In terms of volume?

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes, volume.

Shri Srimanta Panda: Can you repeat that?

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Yes. When it comes to alumina sales, what percentage of the volume is targeted for the export market, and who are we supplying?

Shri RC Joshi: Alumina, as such, we are exporting the entire quantity, except whatever is required for the smelter. Hardly 60-70,000 tons are sold in the domestic market, the rest is all exported.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Completely. Okay, so with the export markets, I'm guessing we will get higher realizations over there?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, definitely.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: And that's one reason. The second reason is it's not possible to sell in the domestic market due to logistic constraints.

Shri Hitesh: Sir, I think you've been very transparent and forthcoming with your answers, which were beyond our expectations. Sir, what can be the reason for the company's 5-year tenure in

terms of alumina and aluminum capacity going forward? And secondly, aluminum doesn't seem very profitable for us. What are our thoughts on that? Would we prefer to focus more on alumina in the future? How can we acquire more mines? And what can be our 10-year plan for capacity expansion?

Shri RC Joshi: 5 to 10 years down the line, we will focus more on value-added products. So far, we are only in primary metal production, but in the future, we'll shift to value-added products. We already have some plans in place as per our recent document. Regarding aluminum not being very profitable, that's not entirely correct. I thought that too initially, but when I looked into it, I found that it actually gives us the maximum contribution.

Shri Hitesh: The second thing is, as you said, we have Hindalco's 5 lakh-ton expansion and its cost. If we have your email ID, we can exchange details on email to

get more clarity.

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, sure. You can email our company secretary, who is coordinating this. We will also provide feedback.

Page | 15

Shri Hitesh: And one more thing: for aluminum production of 5 million tons, we will need roughly ₹4,000 crore in power, based on the numbers you provided. We believe there could be a power saving of 20-25% with better technology. Can we become one of the most efficient plants in the world?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, absolutely.

Shri Hitesh: Sir, can you tell us something about the KABIL JV and any assets we've acquired abroad, and the reason behind the company's and government's involvement in these ventures? I think the government is offering tax benefits for rare earth minerals. What's the bigger picture here? Could it lead to large volumes and profitability in a market where the private sector cannot enter so easily? The government is in favor of PSC-based projects. What can we expect in this space?

Shri Bharat Sahu: Yes, sir. I'm sorry I wasn't present earlier. Could you please repeat your question?

Shri Hitesh: Could you tell us about the KABIL JV and the assets we've acquired abroad? What is the company and government's strategy in these ventures? The government is offering tax benefits for rare earth minerals, so what is the bigger picture here? Can it lead to large volumes and profitability in markets where the private sector is not allowed to enter?

Shri Bharat Sahu: It's still too early to discuss the profitability and mining acquisitions with KABIL. However, KABIL is progressing steadily in that direction. In Argentina, exploration activities have already started in Catamarca. KABIL has signed an agreement with CAMYEN, a state-owned mining company in Argentina. One of our representatives has been appointed as country head to oversee exploration activities there. When KABIL was initially formed, NALCO was a promoter company and had hired DMT Consulting to identify 12 critical minerals, including lithium and cobalt. These minerals are abundantly available in Argentina, Bolivia, Chile, and Australia. Due to political unrest in Chile and Bolivia, our focus is on Argentina and Australia. In Argentina, we've made good progress with exploration activities. If successful, we will move to the next phase. Meanwhile, in Australia, we have also made progress and recently signed a non-binding MOU with an owner to acquire a 20% stake in one of the projects. While it's still early to name them, other major PSUs, are joining hands with KABIL for mining in Australia, provided our bid is successful.

Nirzar Securities LLP: It's encouraging to hear that, sir. Regarding the global scenario, I noticed in the annual report that Chalco (China Aluminum Corporation) has signed a framework agreement with Guinea to establish an alumina refinery. How do you see this development, especially in comparison to our alumina production? What scale could this have? How does Guinea's bauxite compare to our bauxite?

Shri RC Joshi: Guinea's bauxite quality is good, but our Panchpatmali bauxite is still considered superior. As for Chalco's refinery in Guinea, their cost of procuring bauxite will likely decrease, but we don't think this will disrupt the alumina supply-demand balance.

Page | 16

Shri Hitesh: Sir, it seems that the company is focusing on value-added products, as I understand. When can we expect this to roll out? What kind of capital expenditure should we anticipate for this, and what return ratios are we looking at for this expansion?

Shri Srimanta Panda: This has been on our drawing board since 2018 as part of our corporate plan. We've already prepared feasibility reports for 4 downstream products, and land has been identified. The main constraint is the hot metal production. These products will become a reality once our smelter expansion materializes. Until then, we'll have to rely on curtailing domestic

market sales and setting up internally. So, there is a little bit of internal churning going on. So, once the smelter plants get loading, definitely the value-added products, rolls, foils and other extra products will come up.

Shri Hitesh: But, sir, we already have half a million tons of aluminum. Can we not expand value-added products in that facility?

Shri Srimanta Panda: No, because each of the 4 downstream units requires 40-50,000 tons of hot metal. This will require around 1.6-2 lakh tons, and Nalco has entered into a JV with Midhani for 50,000 tons, but it's not materializing as of now.

Shri RC Joshi: Aluminum Park...

Shri Srimanta Panda: Then NALCO is committed to providing 50,000 metric tons to the Angul Aluminum Park, which has come up our JV with state government, after that NALCO will be totally out of the domestic market scenario.

Shri RC Joshi: No surplus metal with us. We are waiting until we get that 0.5 million tons.

Shri Hitesh: So all the future CAPEX will come after 2020, and that, too, on value-added products. We are not planning anything right now on the metals?

Shri RC Joshi: No.

Shri Hitesh: Manav, do you have something to ask, or should we wind it up?

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: That's exactly the question I was about to ask, Hitesh ji.

One thing to clarify: over the next 5 to 10 years, what we are going to see is that Nalco will shift much more towards end products and a much more consumer-oriented approach. Can we expect that this probably be the last stream of refinery in the CAPEX plans going ahead? The first stream could be the last alumina refinery, and the focus will be completely on the metal side.

Shri Srimanta Panda: No, it would be premature to say that. That cannot be said because there are still bauxite mines available in the country.

Shri RC Joshi: We are also going to acquire some more mines, and that is the most profitable business for us. Selling that surplus material provides a lot of comfort to us, even in any market, because we make a profit. So that is why we'll definitely go for the further addition of alumina capacity.

Shri Srimanta Panda: It's too premature to say that this is the end of the road for alumina.

Page | 17

Shri Hitesh: You mentioned you may acquire more mines for future expansion. Can you provide more details on that? What kind of plants do we have, and when can we expect an additional 1 to 1.5 million tons of alumina from our company? Because we have preferential rights...

Shri RC Joshi: Actually, to add more alumina, we definitely need bauxite mines. These bauxite mines are sufficient only for our current needs. So, we are bidding for all available bauxite mines in every auction. Once we are successful in any bidding, we will plan for further expansion of alumina.

Shri Hitesh: So, we'll be doing the mining ourselves, like we did recently with Odisha Mineral Corporation? We'll acquire bauxite from the JV rather than doing the mining ourselves, correct?

Shri RC Joshi: No. No. We will go for our own mining. We'll do the mining ourselves.

Shri Hitesh: So, this may happen in the next 6 to 12 months?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. Yes, it would happen anytime because we participate in every bidding. Once we are the highest bidder, we'll acquire the mines and plan accordingly.

Shri Hitesh: So, we might acquire a 6-7 million tons alumina company going forward?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. Yes, definitely.

Shri Hitesh: The big picture is to become a very big company, right?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, a big number. Right.

Hitesh: Thank you. Where can we get the recent document, or is it internal?

Shri RC Joshi: It's internal, sir.

Shri Hitesh: Where can we find the auction details, sir?

Shri RC Joshi: The auction details? The Ministry of Mines provides it generally.

Shri Hitesh: Is that information on India's bauxite? I believe the results are understated. We're not exploring countries like Guinea, which

have huge reserves. Do you think India is underexplored, and as a company, we could add more reserves?

Shri RC Joshi: Actually, the present Ministry of Mines is focusing a lot on this, and I hope that more reserves will come up in the future.

Shri Hitesh: So, as a country, we can have much more reserves than currently?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes. Yes. Yes, sir.

Shri Hitesh: Substantially more than the current?

Shri RC Joshi: Yes, definitely.

Page | 18

Shri Hitesh: Okay. Thank you, sir.

Shri RC Joshi: Can we wind up, sir?

Shri Hitesh: Yes.

Shri RC Joshi: Sir, we have a meeting now. Can we wrap up?

Shri Hitesh: Thank you so much for your time.

Shri RC Joshi: Thank you. Thank you so much.

Shri Bharat Sahu: Thank you, Manav, for organizing this. Thanks a lot, sir. Thank you to the

team at Nirzar Securities. Thank you very much for this meeting, and we look forward to a similar kind of association in the future as well. Thank you.

Shri Manav Gogia, YES Securities: Thank you so much, Mr. Bharat, for organizing this for us. Thank you so much.

Call: Feb 2025

National Aluminium Company Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)
REGD. & CORPORATE OFFICE
Nalco Bhawan, Nayapalli, Bhubaneswar-751013, India
CIN # L27203OR1981GOI000920
Tel.:0674-2301988-999, Ext.:2265, 2266, 2267, 2585, 2587, E-mail: company_secretary@nalcoindia.co.in, Website: www.nalcoindia.com

■■■■■/Ref. : NBC/S/4.5 & 4.5(A)/2025/228

■■■■■/Dated: 18.02.2025

To,

■■■■■/The Manager

■■■■■ ■■■■■ ■■/BSE Limited,

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Phiroj Jeejeebhoy Towers,

■■■■■ ■ ■■■■/Dalal Street,

■■■■/MUMBAI ■ 400 001

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■■■■■/The Manager

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National Stock Exchange of India Ltd.,

[REDACTED], [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Exchange Plaza, Bandra ■ Kurla Complex,

■■■■■ ■■/Bandra East,

■■■■/MUMBAI■■400 051

■■■■ /Symbol: NATIONALUM

■■■■: 11.02.2025 ■■ ■■■■■■ ■■ ■■ ■■■ ■■■ ■■ ■■■■ ■■■

Sub: Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call held on 11.02.2 025.

■■■■■ /Dear Sir,

Further to our letter dated 11.02.2025 and pursuant to Regulation 30 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, enclosed please find the transcript of the Earnings Conference Call held on 11.02.2025 for discussions on Company's business and outlook post declaration of Unaudited Financial Results for 3rd Quarter & Nine months ended 31st December, 2024. This is for your information and record.

■■■■■/Thanking you.

■■■■■/ Yours faithfully,

■■■■■ ■■■■■■ ■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■

For National Aluminium Co. Ltd.

(■■. ■■. ■■š)/(B. K. Sahu)

[REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

ACS: 9953

Encl.: As above

1 | Page

Earnings VC on "NALCO's Q3 Financial Results for FY25"

Bharat Kumar Sahu: Go od Morning, Are you there?

Shweta Dikshit: Yes, sir.

Bharat Kumar Sahu: Yeah, before we start, let me introduce our NALCO management team. Sitting in the middle, our Chair man-cum-Managing Director, Shri Bijendra Pratap Singh. And, to his right is our Director (Finance), Sri Ramesh Chandra Joshi. And, sitting to his left is Shri Srimanta Panda, EPO-Executive Director (Finance), and myself Bharat Kumar Sahu, Company Secretary. And, as we had discussed, you will be introducing the management team to the investors community and then you will hand over the session, and our Director (Finance) will

make an opening remark, followed by a presentation from our BD team. After the presentation is over, we will invite questions from the investors' community. Is that okay, ma'am?

Shweta Dikshit: Yes, sir. That's okay. Okay. So let me know when we can, allow the participants to join the meeting, and then we can, begin as you suggest.

Bharat Kumar Sahu: In fact, from our side, ma'am, we are all ready.

Shweta Dikshit: Okay.

Bharat Kumar Sahu: It is 11:30, so we can start now.

Shweta Dikshit: Okay. So, let me allow everyone to join. Good morning and welcome everyone to the 3Q FY25 conference meeting of Nalco Limited. On behalf of systematics, we welcome you all today. Today with us, we have Shri Bijendra Pratap Singh, Chairman-cum-Managing Director. Shri Ramesh Chandra Joshi, Director (Finance), Shri Srinanta Panda, EPO-ED (Finance), and Mr. Bharat Kumar Sahu, Company Secretary, representing Nalco Limited to discuss the 3Q FY25 financial results. Sir, thank you so much for joining us today to discuss your plans and performance for the third quarter and nine months of FY25. Now, I hand over to you, sir, for your opening remarks, and then subsequently, we can open the floor for a Q & A session?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Thank you, Shweta. A very good morning to all our esteemed stakeholders to this earning conference meeting. I'm happy to share with all our valued investors that during the third quarter of FY25, Nalco has registered its highest ever quarterly as well as nine

months cumulative turnover, profit after tax, and EBITDA since inception. Nalco has also declared its second interim dividend of Rs.4/- per share followed by the first interim dividend, which was also Rs.4/- per share, making it the highest ever dividend declared by Nalco so far, driven by better sales realization in alumina and metal segment, higher sales volume of alumina, use of captive coal, and reduction in cost of raw material. This has surged the profit in the Q3 of 2 | Page

FY2025 compared to the Q3 of FY 2024. On a standalone basis, Nalco has registered a cumulative PAT of Rs.3,246 crores during the nine months period FY25 as against Rs.1,044 crores during the corresponding nine months period of the previous fiscal. The cumulative PAT up to December 25 is higher by 211% compared to the previous nine months period. Turnover during the nine months period is Rs.11,434 crores as against Rs.9,506 crores in corresponding period of previous year, which is higher by around 20%. During the quarter, Nalco registered standalone PBT of Rs.2,122 crore and PAT of Rs.1,583 crore compared to PBT of Rs.668 crore and PAT of Rs.488 crore during Q3 FY24. The increase in profit after tax is 224% during Q3 FY25 compared to Q3 FY24. I'm confident that the strong financial performance reported has further reinforced the trust and confidence of all our stakeholders in Nalco. These robust numbers are a testament to our resilience, strategic vision, and commitment to delivering sustained value. They reflect not just our financial strength, but also the trust our investors, stakeholders, and partners place on us. As we move forward, we remain dedicated to upholding this confidence by driving growth, innovation, and long-term success. Now management will give a presentation before taking questions.

Manie Ravi: Good morning. My name is Ravi, and I'll take you to a small presentation that we have prepared, for this Earnings Conference. The initial presentation would cover the company, and then the performance of the company, in the last three quarters, the connection highlights. The industry outlook should include the global as well as Indian scenario. And, business highlights, apart from, the last slide being, on ESG. We are a Navratna CPSE, with Govt. of India holding 51.58% as on 30th September, 2024. We are on the largest integrated bauxite alumina aluminum power, and coal complex today. We are also a global leader producing bauxite and alumina at the lowest cost. Our facilities include a bauxite mine of 6.825 million tons per annum, refinery at 2.1 million tons per annum from where we have the finished goods, which are alumina hydrates, special hydrates, and calcined alumina. Our smelter plant is 0.46 million tons per annum, and the products at the smelter plant are the standard ingots, the ingots, billets, wire rods, and roll products. So, this would include, basically, the primary aluminum products as well as secondary products, which is covered in the billets and wire rods and rolled products. We have a captive power plant (CPP) to supply our power to the smelter plant. It's about 1,200 megawatts capacity, and the plan goes to this, CPP is a 4 million ton per annum coal mine, which is nearer to the CPP. It's about 55 kilometers from where the Captive Power Plant is located. We have dedicated facilities at the Vishakhapatnam port for the export of our alumina. The dedicated work has, automated loading system as well as storage facilities. Besides, we also have input storage facilities at the Vishakhapatnam Port. In addition to all these facilities, we also have ventured in wind power plants throughout the country, specifically in Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, and Rajasthan.

And the combined capacity is about 198 kilowatts. On the production front in the third quarter, all our facilities are working at 100 % capacity as of date. And, we have the perfor

mance for the

Q3. It's the first column. And we have increased the production in bauxite, aluminum, metal, as well as thermal power. In comparison to, Q3 of FY 24, the figures are significantly higher except in the case of metal, where, we have made certain, internal technical adjustments within our special plan. However, we would be achieving the capacity of our plan, which is over 0.46 million tons per annum. For the time, ending, it's a tad lower where the better is concerned at 342. On the sales front third quarter has shown some solid performances. The sales volumes have considerably increased where the alumina export is concerned, and that has also been helped by the rising prices in the last two quarters, starting from the end of the second quarter and the third quarter. Metal export, we can see is zero when compared to Q3 of 2023-24, and that's primarily because earlier revisions to the domestic market have been significantly higher. And, the market is also being driven by the goods of infrastructure as well as transportation sectors. The domestic market sales have improved us. The financial highlights have already been explained to you by our Director (Finance).

The highlights, of course, will be in our discussion, after we finish this presentation. One of the highlights is, we have had the highest ever revenue from our operations, the highest ever profit after tax, highest EBITDA margin, ever, and the highest ever dividend, in favor of Nalco, in the forty-five years of our existence. One of the benefits that we have or what are the key results, come from the changes in the element prices. Now, since we are exposed to the commodity cycles, the element prices in the last two, since May 2024 have seen its swings up and down. But in the last quarter, the lead has been a significant upward trend of the LME. At the beginning of the year, the forecast was somewhere around 2300 for the year. However, the market dynamics have changed, primarily because of geographical reasons. And then, there was an impact on the prices of alumina because of some of the constraints emerging from Papua New Guinea as well as Australia. Subsequently, of course, this has all changed. And, we expect that by the end of 2025, there will be a small surplus of primary aluminum in the world market. We are still seeing the action of the tariffs that have been imposed on aluminum from the U.S. The player on this particular tariff will be emerging in the next few days. And there's a lot of volatility that can be improved in the next few days. Globally, the global elements, like I mentioned in the earlier slide, we expect, that by the fact by...

Shweta Dikshit: I'm sorry to interrupt, sir. There's a lot of disturbance on the line. Yes. It's better now, sir. Please carry on.

Manie Ravi: So, in the nine months, that will be better than that. When that is concerned. We've seen a small deficit in terms of, the, better than that is in the market. What we expect is going to be very marginal because we expect more metal to come back into the market, considering the new challenges that have been announced in the US. The aluminium scenario, which was on the lower side was in October and November, 2024. We will be seeing an upswing in terms of, production with the market, and, we expect a surplus, by the end of 2025. The industry capital in India is far more positive in terms of the growth that is happening in infrastructure, transportation, and, the electrical sector, which is taking the large chunk of the aluminum usage

in India. The consumption in India on 2023 - 2024 is about 4.9 million tons and going by the estimates and the market analysis by 2030 in India is estimated that this particular consumption would increase to about 8.3 million tons per annum. So, for the aluminum sector in India, the infrastructures, electrical, as well as transportation are going to

be the growth drivers, in the next five years, and that is reflected in the kind of investments that are happening in this area. We've also announced the recent budgets. We are the largest integrated operations. We are located strategically all in the state of Odisha itself. So, all our plants are within this region, and logistically, we are well connected with respect to access to the traffic from our respective plants. The contents are very close to the refinery as well as to the CPP. So, the supply constraint when it comes to bauxite as well as the coal, is managed very well. Besides, there's a lot of infrastructure development happening with respect to the transportation of material within the state of Odisha in the last six months. We have a zero debt which can be leveraged, to give us the strength in the balance sheet to fund our smelter and power expansion plans, which are going to come up in the next five years' time. We are, in fact, raw material securitization where caustic soda as well as coal is concerned is something that has happened very recently to the company. In fact, it is now two years running, and we are seeing incremental benefits of this, securitization, that has appeared in the results in the last nine months. Our Refinery capacity is currently under expansion, and the expanded capacity is expected to come on stream by the end of this financial year. And, one of the benefits that we will be repaying from this expansion is the revenue that we'll be generating from this new final. In fact, in the first year, we would expect to produce about 5 lakh tons, and it will be increased to 1 million tons, which should be the rated capacity of the refinery expansion. The excess alumina that will come from this refinery will go to the smelter, which is again a brownfield, in addition to our existing smelter plant. The plan is, to have a 0.5 million tons smelter plant, near our existing smelter in the next five years' time, and

4 | Page

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the capacity from the hot cast metal from this smelter, will give the scope for, going downstream into exclusions as well as other value-added products. These are some of the projects which the company is already working. The bauxite mine expansion will add a capacity of 3.5, which will essentially feed the expansion that is happening at the aluminium refinery. The bauxite mines are expected to come on stream by the end of 2025-2026. The alumina refinery, which is also an expansion of the existing capacity, will have 1 million tons per annum, also expected to be completed in the upcoming financial year. The aluminum smelter is an activity which you've already begun. So, the land acquisition activities and other statutory clearances are already underway. The capacity for this aluminum smelter is 0.5 million tons per annum, which is, again, expected in the FY 2029-2030. And, to feed this Aluminium Smelter, we would also be having a capital power plant at a state location, which should be about 1200 megawatts capacity and which will also come along with this smelter in FY 2029-2030. While not just focusing on the business of alumina aluminium, and bauxite. We are also focusing on several of the ESG requirements, within the organization.

5 | Page

The objective, of course, is to minimize environmental harm and implementing, risk effectiveness management strategy. Because, as a company we are also doing a mining activity, we're exposed to a lot of regulations within the ecosystem. And so, on the key initiatives to mitigate to bring the company to the forefront of focus into the environment is, forestation is waste water utilization, advanced pollution control technologies, water pollution management, biodiversity protection, as well as efficient fuel handling. In fact, our bauxite mine is 98% blast free mining.

As part of the plantation activities, we have planted, close to about 1,50,000

trees in FY 2023 -

2024, which is up 14.3%. Out of 14.3 hectares of the mined out areas have been rehabilitated with plantation, in our bauxite mines. Of course, we also use fog cannons, water sprinklers to suppress dust in our mines. And, the ash utilization at our Refinery, we have a small power generated plant over there is more than 100%. In fact, at the bauxite mine, we have recently come up with the biodiversity conservation policy, which is one of the first things that we have been doing in terms of biodiversity conservation. And, aside from this, we have also set up a wind power plant, which I've already mentioned earlier. And, in addition to that, we are also setting up rooftop solar. Currently, we have a capacity of 800 kilowatt of rooftop solar, and we plan to add on the seven megawatts of, rooftop solar, in this organization within the next one and a half years.

Socially, we have a lot of interventions that are happening in the peripheral villages of the plant. Some of the flagship programs over here, I would like to bring your attention, is the Indradhanush program, which basically sponsors kids of the underprivileged, areas in the Damanjodi sector, and we provide them education in reputed residential schools in this area. In fact, close to, 800 odd kids are already currently studying, in the schools over there. Nalco Ki Ladli is another flagship program that we have, which is aligned with the "Beti Bachao Beti Padhao" mission of Govt. of India, where we support about 280 meritorious girl students today, from below poverty line families of Angul and Damanjodi sector.

We have eight Mobile Health Units which deliver services in around 200 peripheral villages. Annually, more than one lakh patients have been benefitted from this effort of ours. Apart from these flagship programs, we also have other social projects like constructing roads & repairing them, drainages, development of school infrastructure, community infrastructure and clean drinking water projects. Finally, on the governance front, we have 10 Board Level Committees for ESE governance, and we have 15 board policies and guidelines for the governance activities. Our self-appraisal for Q3 2024-25, on the adherence to ESE guidelines, was excellent. We have a very fair treatment of investors, dividend policies, and reporting transparency. We have regular risk assessments and evaluations to manage this within the organization. We have a number of ISO certifications which ensure that our processes are aligned with the best business practices.

Thank you.

6 | Page

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you, sir. So, we can now proceed with the Q & A session. We have a lot of participants raising their hands, so I'll take questions one by one. The first question comes from the line of Mr. Amit Dixit. So please introduce yourself and then proceed with your question.

Amit Dixit: Yeah. Hi. Good morning, everyone. I'm Amit Dixit from ICICI Securities. I have two questions for you, sir. The slide where you mentioned the CAPEX projects. So I just wanted to understand the total CAPEX that has been committed for these projects. If you can mention project wise, that would be great. And, the sort of CAPEX outlet that we could expect over the next three to four years.

Bijendra Pratap: The CAPEX, projected for this year was around Rs.2,000 crores, and, expected expenditure will be around Rs.1500 crores we'll be doing. Major shortfall, some AMR schemes we have taken at the refinery and our smelter plant. And some of the AMR schemes we have

taken for sustenance may be some shortfall will be there. And in our refinery scheme, in our refinery expansion, 5th expansions, their plan, there is also some shortfall. But as far as refinery expansion is concerned, maybe December, September was our target. In between September, December, we'll be finishing.

So, CAPEX, next year also, our plan will be around Rs.2,000 crores.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: In addition to that, CAPEX is, right now, we have, fifth stream. Refinery expansion is on, and we are spending about Rs.5,677 crores on fifth stream. And we have an expansion of Pottangi mines. There, we'll be spending about Rs. 1,961 crores. So, these two projects will be completed in the next one year or so. After that, we are going for smelter expansion at the cost of Rs.17,163 crores. The DPR is already approved by the board and for sourcing the power, we are planning to go with JV with NTPC. For that, again there will be a project cost about Rs.13,000. So, these are the projects lined up in the near future.

Amit Dixit: Great, sir. That's very helpful. The second question is on the coal security. So as I understand, we have couple of blocks with us. So just wanted to understand the current EC limit for these call blocks. And, is there a possibility of getting further enhancement on, on EC, and what kind of coal security we are targeting in the future when the, when the new plant also comes up, the new one?

Bijendra Pratap: As far as coal requirement for our CPP is concerned, we have a requirement of around 7 million tons. And, we have got two coal blocks that are Utkal D & E, both 2 million tons each. 4 million tons will be the total coal, which will be able to produce last this financial year, current financial year, will be going up to 3 million tons because for Utkal E, some delay was there. We have got tenancies for that also. Next financial year, around 4 million tons, we'll be producing. So whatever coal we were taking through e-auction, that will not be required to take the auction coal, and all will be produced through this full Utkal D & E.

7 | Page

Amit Dixit: Okay, sir. That's great. Thank you so much

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: Next question is from Somaiah.

Somaiah: Hi. Sir. I hope I'm audible.

Shweta Dikshit: Yes. You're audible.

Somaiah: Yep. Thanks for the opportunity. So, the first question is on your alumina. If you could just help with the pricing. So, this is M-1, M-2. How does the pricing work? How much would we spot? That's one. And, also, in terms of export markets, which are the markets and what is the regional premium that we have an exposure to.

Bijendra Pratap: You're talking about spot prices?

Somaiah: Alumni realizations. This is more to do with how the pricing works there. So, I just want to understand whether it's an m minus one pricing or how does it work?

Bijendra Pratap: Alumina prices actually, on an average, the trend has been around, maybe 400, 430, 450 dollars used to be in the previous years. But this year, in between in June, some shortfall in alumina production was there in Australia. So, the prices shot up of this alumina export prices, to around \$800, spot prices. Now, that plant in Australia has already started. So, the demand gap the supply demand ability, which was around four to five lakh tons in maybe, for Q1 & Q2 that has come down almost, that demand supply gap is not there. So current spot prices are going to around \$530. So, maybe further in the coming times, it may come down also.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: And during the third quarter, we have got \$641 average price of alumina. And up to nine months of this year, it is \$562. And regarding spot and term contract, we decide statistically like went to go for a spot and went to go for a term. And since this year, the price was in the increasing trend, so most of our sales in our spot basis.

Somaiah: Got it, sir. So even if it's a term contract, this will be based M-1 or M-2 pricing. That's how it will work. Right?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Yeah.

Somaiah: Sir, and also, this new project that we are bringing online, the new refinery expansion, in terms of, cost or in terms of margin profile, would it be similar to our existi

ng one, or would

there be any difference? Either it will be higher or lower in terms of contribution.

Bijendra Pratap: Cost wise, whatever alumina will be produced here, that will be almost the same as the existing one because of the raw material, whatever bauxite we are getting, that will be,

8 | Page

from the same mines and one more Pottangi mines we have got. We are just nearby. No major transportation cost will be involved. So, the cost will be almost the same as the existing alumina cost.

Somaiah: This was one small clarification to the earlier question on CAPEX. So, you mentioned the Pottangi mines and this refinery somewhere around Rs.7,500 crores to CAPEX, 5600 and 900. So, of this, how much has been spent so far and how much is remaining? That is one. And,

second thing in terms of this filter capacity, expansion that we are talking about, when will the CAPEX outflow for this start? And also, their NTPC number that you said, if you can just repeat, that should be helpful.

Bijendra Pratap: As far as this refinery and Pottangi mines is concerned, our total CAPEX plan was around Rs.5,700 crores and out of that Rs.3,500 crores we have already spent on that. And, till date, around 70% completion of the job, physical progress is there. We are trying to commission this project in September.

And Pottangi mines, almost, all clearances we have got, and, the CAPEX there is around 2,200 crores. We are going in for tender, maybe this month itself, February end or March, the NIT for the MDO appointment. MDO appointment board has given the clearance. We are going to appoint an MDO to operate those mines. We're trying to place orders by June or May, so that six months' time will be there for MDO to start the mines. Maybe, in between September and December, somewhere we'll try to start the Pottangi mines. And as far as our smelter is concerned, that is the expansion of the smelter 0.5 million tons smelter expansion we are planning, in addition to our existing capacities for which DPR, has been made by EIL, and DPR is approved by the board. The board has given in principle clearance. We are going for a technology partner, which EIL has selected, Rtail, Rio Tinto, Canada, and we are into negotiation with them for supply of technology. And, almost a new negotiation is on the verge of finalization. So once that is over, maybe this month itself, we'll be going for a preparation of a tender document technical specification with EIL. And, our plan is that, this tender and all the documents within the next six months, we should try to float the tender. And what the tender may be in the next seven, eight months so that the job starts after that. And maybe in the next four, five years, you should start the smelter plant because the commissioning itself will take three to four years after ordering. And along with that, one power plant also will be required because Smelter will require the captive power plant. For that, we'll be trying to go in a joint venture mode with NTDC or setting up a power plant.

Somaiah: Got it, sir. Thank you.

Bijendra Pratap: Till then, what we are observing, we have an additional casting facility of aluminum of around one lakh tons. We are trying to, increase our hot metal production, which is around 4.5 million tons, trying to save some small projects so that our, hot metal, we can increase the capacity or maybe use some, scraps so that this casting facility, whatever extra

9 | Page

casting facility we are having to increase the cast metal production. We'll be going for appointing EIL as a consultant to give some kind of feasibility whether that is possible or not.

Shweta Dikshit: The next question is from the line of Divya Agrawal. Divya, please unmute yourself and go ahead with your question.

Divya Agrawal: Hello, sir. Thanks for taking my question. So, sir, my question is on the macro side. So, can you

throw some light on the alumina and the bauxite pricing and the entire situation right now? Because we are seeing the alumina prices are corrected, but the bauxite prices are not being corrected in the similar tandem. So, will this trend continue, or how is the situation right now?

Bijendra Pratap: Can you repeat your question. It was not clearly audible.

Divya Agrawal: Am I audible now, sir? Now it is okay.

Bijendra Pratap: Yeah.

Divya Agrawal: So, I just wanted to know about the current scenario on the alumina as well as the bauxite pricing scenario. Because if we see the alumina, prices have reduced, but the bauxite prices have not reduced in the similar tandem. So, will this trend continue going forward, or how will the gap be in the coming quarter or the coming years?

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, alumina prices depend on demand supply. What is the alumina production and bauxite prices, also the cost of the mining is there. The bauxite cost almost remains constant, but alumina is totally dependent on the production from the smelter. Few of the smelters were closed down due to high alumina prices. So, when these smelters will start operating, the alumina demand will also increase. But alumina production, which was on the lower side earlier, now, there will be an excess of alumina in the coming times. So, we are seeing that whatever spot prices are now, around \$ 530 is a spot price as of date. That may go down in the coming time. That may go down to maybe 500 or 500 below.

Divya Agrawal: Okay sir, I got it. That's all from my end. Thank you.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you. The next question is from Sumangal. Sumangal, please unmute yourself and go ahead.

Sumangal: Yeah. Good afternoon. This is Sumangal, from Kotak Securities. Firstly, sir, thanks for hosting this call. We hope this practice continues in future. Thank you for spending time with us. First question, on overall employee cost. So, since the last few years, it's been steady around 10 | Page

2,000, 2100 crores a year. Can you guide us? How are we looking at it, over the next one to two

years? And in terms of annual retirements, etc., how are we positioned?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Employee cost will remain at the same level about Rs.2,000 to Rs.2,100 crores. And, in these nine months, you must have seen that the employee cost has come down by about Rs.150 crores. That is because of the onetime provision we have made for, non-executive PRP. So that's why this Rs.150 crores expenditure has come down. But our employee cost will remain more or less in the same range of Rs.2,100 to Rs.2,200 even after its expansion.

Sumangal: Understood. So annually, how many employees, what is the employee account trend, in terms of retirement, over the next two years?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: In the next two years, about 200 employees will be retiring. Next five years. Each year about 40.

Sumangal: Understood. That's helpful. Sir, on the coal sourcing thing, just continuing on the previous question, in the first nine months, have we completed these 3 million tons, which we are expecting this year, or it is distributed, coming also in the fourth quarter? And, so can you give us the mix of the coal sourcing currently in the nine months?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Yeah. Coal sourcing this nine months, just one time giving you. Yeah. 49% we have sold through linkage, 4% through e-auction, and the balance 47% is captive.

Sumangal: Okay. And, sir, next year, if you're doing 4 million tons, then out of seven, four million tons would be captive and three would be linkage. Right?

Bijendra Pratap: No. See, it will be 50-50 only because our machinery or our technology wants that, a mix of 50-50%. Otherwise, it is creating some problems in the process by using more of captive coal because of its quality. So, it has to be mixed 50-50% to have a right mix.

Sumangal: Understood. And, sir, so in between,

we were hearing that there could be an expansion of capacity from four to five and a half or something given some automatic approval of EC extension, is that not now currently on the annual?

Bijendra Pratap: 20% is if we achieve the target of 4 million tons, of 20% automatically, we can increase. That is around 80 lakhs or 80 thousand tons, we'll be able to increase. That will be coming in the subsequent years. If, next year, we'll do 4 million tons, then the subsequent year will be able to, further go to maybe 4.8 million tons.

Sumangal: Understood and, sir, what would be the cost difference between linkage and captive, or is it similar cost?

11 | Page

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Linkage and captive, there is a price difference of about 400 Rs. But linkage in any case, we are going to use. We should see the price advantage of not using e-auction and using Captive.

Sumangal: Yeah. But that is already behind us. Right? I mean, incrementally, we don't expect any further major reduction in cost on the coal front. Is that the right way to understand?

Bijendra Pratap: Right. Yes.

Sumangal: Understood. That's very clear. Sir, on the overall alumina volumes, currently, we have 2.1 million tons capacity. So, on a rated basis, our external sales can be up to 1.3 million tons also. But our current run rate is much lower. So, what should we expect for external alumina sales in the fourth quarter and then in FY26 without the new refinery?

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, for our smelter operation, we require around 0.9 to 1 million ton for the smelter. So, if out of 2.1 million tons, 1 million tons goes to the smelter. So, we are left with 1.1 million and that will be the figure, going for exports or maybe, domestic sales including major exports.

Sumangal: Okay and sir, just on the CAPEX, I mean, for this smelter, we will start spending from FY27. So, we are looking at, I think we said 17,000 plus, another 13 for the power plant. So, what sort of annual CAPEX could we see from FY 27 onwards?

Bijendra Pratap: If we see, in the initial year of, FY 2027, you are talking?

Sumangal: Yeah. That's right. When we start spending for the spending for the smelter

Bijendra Pratap: It will be around 15% because initially all drawings, approvals, and all that will be there. So maybe 10-15% of the total, whatever CAPEX will be there. And in the subsequent two, three years, it will be like 25% to 30%. The first year, it will be hardly 15% max.

Sumangal: Okay and smelter plus power would be around Rs.30,000 crores. Right? Is that the right understanding?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes.

Sumangal: Okay. And just one last question on the new refinery, which is coming up. So, we have a substantial amount of CAPEX still left and how confident are we of this commissioning by December, or should we expect some more delays? Because in the past, we've continuously seen delays because of some issues or the other. So, what sort of volumes and commissioning should we expect on a conservative basis?

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, as far as this refinery is concerned, after joining, I've been there two times, and I was there for two, three days, dealing with all the parties who are doing the job, and

12 | Page

I was very closely monitoring that. And, we have found that there are few packages, some delays

were there. We have also highlighted those things, and we are trying to take care of this September, we were targeting earlier. But by December, at least, we should try to finish off. And, whatever actions we are taking, we are confident enough by December, we will be finishing and starting the trials of the commissioning.

Sumangal: Okay. So, when do we expect commercial volumes? Is it FY27 then?

Bijendra Pratap: Commercial volume will start in the next three, four months, and we'll start the trials. Until maybe FY27, March, April onwards, the commercial v

olumes will start.

Sumangal: Okay and, sorry, just the last one. In this 2,000 CAP EX, what is our maintenance CAPEX for existing capacity, and how much is the growth CAPEX for all this future refinery and smelter expansion?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Rs.700 crores is for this and expansion is Rs.1,300 crores. Okay.

Sumangal: So, the Rs.700 to Rs.800 crores is something which will continue?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Yeah.

Sumangal: Understood. Thank you so much for patiently answering all the questions. All the best, sir. Yeah. Thank you.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: So, we'll take the next question from Pranay Khandelwal. Pranay, please go ahead.

Pranay Khandelwal: Hello? Yeah. Hi. Am I audible?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes.

Pranay Khandelwal: Yeah. Thank you for the opportunity. Congratulations on a great set of numbers. I think most of my questions have been answered. Just wanted to know, in this quarter, we have seen a higher depreciation than usual and also interest expense. So, is that a one off or should we expect it to be in that range only going forward?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Actually, we have, impaired to, wind power mill, at Rajasthan, for which the implication is 106 crores because we do not have the PPA right now. But we are injecting the power, whatever we are generating into the grid. We have a joint reconciliation also for that. We'll be getting that money in the future, but we are not accounting for it. So as per the accounting standard, we have, impaired both the plants. So that effect is 106 crores.

13 | Page

Pranay Khandelwal: Okay. And, also, this 13,000 crore that we have budgeted for the captive power plant for the new smelter expansion, so that'll be of what capacity?

Bijendra Pratap: Around 1,200 megawatts.

Pranay Khandelwal: 1,200 megawatts? Alright. And so, we are considering a JV with NTPC. So, will it be, like, a bigger power plant that both the companies will make and 1,200 megawatts will come to us, or will it be, like, 1,200 megawatts in total and then, some part of it will come to us?

Bijendra Pratap: Total will be 1,200 and that will be for captive use for that smelter only.

Whatever expansion we'll be doing, that will be for captive use.

Pranay Khandelwal: So, the JV with NTPC will just entail that I like, just wanted to understand what will be the role of NTPC in that.

Bijendra Pratap: JV with NTPC is just in the initial phase of our negotiations with NTPC. We had an MOU earlier. And, maybe how much partnership and all that that will be residing in the coming times. Yes. We are starting the negotiations and all that with them.

Pranay Khandelwal: Okay. And this will be a coal-based power plant?

Bijendra Pratap: It will be a coal-based power plant, but out of, 1,200 megawatts, actually, in the JV, we'll be putting one condition, because in the new regulatory norms, it is coming that 30% of the total power should be green power. So, we still have not finalized the capacities and all that. Maybe 30% will be going for green power. If we are able, NTPC is able to source the green power or maybe some other green power is available somewhere, so we will reduce the coal-based power plant capacity. Maybe it will become around 700 or 800 and the rest of the green power will be taken. So that will come out after the final discussions with NTPC.

Pranay Khandelwal: Okay. Alright. And, yeah. I think that'll be all. Thank you.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: We'll take the next question from Rajesh Malinda.

Rajesh Malinda: Yeah. Am I audible?

Shweta Dikshit: Yes.

Rajesh Malinda: Yeah. Good afternoon, sir. This is Rajesh Malinda from B & K Securities. So, thanks for the opportunity. I had a couple of questions. What is the current cost of production of alumina, in dollar per ton, and what is the current cost of production of aluminium assuming the alumina is transferred at the cost of product

ion in dollar per ton?

14 | Page

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: The cost of production of alumina ranges from 21,000 to 22,000 based on the prices of raw material. Presently, it is covering around that 22,000. And aluminum also, it

varies from 1,60,000 to 1,65,000.

Rajesh Malinda: This is based on alumina being transferred at cost. Right?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Pardon, please?

Rajesh Malinda: This is based on alumina being transferred at the cost price. Right?

Srimanta Panda: Yes. Yes. At cost price.

Rajesh Malinda: Okay. So, my question was that, sir, your cost of alumina has gone up over the years. At one stage, it used to be nearly \$170, \$180. Now if you look at that conversion, it is now almost close to, what, \$240, \$250 per ton. So, with the new, I understand that the Panchpatmali mines are requiring much more, consumption of, raw materials, etcetera, to make the same ton of alumina. So, with the Pottangi mines in operation, will we see a reduction in the cost of production? Hopefully, because those mines are very old, and these are new mines where the cost of production should be lower. That was the first question.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Cost of production of bauxite you are talking about?

Rajesh Malinda: Alumina.

Bijendra Pratap: Alumina. The cost of production of Alumina, whatever is presently there, will be almost the same because, over the years, what you are saying, like, earlier, it was \$180. Now it is around \$240, \$250. The increase is due to the increase in the, maybe employee cost or, some other raw material cost. And whatever bauxite cost we are getting is now around, thousand Rs. thousand per bauxite cost. So, they are also in Pottangi also, the cost of bauxite mining will be around thousand tons, what we are estimating. So, it will remain almost the same, which is at the present level.

Rajesh Malinda: No. So, because the mines are new, won't the quantum of cost required per ton of alumina go down, in the new mines?

Bijendra Pratap: Specific requirement of bauxite will be slightly less will be slightly less because now, it is, on the higher side because of some quality issues. But we like to see once we start the mindset. It is still now we cannot say.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: But with the new technology, we'll be saving about 6 to 7 kg of caustic soda. Some cost of that will be saving.

Bijendra Pratap: We will lower. Yes. How much impact will be there? Because, in this new refinery, the existing refinery may whatever caustic soda consumption is there, that will go down. That maybe, reduce the cost of Alumina. Maybe, overall caustic soda cost, whatever, now it is there. Maybe, it will be reduced by 700 Rs. it will be 500 to 700 Rs. That alumina cost will come down by around?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: No. But the depreciation cost will be added, sir, because we have no depreciation cost. Yes. Total cost will be added to the same range.

Bijendra Pratap: Depreciation cost will be adding.

Rajesh Malinda: So, when you give a cost of 240, you're including the depreciation. This 2122 k includes depreciation cost, is it?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Yes.

Rajesh Malinda: And even in aluminum, 161165 includes the depreciation cost?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Yeah. This is the total cost.

Rajesh Malinda: Okay. Including the savings. Okay. That's useful. But 600 to 700 Rs. per ton will be the saving on the raw material cost. That's what you are saying.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: That will be saving, and, also, there will be substantial savings in employee cost because employees will not increase proportionately. So, there will be major savings from employee costs also.

Rajesh Malinda: Right. So that's useful. And secondly, sir, I was curious about how you would expand the hot metal capacity because I understand we have 960 odd ports, which are now, like, in a configuration with 1,200-megawatt captive power. So how is it possible to increase the

capacity there by one lakh tons or something? How and on what, is the technical, you know, possibility of that happening?

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, that was a thought process. When I joined, and I was going through all the plants and all the details, I thought that our metal capacity is 0.5 million ton, and our casting capacity is around, 0.6 million tons. Hot metal is 0.45-1.5 lakh tons gap. So, we have requested EIL to make a study. It cannot come, as it is. We'll have to do some investment, maybe adding some pots and increasing maybe some captive power also. With small investment, we can have this increase in the capacity of the total overall cast metal. And because, for that, our alumina supply and maybe downward, casting facilities are already there. Only a number of pots will be required to be added. Of course, we'll have to take some CAPEX for that. We have engaged EIL to do some study and suggest what can be done. The second option is maybe taking in some scraps. If we get good quality scrap, we'll try to source, and that scrap adds to the casting. Along with the hot metal, we can increase the casting capacity. These are the two options which we are working on. These are just the initial thought process, because, whatever casting facilities there,

we're not able to use that. We are trying to see what way we can go, maybe short term, medium term, long term. So that to maximize the use of existing casting facilities. But whatever expansions we are planning, that will go as it is.

Rajesh Malinda: That's useful, sir. And so, my last question is for the smelter and CPP CAPEX. Will the company be taking on debt? Because historically, we've had zero debt, across all our expansions, but the alumina refinery is a very small investment. And Smelter and CPP is a substantially larger commitment. So, will we be changing our capital structure for that? That was my last question.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: We have to go for leveraging, definitely. We have to go for debt.

Rajesh Malinda: So, do we have any debt equity ratio in mind for the new project? Any ballpark idea of that?

Srimanta Panda: No. It could take a ballpark figure then, for this kind of capital intensive industry, for a gestation period of four years. So, and with our continuous internal revenue, then this one, we can afford to have 70-30. No issue with that. And, if we are ending the FY with more than 17,000 or 17,500 net worth, the company will be in a very good position to finance the entire CAPEX up for, metal and, power plant expansion through external financing.

Rajesh Malinda: Okay, sir. Thank you so much.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you

Shweta Dikshit: We'll take the next question from Ajit Darda.

Ajit Darda: Hello?

Shweta Dikshit: Yes, Ajit. Go ahead.

Ajit Darda: Yes. Good afternoon. Thank you for the opportunity. I warmly welcome our new CMD sir to Nalco. We are long shareholders of Nalco, and congratulations on a good set of results, sir.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you. Yes

Ajit Darda: Very heartening to know that we are coming up with this presentation and investor con-call, and I sincerely hope that we will continue this, and present a good governance. Sir, my question is regarding the CAPEX that you have just mentioned. Firstly, on the captive power plant, of 1,200-megawatt, 13,000 crore is, looking very steep. So, how should we understand this? And, if we combine the half a million capacity of the smelter also, so 17,000 crores for smelter, 13,000 crores for captive power plant by investing 30,000 crores, how much incrementally we are going to earn per year? That's my first question, sir.

17 | Page

Bijendra Pratap: That will be, we'll be adding around five lakh tons of metal production. That will be the main year, and the revenue generation will be around, it will be increasing the revenue generation overall by, around 11,000 to 12,000 crores.

Srimanta Pan

da: Sir. Can I contribute?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes, you contribute.

Srimanta Panda: More importantly, Nalco has been in the primary metal plaque team now. With this addition of 5 lakhs metric ton, it will give us space to get into extrusion and other value-added downstream products, which will be much more immune to LME fluctuation. That is also another most important factor. Because there, the margin is well protected from LME cycles. That, leverage, we are not having as of now with only 4.6 lakhs ton.

Ajit Darda: I just really appreciate this clarification, sir. So, I just wanted to have a better understanding. What are our internal projections? How much IRR or return would we be generating by investing these 30,000 crores? It's over a period of time. So, annually, 5000 to 600 EBITDA, incremental EBITDA?

Srimanta Panda: Since the earlier DPR, we had prepared in 2019 what with AP 500. Now, CMD sir will be visiting, and we will be going for the latest technology that is available, which will be still expected to be more cost efficient, more energy efficient, and, environment, sustainability. So that, again, has to be revisited. And with our we are also trying for further coal mines if we are going for this. So that projection will be revisited with all the updates.

Ajit Darda: Any plans to bid for the bauxite, ore mine additional bauxite?

Bijendra Pratap: Additional this bauxite, whatever, bauxite mines we are getting, Pottangi mines, actually, that will be sufficient for next 15 to 20 years because the reserve there is around, 20 million tons and 3.5 million tons which will be taking, that will be fitting to the, alumina whatever alumina refinery we are, going for, 1 million tons alumina refinery. So, this will be sufficient for feeding to our refineries for the next fifteen to twenty years. But whatever mines auctions are coming; we'll be going in for auctions.

Ajit Darda: What time do they increment?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes.

Ajit Darda: Yes, sir. So incremental EBITDA per ton, what would be the EBITDA per ton incremental for the new capacity, from the 0.5 million tons, which we are planning.

18 | Page

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, those financials have not been worked out till now in detail. Initial

feasibility report was given by EIL. Once all those technologies and your financials will be fixed, then only we'll be able to tell it. Okay?

Ajit Darda: Thank you, sir. Sir, one last question. Just on the captive work plan. So, my understanding was that 13,000 crores for a 1,200-megawatt CAPEX plan is very steep. So, is NTPC also going to invest in our JV?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes. When we'll be going for a joint venture, they will also be investing in that. So, and in these 13,000 crores, whatever is told was the initial projection, maybe when we'll be going with NTPC and maybe 20 to 30% of green power, this will be a gain, see some kind of changes in that.

Ajit Darda: Okay. Okay. And, this whole CAPEX of 13,000 crores, includes our proposed CAPEX for the value-added products as well. We won't be investing more for value added products. Right?

Ramesh Joshi: No. This is excluding value added products.

Ajit Darda: Excluding value. Okay. Okay. Thank you so much, sir. I'll get back in the queue.

Bijendra Pratap: Okay. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: We'll take the next question from Aditya. Please go ahead.

Aditya: Yeah. Thanks for this opportunity. I'm Aditya from Axis Securities. Most of my questions are answered. Just a couple, a few. So, on the alumina refinery, expansion, so from FY27 what kind of run rate in sales volume can we expect?

Bijendra Pratap: What kind of? Just you can repeat.

Aditya: The utilization of alumina refinery in FY27, how much sales volume can we expect from that directionally?

Bijendra Pratap: FY27, if we are going to reach our target by December, we'll be trying to start the commissioning process and end up in the next two, three

months. FY '27, we will be

targeting maybe 1 million tons capacity around, 60 to 70%. Around seven lakh tons, we'll be producing. Seven to eight lakh tons. It all depends on the commissioning, how fast we'll be doing the commissioning.

Aditya: So, will we be able to operate it at a rated capacity, right, for forty-five minutes?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes.

19 | Page

Aditya: Okay. And, we had a joint venture in Argentina for our lithium brine blocks. Any update on that? Anything material, which you can share?

Bijendra Pratap: You're talking about that, lithium in Argentina? Its KABIL. We have gone in for a joint venture. KABIL has been formed between NALCO, HCL, and MECL. Already, four mines have been allotted there by CAMYEN, which is a mining company of the state of Argentina. And, invasive exploration has started there. Noninvasive exploration has started there, wherein, the result of that noninvasive exploration will be coming this 25th March. After that, we are going in for appointment if we have already set up an office there also CEO, KABIL and all that, has been appointed. After March, we are going to appoint one, PMC consultant for the appointment of an invasive exploration partner, wherein the timelines are around 2026, maybe May, June will be completing the exploration. After that, one pilot plant study has to be done of whatever exploration results are coming. And, after that pilot plant study, maybe somewhere in mid-2027, we have to make a decision on doing the mining of those blocks depending on whatever the results of those explorations are coming. With your timeline, non-invasive exploration, we are completing March. After that, final exploration will take one year. After that, pilot study, then mining investment.

Aditya: So, anything related to CAPEX or any financial number or it's slightly premature at this stage, for this Financial?

Bijendra Pratap: Till now, it is very, early to state that because, it is just noninvasive, exploration is going on. Once the results of some noninvasive exploration come, then only we'll be able to know how much quantity and how much what grade of lithium and all that is available. So, it is very premature to tell anything about that.

Aditya: Okay. Understood. Thanks a lot. That's it from my side. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: So, can we take a couple of more questions, or if time permits?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes. Yes. We can ask two, three questions.

Shweta Dikshit: Sure, and we'll take the next question from Manav. Manav, please go ahead.

Manav Gogia: Oh, yes. Thank you for the opportunity, and I hope I'm audible first of all.

Shweta Dikshit: Yes. You're audible.

Manav Gogia: Yes. So, one question I wanted to ask was can you give me the landed cost of caustic soda for the particular quarter?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: It is 37,000 Rs. per ton.

20 | Page

Manav Gogia: Yeah. Okay. And, I think we just talked about the reserves and resources at Pottangi Mines. That was around 120 million tons. Could you give the latest number for Panchpatmali mines as well?

Srimanta Panda: It's about a 145 million is the balance.

Manav Gogia: Okay. Sure. I mean, since, you know, the rest of the questions have been asked already. So, that's all from my end. Thank you so much, and all the very best.

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit: Next question is from Saket Kapoor. Saket, please go ahead.

Saket Kapoor: Yeah. Thank you. Namaskar, sir, and thank you for the opportunity. Sir, I joined a bit late. A couple of questions. Firstly, with the capitalization of, I think, two of our projects, our depreciation cost has gone up to 2.86 crore for this quarter. So, if you could just highlight, this will be the run rate going ahead or, how much is still left to be capitalized for the fourth quarter?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: No. No. The fifth stream is yet to be capitalized. This depreciation cost has gone up

mainly because we have made an impairment provision of 106 crores for our wind power plant at Rajasthan. Because we don't have PPA, within Rajasthan. So, we have made an impairment provision of 106 crores. That's why depreciation is showing a higher value. There are no capitalizations as such. Major capitalizations happen from the fifth stream.

Bijendra Pratap: Stream capitalizations will start when the commissioning will start. The commissioning maybe will be starting, in September or December. After that, the capitalizations of the stream will start.

Saket Kapoor: Okay and so, what is then the closing balance of capital work in progress as on 31st December? Next point is about the current price trends for, alumina and the global market scenario. Sir, if you could just outline to us what factors are currently influencing the prices and going ahead with the tariff war issues...

Bijendra Pratap: You're talking about global alumina prices?

Saket Kapoor: Yes. Global alumina prices and the factors that are affecting the price trends, currently, sir.

Bijendra Pratap: Actually, these global alumina prices totally depend on demand supply equation. In between, the prices shifted up to \$800. That was just because there were some supply issues in Australia. Some plants of alumina were stopped, and few supply issues of bauxite from New Guinea were there. And now those plants have already started. So, as of now, in quarter one, quarter two, there was a demand supply gap of a round maybe five, six lakhs tons. 21 | Page

But as of now, if this quarter we see the demand supply gap is not there, whatever, demand requirement is there, the supply is almost matching. So, that is why, the prices have also started falling down, which has come down to the latest for prices around \$530. So it totally depends on the, what is the production and what is the supply and what is the demand. As far as US tariffs are concerned, the latest US tariffs have been imposed 25%. It can have some impact, maybe, some of the aluminum which was going inside the US, if that price goes up and that doesn't go into the US, maybe it will be coming to the other market, increasing the aluminum putting the pressure on the aluminum prices, reducing the aluminum prices.

Or maybe some of the smelters, we can see that this smelter, if it's not viable, and the prices are coming down, maybe some of the smelters will be closing down. And if some of the smelters are closing down, the requirement of alumina will also go down. So that will impact the alumina prices also. So, we like to just see because whatever tariffs have been imposed, final decision, still some it awaits what will be the fate of those tariffs. We're to see that, but, ultimately, alumina, because it cannot be stored for a long time. So whatever production is there, that has to be consumed. So whatever requirements from the smelters are there, whatever number of smelters are operating, demand supply is matching, all the prices will remain somewhere around, I think, \$450 to \$500, somewhere in between that itself.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: The CWIP, what you are asking for is about 4,500 crores.

Saket Kapoor: Okay. And, any project you'd capitalize it for the fourth quarter?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Fourth quarter? No. No major capitalization will come.

Saket Kapoor: And last point, sir, \$530 is what mentioned was the current prices, and you are expecting prices to trend between \$4.50 and \$500, for alumina going ahead. So, what was the average realization for us for quarter three in terms of the alumina that we have.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: \$641 was the realization in Q3.

Saket Kapoor: And answer the Tonnage? Two, three Tonnages?

Srimanta Panda: Nine months, it is \$562.

Bijendra Pratap: You are talking about Tonnage?

Saket Kapoor: Yes. A tonnage for the third quarter, and they expected tonnage for Q4. And the trend line, if you can give.

Bijendra Pratap: Third quarter tonnage was 3.75. So, alumina, export was 3.66 and domestic was 3.09. So total alumina sales were 3.75 million tons in the third quarter.

Saket Kapoor: How's Q4 trend? How much we will be expecting?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: About 4 lakhs will be there.

Saket Kapoor: And prices will be?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Prices will be around 600, I think.

Bijendra Pratap: Around 600 prices will be in Q4 also because a bit on spot booking this will affect will come in two, three months. And Q4 now, whatever is going will be the spot prices already booked earlier. So Q4 maybe also will be getting an average relation of around 600 plus.

Saket Kapoor: Okay. So, we are looking to close a year on a very high note, sir. Financially?

Bijendra Pratap: Yes.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Thank you so much. Thank you.

Saket Kapoor: Sir, Thank you very much to your whole team. May you keep up such arrangements for investor interactions, it will be our request.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Sure Sure. This will continue. Thank you so much.

Shweta Dikshit: So, can I take the next question?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Let us take last. Okay. We'll take the last.

Shweta Dikshit: Okay. Last question from Vikash. Vikash, please go ahead.

Vikash: Thank you for the opportunity. And, sir, congratulations on a very good set of numbers.

So just couple of questions. One clarification on the refinery CAPEX, we said about roughly about 5,700 crores, but we understood that there was a cost escalation in the cap. Total cost has already run closer to 7,000 crores. So, if you could clarify, that?

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: No. There is after cost escalation, this is the price, 5,700. Okay. And 7,000, what you are talking about, that is inclusive of Pottang mines. 7,500 is the total capital. Only the refinery, 5,700, which is after escalation.

Vikash: Understood. And just second question on the employee cost, how should we look at the employee cost because the pay commission is coming. So have you started taking some provision regarding the same or your expectation on the escalation in the employee calls going forward?

Bijendra Pratap: The pay commission will be coming after 2028.

Ramesh Chandra Joshi: Pay commission for CPSC has not yet been set up. It is for, central government that has been set up. For January 2027 only.

23 | Page

Srimanta Panda: January 2027 only. So maybe we'll. No provisioning has been made.

Vikash: Thank you for the clarification. That's all from my side, sir, and all the best for the future.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you. Thank you so much, sir. Any closing remarks from your side?

Bijendra Pratap: Thank you very much. First of all, I would like to congratulate the whole of the Nalco team and all the shareholders, all the stakeholders who have been supporting the company and all their performances, from all our supporters, all our investors. And we'd like to ensure that, in the coming time, our total priority will be fixed in two areas. That is how to increase the efficiency of the present operation, putting the focus on the future of expansions. As far as our present operations are concerned, two, three areas we are focusing on are, including the volumes. Whatever volumes we are doing this year; we are trying to increase the volume next year maybe by 5% to 10%. Smelter, it will not be possible, but, of course, the refinery will try to increase the volumes by doing some modifications there and reducing the cost. And, also, one area we are working that is, to increase some value added and maybe alumina and maybe our, aluminum production, some of the value added products to add on as a short term or medium term, so that our existing operations, we increase our revenues, increase our profitability so that whatever expansions will be coming in the coming time, we'll be, able to fund our expansions in an easy manner. And expansions already

we have explained whatever as per plan to keep an eye on expansion and put a, a very active year, role in completing all this alumina expansion and going in for a smelter expansion. Thank you once again for all your questions, all your queries, and all your support provided by everyone. Thank you. Thank you very much.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you, sir. Thank you.

Bharat Kumar Sahu: Thank you. We are thrilled to see a large number of participants, which at one point of time topped a hundred. So that showed your keen interest, of all this, our esteemed analyst, and the investors, in Nalco and its futuristic plans. And we'll look forward to a similar kind of response in future also. Thanks once again, and particularly to Shweta Ma'am, and Hinal Ma'am, for organizing this session. Thank you.

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■■■■■/Dated: 29.05.2025

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Sub: Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 22.05. 2025.

■■■■■ /Dear Sir,

Further to our letter dated 22.05.2025 and pursuant to Regulation 30 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, enclosed please find the transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 22.05.2025 for discussions on Company's business and outlook post declaration of Audited Financial Results for 4th Quarter and year ended 31st March, 2025. Neither any Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI) was shared during the aforesaid Earnings Conference Call nor is mentioned in the enclosed transcripts. This is for your information and record.

■■■■■/Thanking you.

■■■■■/ Yours faithfully,

■■ ■■ ■■■■■ ■■ ■■■■■■■ ■ ■■■■ ■■■■■ ■■

For National Aluminium Co. Ltd.
(■
■. ■ ■ . ■■■š)/(B. K. Sahu)
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Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
ACS: 9953
Encl.: As above

1 | PageTranscript – Q4 Earnings Con ference Call held on 22.05.2025
Sh
weta Dixit :

Good morning everyone. On behalf of the Systematics Group, we welcome you to the 4Q FY25 Earnings Conference Call of NALCO Limited. We're joined today by Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, Chairman-cum-Managing Director and Director (Finance) and other Functional Directors of the company, along with Mr. Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary, to discuss the company's financial and operational performance for 4QFY25 and FY25. I would like to thank the management for giving us an opportunity to host this call. At the end of the presentation, we will open the floor for questions and participants can raise their hands if they wish to ask a question. Now I request Mr. Bharat Sahu for his opening remarks and introduction of the management team. Over to you, Sir.

Bharat Sahu :

Yeah, good morning Shweta and good morning all our esteemed shareholders, analysts and all the participants in this conference. So, in fact it's a good morning after a great evening. NALCO posted a very good result, stupendous results last evening. And I am sure all our esteemed shareholders must have gone through the results. In my opening remark, before we formally start, let me start in a different way. All must be knowing Sergey Bubka, the pole vaulter from Russia had once said – "I make records and I also

break records." For us, Nalco is also following the same path. Nalco is creating records and also breaking its own records. And the last result, yesterday's results, i.e., FY 24-25 result, is a testimony of that one. So, with this back note, I don't want to take more time. Let me first introduce all our management and the functional directors attending this conference call. On the extreme left is Shri Srimanta Panda, our EPO-ED (Finance). Sitting next to him, is Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak, our Director (HR). And next to him is Shri Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial). Sitting in the centre is our CMD and Director (Finance), Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh Sir and to my right, it is Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production) and next to him, Shri Ja

gdish Aro ra, Director (Projects & Technical). Before we start taking questions from our esteemed shareholders, we would like to have a brief presentation and I would request my colleague, Mr. Subha Purohit, to kindly make a brief presentation and then we'll start taking questions from the participants' side. Thank You.

Subha Purohit :

Thank you Sir. I'm Subha Purohit from Nalco. I'm just starting the presentation. Good morning to all. This has been a historic quarter and an historic year.

[Inaudible Voice]

Shweta Dikshit :

Sir, the voice is not audible or can you please come closer to the mike.

2 | Page

Subha Purohit :

Okay. Now it's audible?

Shweta Dikshit :

Yes it's better sir.

Subha Purohit :

Okay so I'm starting again. So, it has been a historic quarter and a historic year for the company. The company has recorded its highest ever financial performance, be it the revenue, the PAT, the margins. I am starting the presentation with this background, and this is a standard disclaimer. The agenda will consist of a brief on the company, its operations. Then I'll go through the financials and a bit of the industry outlook. So, when you see your company, it's one of the most integrated Bauxite-Alumina-Aluminium-Power-Coal complex. Its integrated raw materials are secured. And we're also one of the lowest cost producers of bauxite and alumina in the world. As per our capacity, all our capacities are given here. Bauxite mines, we're having 2 operating leases, the Panchpatmali central & north block and south block. Then our alumina refinery capacities, smelter capacities, were integrated with our captive power. Recently, we've started our coal production from our coal mines. And it is happy to note that in this concluding year, we've got licenses for the combined Utkal D&E coal mines with a capacity of 4 million tonnes. Then we have our dedicated port facilities; and we're having 198 MW, 4 Wind Power plants at different locations of the country, in Rajasthan 2 Wind Power plants are there, in Andhra Pradesh, there is 1, and in Maharashtra there is 1. Coming to the financial components of the quarter, all figures are given here.

Coming to the Physical components of the quarter, all figures are given here. As far as the highlights are concerned, we've achieved highest-ever domestic metal sales in this year and in the quarter as well. And for production, we have achieved highest ever thermal power production this year. And all our production units are operating at almost 100% capacity.

The financial results are published and it's well highlighted. I think everybody will discuss at the end of the presentation about the financial performance. We've achieved the highest ever revenue, highest ever profit as well as margin for the year and for the quarter.

We've achieved the highest ever revenue, highest ever PAT, highest ever margin and also the highest ever dividend in the history of the company. Coming to the LME price trend, this has been a very volatile period since the end of the financial year after the announcement of the tariffs structure by the US government. Earlier the LME prices were about 2600 dollars, but since the announcement in April, it has reduced to 2300 dollars.

3 | Page

But again now the 90 days pause has been announced by US tariffs to all countries and recently for China as well. The trade negotiations are going on. So right now the price has recovered from the bottom and settled about \$ 2,450/ tonne. So still the market is unsure and uncertain. They are looking to the upcoming developments on the negotiations and it will change the market in the future. There are some other cases also like smelter

restarts, The US FED interest rate in pause mode right now as they are thinking about the rising inflation concern and inflation concern and correction in alumina prices as well

So these are all setting the alumina market pattern.

Coming to global industry outlook, the global GDP growth which the IMF has predicted in the earlier January 2025, since then the outlook has been slightly reduced, and the reduction is only because of the tariff related developments. So the global economy is expected to grow by 2.8% in 2025, then 3% in 2026. As far as the aluminium sector is concerned, the aluminium sector is expected to grow at 1.5% from FY 2024-25 to FY 25-26. And the market is likely to stay in a slight deficit like when you say 24-25, the deficit was about 1 million tonnes. In 25-26, it is projected to be at about 0.7 million tonnes. The Aluminium market, the supply side concerns have eased in recent times, as there are production enhancements in Australia and other areas. So in the Alumina sectors, the projections are likely to be at little bit on the surplus side which will determine the prices of both alumina and aluminium.

Coming to the Indian economic scene, India is being seen as the fastest economy in the world. The country is likely to grow at about 6.5%-7% in the next year. The Aluminium sector is progressing very well. The Aluminium demand is rising at about 9 to 10% and it is likely to grow more. The predictions are showing that all the sectors, the transportations, building constructions, electrical, there's possibility of huge scale growth in these sectors in India specifically and by 2030, the CAGR growth will be about 6.5% to 7%, and the consumption of Aluminium is likely to rise to about 7.5 to 8 million tonnes per annum. These are the major business highlights of the company. I am reiterating again. We're having the most integrated operation in the aluminium industry starting from bauxite mines to aluminium smelting supported by captive power plant in our own complex. And we're a zero-debt company, which gives us leverage to fund our expansion projects. We're having raw materials, securities for Caustic soda also. For caustic soda we're having a JV company with GACL, which is known as GNAL. Then for coal, we are having our own captive mines. We're having projects in our refinery sites, where the refinery expansion of 1 million tonne is going on.

Then further we have planned to set-up a brownfield expansion of smelter and we are having a global presence in our products. Currently for our Bauxite Mines, we have already signed a lease deed for Potangi Bauxite Mines with a capacity of 3.5 million tonnes per annum, having a reserve of 111 million tonnes per annum, which will give us security of Bauxite in long term. The mine is expected to be opened by the end of this year. Coming to Alumina Refinery, the project is progressing well at the moment. And the

4 | Page

capacity will be increased by 1 million tonnes per annum. And we're projecting the mechanical completion to be completed by this year's end and the commercial operation may likely start next year. For the Aluminium Smelter, our project has been approved, the planning process is going on and the capacity is 0.5 million tonnes per annum and it is expected to end by the year end of FY 2030. And supporting the aluminium smelter will be the Captive Power Plant, with a 1080 MW capacity.

Apart from our operations and business we equally emphasize on our environmental commitments. Our mining operations are sustainable. We have been rated 5-star rating from Ministry of Mines. The key initiatives we take are: Afforestation, waste utilisation, advanced pollution control technologies for water pollution and air pollution. The bauxite mines at Panchpatmali where we are having a 14.6 kms long, state-of-the-art, single flight, multi curve belt conveyor which is environment friendly, eliminating the road mode of transportation. And also, we're installing a second conveyor of 7.9 kms long which will give our environmental initiative

a boost. The other details are also shown here on the figures related to our environment. Specifically, we're operating a 198 MW Wind Power Plant. From there, we've generated 281 million units in the year 24-25. Further, we're setting up another 15 MW wind power in Tamil Nadu. In the case of Solar also, we're planning to set up 7 MW in the coming years.

The company believes in the philosophy of "Growing Together". With great concern for the society, wherever our operating units are located, we're putting equal importance on our CSR activities. We have CSR flagship schemes on various factors like education, health, rural development projects. Some of the flagship schemes shown here are the

Indradhanush, which sponsors tribal children from Koraput district in the private residential schools. Then we have 'Nalco Ki Ladli' scheme where, we sponsor girl child from BPL families to support their education; then we also operate Mobile Health Units at our operating locations in Angul, Damanjodi and Pottangi, where more than 1 lakh patients are treated every year. Also, we carry multiple social and rural development projects like roads, drainage, drinking water systems, school infrastructure etc.

The company has been rated excellent as part of the assessment as per the DPE guidelines. Wherein 10 Board Level Committees for the ESG governance, 15 Policies & Guidelines for ESG Governance, and we are putting equal importance as per Govt. of India guidelines to follow our governance.

So thank you all.

Shweta Dikshit :

Thank You. We will now move on to the question and answer session. We've a first question from Mr. Kamlesh Bagmar. Sir, please unmute yourself.

Kamlesh Bagmar :

Yeah sir, thanks for the opportunity and congratulations on very strong set of numbers. So just one question on the part of realisation. So what were the realisations for alumina

5 | Page
in this quarter and how do you see going forward in Q1 and if you can give some output on the Q2 as well?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

You're asking about Q1 ?

Kamlesh Bagmar :

Yeah I'm asking about the Q4 and Q1

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Q4 realisation of alumina was, the NSR was around \$600 and our cost of production was 22000 and we were getting around 50000. Realisation was around maybe 20000- 25000 realisation was there. Net sales realisation was around \$600 in Q4. Now in Q1, the net sales realisation which we are getting is around \$400. The last spot price was around \$400.

Kamlesh Bagmar :

Okay. \$400. and for the quarter we would be seeing as an average \$400?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Average two spot tender were at 350\$ also, it has slightly improved. We're expecting that maybe it'll be stabilising around 400\$.

Kamlesh Bagmar :

What is the timeline for our alumina capacity expansion? When it will get commissioned?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Alumina capacity expansion in our earlier timeline, which we've committed was September this year. But some of the few of the packages are getting delayed due to some of the local issues and some other inevitable issues so, we are expecting to finish off all the packages by January or February 2026. After that the commissioning will start, commissioning itself takes around 2-3 months or 4 months. So, commercial production maybe will be starting in May or June 2026.

Kamlesh Bagmar :

Okay and lastly sir, I missed on the figure regarding the cost of production in this quarter for alumina. How do you see the cost in the Q1?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : As far as the cost is concerned, our present alumina cost is around 22000, we expect the cost will be in the same level. It will further reduce maybe by 1,000 rupees or 2,000 rupees, because this year, we are trying to improve our efficiencies by reducing, like, caustic soda consumption. Caustic soda is

contributing around 20% of the total cost of the Alumina. So, for Caustic Soda we have targeted around 111 kg for per ton of Alumina, which was earlier around 120 kg in the previous years. Even when we are doing better than that, that will give some advantage, even power cost, if we get some of our internal coal and be able to send the internal coal

6 | Page
there that will reduce our power costs by around 20%, 30% of the cost of the Alumina is power cost, including coal and power, everything. That will also... So, our target is, at least, we should reduce the cost by around 1,000 or 1,500, 2,000 rupees.

Kamlesh Bagmar :

And for the current quarter, it was Rs. 25,000?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Uh, from the current quarter, it is hovering around Rs. 22,000.

Kamlesh Bagmar :
Okay, thanks a lot, sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Thank you

Shweta Dikshit :

Thank you. We'll take the next question for Mr. Aditya. Please unmute yourself and go ahead

Aditya A. :

Yeah, thank you, and congrats for the great set of numbers.

So my question is with respect to our 5

th stream of Alumina Refinery. So, in the previous

call, you indicated that in FY27, we are targeting production of 7 to 8 lakhs, which comes from that, 5th stream of refinery. So, does that still hold?

And, on the same similar lines, what is the remaining CAPEX on that, and how much of the project is completed as of now?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : As far as commercial production is concerned, our plan is to start the commercial production by maybe May or June of 2026, that is FY27. So, we will be targeting more than maybe 5 to 6 lakhs in the next financial year. CAPEX, already we have spent around, as Director (P&T) will tell, around \$3,500.

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T): Yeah. We have completed around 75% of our financial commitment.

So it is remaining 25%. So, as our CMD is telling, we'll be completing in the first few months of next year, and we'll start the production in the next financial year.

Aditya A. : Yeah, understood, that's helpful. And second, Sir, any guidance on third-party alumina sales, external sales? Because this figure is slightly volatile on a quarter-on-quarter basis, so for a full-year fiscal 2026, if you can guide how will be the alumina sales to the external market?

7 | Page

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

As far as sales is concerned, Alumina, of course. Some few refineries are coming in Indonesia, in China, the refinery capacity is expanding. So, external sales, till now, we are depending. I think 90-95% of our sale is going to the export market. Now, we have to have few of the customers, we are thinking to go for domestic sale also, because our alumina production will increase. This year, we have increased the target for our domestic sales to around 50 to 80,000, which was very less last year. So, the domestic market, we are seeing. Export market, of course, the challenge will be there, with increase in the alumina availability in the market.

Aditya A. :

Understood. Just one last question on the brownfields smelter expansion, so, in the earlier call, you indicated that the CAPEX will start flowing from FY27, And total CAPEX figure of 17,000 crores. So, does that still hold? And also in the earlier call, the JV with NTPC for the captive power plant was 1200MW, but in the presentation, that figure is now 1080MW. So, what am I missing here?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : CAPEX, you are talking about the smelter expansion?

Aditya A. : Yes,.....Smelter expansion.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Smelter expansion, already earlier, we had made a DPR for that. Our plan was to go ahead with that DPR, and that was met with RTAL Technology. But RTAL now is not willing to give up their technology. So, again, we are revisiting it. Our team

is going to Dubai. So, we have given EIL a target to give DPR in the next 6 to 8 months. And after that, we'll be going in for tendering. Our target is the next one, one and a half years to finish off the tendering activity. And if it completes by

the end of last year, then, actual commissioning and all that will take 3 to 4 years. That is the plan for smelter. As far as the power plant is concerned, we had already tied up earlier with NTPC, but, NTPC model, they are insisting on making 600x2 capacity power plants, but our requirement is 270x4. That's why we are going in for tendering, for appointing the consultant. The consultant will be appointed. And parallelly this will also go along with the smelter. Aditya A. :

Yeah, so you're saying that, the 17,000 crores earlier CAPEX guidance that you will finalize later on, 1200 MW is now...the need is only 1080 MW.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : This 17,000 crore was for smelter expansion. And along with that, 12,000 crore for CPP, combined at around 30,000. This CAPEX will start flowing in maybe FY 2026-27, it will not come. Around FY 2027-28, the CAPEX will start coming.

8 | Page

Aditya A. : Understood. Thanks a lot Sir. I will get back to you.

Shweta Dikshit :

Thank you. We'll take the next question from Mr. Digant Haria.

Digant Haria :

Yeah, thank you for the opportunity. Sir, my question is that, you know, around last time, we were thinking that the Alumina prices will probably settle around \$500, but, you know, we've seen very sharp corrections in the alumina prices. So, if you can just explain globally what has happened, because refineries cannot come overnight. Like, we are taking 6 to 7 years to make the new Alumina refinery. The refineries cannot come overnight, so if you can explain what has happened on the bauxite supply side, because, last year, we were all saying that, Guinea has probably reached pre-production, and bauxite supplies are tight. And which is why Alumina prices are high. So if you can just explain the demand-supply scenario here on the alumina. That would be great, Sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

Actually, what is happening, the Alumina capacities this year, a few of the refineries are getting added up in Indonesia, where the refinery is coming up, it is getting commissioned. In India also, Vedanta is adding up their capacity. And the smelter capacity in China, a few of those smelters are closed down. In other areas also, some of the smelters are not picking up. The smelter capacity is not picking up. That's why there is excess availability of alumina. That's why we are seeing...overall what we were thinking, that it will come around \$500, has gone down to around \$400. So, we are expecting the same will continue, maybe it will go up to maybe in between \$400 to \$450.

As far as bauxite is concerned, bauxite is locally available, but we know, globally, most of the bauxite is supplied by New Guinea, and sometimes there are disruptions from there, from New Guinea, few of the disruptions last year were there. Due to which the aluminum production was affected. But this year again, a few days back, New Guinea have announced that they will not be supplying bauxite to EGA. Again, AGA is trying to consolidate with them. So, globally, that is a challenge, because one country is supplying around 60-70% of the bauxite to the rest of the world. So any policy decision, policy changes in the New Guinea may affect the Bauxite supply to the other Alumina Refineries across the world. Anything you would like to add up?

Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial): And one thing I would like to add, that the figure, what you were telling, that last year it had gone to very high prices; that all depends on not only the demand-supply scenario, it depends on the geopolitical issues also. You remember a lot of geopolitical issues were faced last year,

so this type of spike

in the prices do happen, and then these normalize. Actually, that always happens in a cyclic manner.

9 | Page

Digant Haria : All right. Thank you, that's a lot of details, so thank you so much. Sir, my second question is just one clarification. We said that our cost of alumina production was Rs. 22,000 a ton, so around \$260. Is that number right?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Somewhere around that. It depends on the caustic soda prices and analog prices. Keeps on fluctuating, but somewhere around that.

Digant Haria : Okay, and Sir, what would be a similar number for aluminum production?

Like, you know, based on all the current prices?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Aluminum, if you see, our cost of production last year, average was around Rs. 1.6 lakhs per ton.

Digant Haria : Okay, got it. Sir then, lastly, on this coal mining, this Utkal block, what is our total coal requirement, and what is the peak that we can mine from the Utkal block, and where are we right now versus that... on the coal bit?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

Our total coal requirement for our power plant is around 7.2 million tonnes. Out of that, our Utkal D capacity is 4 million tonnes. Last year, we had mined around 2.8 million tonnes. This year, we will be reaching 4 million tonnes. We'll be reaching to the rated capacity of both Utkal D & E combined, and rest of the coal which is required around 3.2 million tonnes, that will be sourced from Coal India, through linkage option.

Digant Haria :

Oh, okay, okay. And Sir, just one follow-up on this. The Coal India price, you know the FSA price that we'll get from Coal India and our own mining costs, is there a reasonable savings that we do because we mine our own coal?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

Yeah, there is a difference in Coal India prices, which we are getting, must be around 1800-1900, or 2000. The linkage goal is around 2,000. And our goal is, which we are mining from Utkal D, it is around 1500 to 1600. Around, 300 to 400 per ton difference is there.

Digant Haria : Okay Sir. Thank you so much Sir. All the best

Shweta Dikshit : We'll take the next question from Mr. Amit Lahoti.

10 | Page

Amit Lahoti :

Hi, good morning. Thanks for the opportunity, and congratulations on a great set of numbers.

My first question is on employee cost, which has declined by 12 % in FY25, so.... What are the drivers here? Has the absolute headcount reduced, or is there any other cost saving on the employee side, that we have achieved?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO :

Absolute head cost has reduced. The retirement was around 250 separations...430 separations and few inductions we have done, new trainees we have taken. Maybe 200 gap was there, that has caused the reduction in the employee cost.

Amit Lahoti :

Can we expect that we can sustain this year as well?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Yes, yes. This year also, every year, we'll be reducing our employee by around 250 numbers per year. That is the retirement that is going to happen and recruitment, we will not be doing that much. Accordingly, we will try to manage with the lean employees.

Amit Lahoti :

Okay, and my second question is on refinery delay. So, last quarter, we were indicating this December 2025 completion. Now it has changed to May-June 2026. So, what has changed in the last 3 months that has led to this 6 months of delay?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : There has been some delays, in 2 or 3 packages. Some local issues where there, in the supply of laborers, some local issues, some local resistance where, because it is a tribal area, Koraput area. So, many times, many resistances come. We are trying to overcome those issues.

Of course, a lot of support from district administration and all is also there. Now, everything is picked up, nothing is under stress

mate. So, we are thinking just maybe...

because December was the completion time, after that, it takes around 2-3 months for

commissioning also, refinery commissioning also takes 2-3 months. Maybe, that will get shifted to 2-3 months ahead.

Amit Lahoti :

But how confident are we that we will be able to hold the current timeline of, say, May-June 2026? Can there still be a further delay, or, like, we are very confident that, okay, this will definitely come by May-June?

11 | Page

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO :

We are very closely monitoring every week. We are having our own monitoring mechanisms and all that, and all packages we are monitoring at a very close level, and the kind of resource allocation is there in all the packages. In a few of the packages, the resource allocation was not proper. So now that has increased. Even with a few packages, some issues were there, like rock cutting and all those issues. We have taken the permission from blasting and the blasting has started, which has expedited the packages. So, we are confident enough that next May-June, we will be able to start the production from there.

Amit Lahoti :

Okay sure thank you

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Thank you

Shweta Dikshit:

We will take the next question from Saket Kapoor.

Saket Kapoor:

Yeah. Namaskar Sir. And thank you for this opportunity.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO :

Namaskar

Saket Kapoor:

Sir, firstly, we have this capital work is in progress, closing balance of closer to Rs 4,950 crores. So if you could just provide us input on the closing... on how many projects are these, and this includes the one which is getting delayed by 6 months. So, if you could just quantify what amount is attributed towards that refinery expansion that is getting delayed by 6 months? And also, Sir, if you could give us an understanding of the tonnages we have done for our Alumina for this quarter. And what have been, outlined for the ensuing quarter, that is, Q1? Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO :

I would request my ED (Finance)...you will explain, or...?

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : Yeah, this work in progress of this 1 million ton refinery, which is coming with the better technology and better techno-economic parameters. That is, 75% we have progressed. And remaining 25%, once we reach 90 %, we will start closing the things. And, as it was told earlier, we will try to complete the project...mechanical completion by February or March, and then we will start commissioning the project. That takes, 3 months' time. And, from there onwards, we'll start the production.

12 | Page

Saket Kapoor :

I was just looking at the balance investment done...anyway...

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) :

Balance investment, I had covered it earlier. We have completed 75% of financial commitment. It is along with the project progress. So, only 25% of commitment is left. And, it is not going to increase our cost of the project. We are completing the project in the approved budget itself. Though time has increased, but the budget has not increased. I hope... I hope this is clear?

Saket Kapoor :

Yes Sir. Thank you Sir. On the tonnages part? Alumina tonnage?

We have done for Q4 the entire financial year, and what are we emphasizing for Q1?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Tonnage in terms of production, you're telling?

Saket Kapoor: Yes, Production and Sales. Sales would be more appropriate.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO: This year, we are planning the total yearly tonnage for Alumina is around 22, 50,000 tons. And sales we are planning, 1275...

Saket Kapoor:

And what was the comparable number for last year, sir?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO:

Last year, our alumina production was 20 lakhs, around 40-45,000. Around 2 lakhs, we'll be increasing alumina production, and similar amount of sales also. 2 lakhs will be the increase.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Production increment on hydro rate would be around 6% and Calcined Alumina it will be 10% and on metal front it will be 3% vis-à-vis of last year.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

In terms of tonnage if you see, it will be around 2 lakhs.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Yes

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO :

2 lakhs it will be tonnage, both production and sales.

13 | Page

Saket Kapoor :

And my last question is on the investment in the GNAL part, if you could just explain to us the note no. 7, exactly we have mentioned about 500 crores investment...

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) :

GNAL was going very bad condition, since commissioning, combined with multiple factors of high court...delay in commissioning, then unusual depressed caustic soda realisation and also negative realisation from chlorine, which is one of the major constant for any Chloro-organic industry of disposal of chlorine.

So, that has led to cumulative erosion of net worth and profit. So, leverages were totally destroyed, i.e. not any promoter is ready to infuse any equity. So, the best possible solution that was for going for a CCD.

Because that was not going to average the leverage also and it was giving a breathing time with expectation of more than 90-95% capacity utilisation, we will be able to come over. That is basically infuse, not only to provide working capital, but to particularly return the 100 million around which was contributing to exchange variation loss. So, that is why the CCD was taken to back-step arrangements from both the promoters with 40-60 ratio in the 5 year tenure that has been subscribed by one of the banker, then this end of 5 years, or even before that there can be accelerated...buy out option to be exercised by both the promoters and put option to exercise. So, that is the situation, after that there has been pre-payment of ...Further GNAL is negotiating for...whatever 41 million is remaining as of now.

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T):

I'll supplement what ED (Finance) has told. That the operation of GNAL was supposed to be 90% plus. And with this chlorine offtake some improvement, it has started coming in the operating profit area. If it continues for the 90% plus performance, which it has performed for the last 4-5 months, this will start coming into the operating profitability.

Saket Kapoor :

Okay, thank you sir, I've a couple of questions for which I will join the queue again' for my follow up, hope for an opportunity.

Shweta Dikshit :

Thank you. We'll take the next question from Mr. Pratim Roy.

Pratim Roy:

Thank you for the opportunity sir, and congratulations for the good set of numbers. My first question is that the aluminium prices for the quarter if you compare the Q & Q improvements, is very marginal. And volume is also there but our top line for the

aluminium segment has done significantly. So, can you please tell me what is the reason behind that ?

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Can you come up again, please?

Pratim Roy:

My question is that aluminium prices for the quarter to quarter basis has improved marginally and our volume has also improved. But overall top line growth is much more than that. So can you please quantify what is the drivers for that huge jump in the aluminium segment revenue.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Aluminium prices also have increased because last year, quarter wise if you see, the LME has gone upto maybe 2600 levels also. Now in this quarter you're saying it has gone down to \$2,350 also, now it is around \$2,450. So, LME has gone down in this quarter due to this trade war and restrictions in the duties. That is the main reason where we have a loss in realisation to aluminium. And whatever growth is there, growth was in the Alumina. Alumina, where we got the actual growth. As far as aluminum is

concerned, the growth was on the lesser side .

Pratim Roy :

Okay Sir, and can you please tell me the guidelines for FY2026 & 27 CAPEX? How much do we spend on CAPEX for FY 26 & 27?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO: For FY 26-27, our CAPEX target is around Rs. 1700 crores.

Pratim Roy : Each year or for both the years ?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO: For this year it will be Rs. 1700 crores.

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : For next year it will be Rs. 2000 crores

Pratim Roy : And sir could you please give us the guideline of the depreciation site as our project got delayed and it is in FY27. So for FY 26, depreciation will be the single line of FY25 and 27, it'll shoot up again. Is that the correct understanding?

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : On the expanded arm, once bauxite Pottangi mines are operationalized and expanded alumina capacity once it is operationalised, definitely there will be an increase in the depreciation cost.

Going forward, FY 2026-27 when it will be fully commissioned, and all things would be capitalised there will be a substantial increase in the depreciation cost. Because earlier, the depreciation was very negligible being a 40 year old plant. So there will be an increase

in the depreciation cost. But which is expected to be compensated in terms of saving some manpower, tapping cost and efficiency in some of the components that goes into production of Alumina Hydrate and once our Conveyor Belt is operationalized for Pottangi Mines, then there will be further saving in landed cost of bauxite at alumina plant. So those will compensate more than the deficiency.

Pratim Roy : That means for FY27, the number will be much more significantly higher than the FY25-26, will be less likely.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance): In terms of depreciation, yes it is.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Depreciation will be high, but our overall expenditure side efficiency, our operating expenditure will go down because this is coming up with the latest technology, HRD, DCW, the caustic soda, which is one of the major requirement of making this alumina. The raw material cost is around 20-25% in there. That will go down. So, for this fifth stream, our overall operating cost will be on the lesser side, so whatever increase in depreciation will be somewhat taken care of by this reduction in cost.

Pratim Roy: okay sir, thank you and best of luck sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit : Thank you, we'll take the next question from Mr. Tushar Chaudhari.

Tushar Chaudhari: Yeah, thank a lot Sir for the opportunity and congratulations for a great set of numbers. Sir, what is our captive coal production target for FY26? You said we produced 2.8 million tons in FY 25 from Utkal D and what about Utkal E?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : This year we're targeting 4 million tons, with a rated capacity.

Tushar Chaudhari : From both the mines, in total ?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Yes, combined Utkal D & E.

Tushar Chaudhari : And FY 27, it will again be 4 ?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : FY 27, 4 million tonnes is the rated capacity.

Tushar Chaudhari: Okay. And sir you said about some conveyor belt, we have... I missed that point. Which mines were you talking about ? Conveyor Belt you built?

16 | Page

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : That is the new Pottangi bauxite mine, which will feed to our new refinery. Our ED Finance was talking about that particular.

Tushar Chaudhari: Sir, secondly any progress on new projects which we had undertaken earlier at KABIL, lithium and all?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : As far as KABIL is concerned, KABIL has acquired the mines in Argentina and non-invasive exploration job was under progress, that is completed.

Now we're going for appointing one consultant

here, and after that our invasive exploration will start. The consultant appointment is almost on the verge of final. Our plan is that, by the end of FY28, we will finish off all the exploration. So, by the end of FY28, we'll come to know what are the deposits and whether it is commercially viable to mine and economically viable to open the mine there. Maybe somewhere in FY28 or end of FY28, we'll be able to take the decision, whether to go for commercial mining or not, after the exploration is over.

Tushar Chaudhari: Understood. And the alloy plant, which we had with the JV with Midhani?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : JV with Midhani?

Tushar Chaudhari : Yeah, yes sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Medhani JV was actually, for making special grid aluminium products; and the kind of forecast which was given in the DPR, the requirement increase, it was given that, the increase will come in the transportation sector and railways. And the construction sector, that is not coming up. So that project, the overall investment was around Rs. 4000-5000 crores was there, so that we are not able to justify that project. Still, we are not sure whether we will go ahead with the project or not. It is under discussion at the ministry stage, because commercial viability is not coming into play.

Tushar Chaudhari : Okay sir, thanks a lot.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Thank you

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you, we'll take the next question from Somaiah V.

Somaiah V. : Thanks for the opportunity, sir. Hope I'm audible. So the first question is on the Aluminium, global Aluminium landscape, so you've mentioned potential restart of some smelters in US and EUROPE. And also you've given expectations in terms of this

17 | Page

year's global aluminum production going up by 1 million tons. If you could give some

colour on...

Shweta Dikshit: There's a lot of disturbance, Somaiah, can you please speak closer to the mic ?

Somaiah V. : Yeah, am I audible now ?

Shweta Dikshit : Yes, better now.

Somaiah V. : Yeah thanks, So, the question is on the aluminium... global aluminium smelter additions this year. The restarts that you have mentioned in the presentation. So could you just help us on what is the incremental capacity that you're seeing this year in the global landscape?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Incremental capacity, some of the closed smelters, which were not operating, will come up. New smelters, some of them will come, because this year, you see on an average, the global aluminum production is around 72 million tonnes. So that will be maybe 73 or 74 next year it is targeting. Next year the projections are it will be around 73 million tonnes.

Somaiah V. : So this is in reference to some of the European smelters that went offline maybe a couple of years back, and they are coming back now. That's the one that you're referring to ?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : They are coming back, but in China also some of the smelters due to this carbon emission and reduction in carbon emission, they are stopping those smelters. Modernizing it to reduce the carbon emission. So, in China some of the production may go down. Over-all, the production increase will not be much.

Somaiah V. : Okay, got it sir. So, also in the last week, there was news on Guinea, revoking some mining licenses. Any thoughts on what impact be for bauxite supply globally ?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : You're talking about New Guinea, nah ?

Somaiah V. : There was one news article talking about, you know, revoking some 45 to 50 mining licenses there.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : I think what you're referring to is the mine owned by EGA itself by the GSE. Global aluminium alumina corporation, Emirates Global, so that is the mine which will be mostly affecting EGA's own sourcing. Otherwise, China's bauxite

import from Guinea has in fact gone up. Now it is 25-30% in the last quarter. So, other global supply of, you know, Bauxite has not been affected.

Somaiah V. : Got it Sir. Sir, also, on the alumina, you gave, you know your quarterly, last quarter, you know realisations. And then what is, you know currently what is going on. So similarly, for aluminium, would you be able to give the realisation? Last quarter, Q3, and what you're seeing currently?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : You see aluminium in the last quarter of the previous year, it has reached to even 2600 levels. Now it has gone down to in this quarter, around 2400, 2350 to 2400 levels. But the projections are there in S2. It will further improve and it will move to 2,500, maybe 25 or 2550. Those are the projections which are coming up.

Somaiah V. : Sir, I was looking out for more in terms of your realisation, sir. Like alumina, you had given \$600 Q4, and currently, around \$400 is what you're seeing. So similarly, in aluminium just want to understand if the Asian premiums have helped a bit in the realisation on the aluminium.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Our realisation is also linked directly to the LME, whatever LME prices are there. Our realisations are directly linked to it.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance): Can I add, Sir? In our pricing mechanism, we capture the Asian premium, so that will also be added, apart from what LME...infact in last 2

quarters we didn't have any export. So, in domestic realisation, the exchange rate, the Asian premium, all those are captured. So, you have to estimate accordingly. Above LME, the domestic metal realisation was more than 2.5.

Somaiah V. : Got it. So, in general Q4 had a good support from Asian premiums compared to Q3.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance): No, I think, what the quarters in FY2024-25, the Asian premium had come down towards the end of last quarter. Earlier it was more than 100. Then it came down.

Somaiah V. : Got it so one small clarification when you gave the cost of production, I presume that includes the depreciation cost also. If you could just give X depreciation that would be helpful both in Alumina and...

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : In the present cost the depreciation is not there. Depreciation is almost negligible, because the plant is already very old, so in the present, whatever cost of aluminum or aluminium we are telling, the depreciation is almost negligible,
19 | Page

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : It is around 1,000 now in alumina, because of whatever capital investment that goes into high equipment and other investments in mining equipment. But going forward, this is going to be almost near about to little less than that double. If we are coming up with the refinery, and our Bauxite mines. For metal, the depreciation component is around 5% of the cost of production.

Somaiah V. : So of 1,60,000, 5% or something? Yes got it sir, thank you sir.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Yes

Somaiah V. : Got it sir. Thank you sir.

Shweta Dikshit : Thank you. We'll take the next question from Mr. Akhilesh Kumar.

Akhilesh Kumar : Yeah, thanks for the opportunity, Sir. So my 1st question is on the captive coal mining. So what is the current rate of production from D and E, and also, as your guiding cost difference of rupees 400 per tonne from coal linkages. Would it be fair to assume that cost savings would be higher given our captive coal will replace...instead of linkage one?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Our Director (Production) will reply to you.

Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production) : This year we will be producing around 4 million tons from Utkal D & E.

Akhilesh Kumar : And Sir on the cost difference guidance, would it be fair to assume that it will be more than 400, as it will be a replacing e-auction?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, C

MD, NALCO : The difference between linkage price from Coal India and our price is around Rs.300 to 400 per ton.

Akhilesh Kumar : On that Sir, since captive coal I assume will be replacing the e-auction instead of the linkage one. So the difference with the e-auction, and the captive coal price would be higher. So would it be fair to assume that it could go more than 400 per ton?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Actually, e-auction prices are very variable. Now, earlier it was on the higher side. Now it has gone down to around 1,900 or 2,200. So it was coming close to the linkage coal. Only sometimes it depends on the mines from where they are giving it. But if you see the difference between e-auction and our coal, then it will be slightly, maybe Rs. 500 to 600 difference and linkage, and our call is Rs.300 to 400 difference.

20 | Page

Akhilesh Kumar: Okay, okay, thank you, sir. And my second question is on the smelter

project. So what is the economics there? How much IRR and ROC, we are assessing. And at what price assumption, what we are taking into aluminium while building those IRRs?

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : The proposal which our board had approved for the 17,000 crore rupees of investment in smelter and power plant would cost another 10,000 crores. That time this IRR was taken, so now we are coming up with the detailed project report, the fresh detailed project report for refined smelter as well as power plant, and after that we'll be coming out with what will be the IRR and the return of capital?

Akhilesh Kumar : Sure, sir, thank you so much.

Shweta Dikshit :

Thank you. We'll take the next question from Mr. Sumangal Nevatia. Please go ahead.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) :

Yeah, thank you so much for the chance Sir. The 1st question is on the coal block in between we were talking about applying for higher EC, maybe from 4 to 5 and a half or something is that plan still on? Or we should expect this 4 million ton only to continue?

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : You have asked a very right question, that we can increase 20% without even taking EC also. But if you want to increase it beyond 20% for that, environmental clearances and other clearances have to be taken. But for this year we are sticking to 4 million tons. And as we progress this year because this coal is new to our power plant, and we are mixing it up 50% with the MCL coal. So we'll take the performance and then we'll decide whether we have the liberty of going up to 6 million tons in coming FY. That decision will be taken after 6 months.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood, sir, very clear. Today, what would be our employee count? around 4,600?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : 4800

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Okay, understood. And, Sir, the net reduction over next 2 - 3 years. What are we looking at?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Almost 250 per year.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : So we will go down to as low as 4,000 employees. Right.

21 | Page

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Yes, yes. Some inductions will be there, not at that rate, but induction, of course, the remuneration at the induction stage will be on the lesser side, over employees who are retiring, remunerations are high there.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood. So this year our employee cost went down by almost 200 crores. What is the guidance for FY 26 and 27, the reduction will continue or we should see it stabilizing at around 1,800 odd crores?

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : The employee cost movement either downward or being static has been the composition of 2 factors basically. Superannuation at a higher level and induction at lower level, and the company's performance and profit, which leads to a component of the pay being given to employee. So with a higher profit this year definitely that component is quite sub

stantially high, which is not likely to be sustained in next year, as you all know, because of the declining alumina price, and even if our production volume goes up, so profit will not be to that extent. Pay off to employee will also get reduced, so it will be very premature to talk of figures now. But on the employee cost for our fixed and other salary component will come down. Then again, it depends on the financial performance and the payoff.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood, Sir. And this year's Rs. 1,800 crores already includes the incentives of good profitability in FY 25, or it is included in FY26?

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Yes, yes, yes, it is included on that account of FY25. That is accounted for.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood, Sir. this year overall our sales of alumina and

captive usage was still lower than production, so did we have a ny increase in alumina inventory.

Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial) : The alumina sale will always be less than the alumina production, because almost half of it, slightly less than the half goes to the smelter for aluminum production. So, out of total production, almost 10 lakh tons goes to the smelter.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Sure, sir, of course. So if you use, say, 1.9 multiplier. Then also there was a gap, so I just wanted to know if we are.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : We have increased our inventory at the smelter 3 months back. Our inventory at the smelter was around maybe 10,000-12,000. As of that at the smelter level, our inventory is around 60,000-65,000 tons.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Okay, understood. That explains.

22 | Page

Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial) : For better operation, better operation, and to take care of any raise we are keeping some higher stock of Alumina in smelter, because of frequent logistics issues are there. We are totally dependent on railways. So, that is a decision taken by the company to add safety stock.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood Sir. Sir, my next question is on aluminium cost, this year there has been a good reduction; where there other elements from the captive coal and employee cost contributing to this reduction in FY25?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : The cost of CP coke has gone down. The cost reduction has itself contributed around 400 to 500 crores. That was one of the major saving, as far as raw material is concerned. And caustic soda, of course that was in the Alumina side, the caustic soda has also given us 150 crores. And CPP has given around 70-80 crores. And increase in efficiency, that is reduction in the caustic soda and CP coke, that has given around maybe 100crores.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Okay. So sir, in FY26, are we seeing any reversal of any of these carbon related cost? As of now?

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : In FY26, there is already a reversal of both in CP coke and caustic soda price also, there was a slight reversal, and a gain in maybe last 8-10 days. It has again started coming down. But since, for our yearly 6 month cycle, so we don't get every month, any now and then benefit cost. But, there is already little bit of reversal in CP Coke and Caustic Soda price.

Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial) : Actually, the thing is that the raw material prices depends on the raw material cost to the supplier. It is very difficult to predict whether any prices will go up, how much will go up or go down, but what our ED (Finance) was telling it is the momentary figures but actually, it is very difficult to assess what exactly will happen. But, we are hopeful that the prices will be competitive.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood, and Sir, just last question, on the CAPEX on 1800 crores, is it possible to give a broad break-up of how much is maintenance towards refinery and maybe for future smelter

how much...

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : This 1700 crores, 1100 will go for 5th stream refinery, pottangi and smelter and other major projects. And rest of all will be earmarked for additional modification of projects in both the complexes.

Sumangal Nevatia (Kotak) : Understood. Alright Sir. Thank you so much and I hope this call initiative continues every quarter.

23 | Page

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Thank you

Shweta Dikshit : We have a follow up question from Mr. Kamlesh Bagmar. There is no response from the participant. Saket Kapoor?

Saket Kapoor : Yes, thank you sir for this opportunity. As Sumangal ji is looking forward for continuity of these calls, very exhaustive and informative. Sir, when we look at our depreciation line item, there is some reversal also of 76 crore for the quarter. So, if you could just explain to us how that has worked out, and my second question is ...average alumina realisation for the year as a whole.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : For Alumina, the average realisation for FY24-25 was around 590\$. As far as depreciation is concerned, reversal of depreciation I would request ED (Finance) ...

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : The depreciation reversal you are talking about is for Q on Q or ?

Saket Kapoor : Q on Q Sir. December quarter to March quarter. Lastly Sir, you mentioned about Alumina prices, now pending between 300 to 400\$. Does that align with our quarterly run rate or are we seeking any dip in the shipments also Q on Q, for Q1, the shipments are in align?

Sadashiv Samantaray, Director (Commercial) : Yeah. Shipments are distributed across the year. We will be selling around 12,75,000 tons in the current year. Out of that, we will be exporting around 12,30,000 tons and shipment, we have already planned month-wise shipment for the whole year.

Saket Kapoor: Okay Sir.

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : Depreciation Q4 over Q3 reversal is mainly due to a change in the estimate for threshold limit for capitalization of major spares. Then second was the re-assessment of the lean slurry project.

So, that has also contributed to the reversal of the depreciation. Then, there was a impairment earlier in Q3 of wind power assets which has been going on for last few quarter. Now, this 4

th quarter, we have taken a fair evaluation of our wind power assets based on that there was a reversal of environment provision. So, that 3 components have lead to depreciation reversal.

Saket Kapoor : Yeah, thank you for all the elaborate answer. Only, one thing I left was about the finance, we are seeing this line item also cropping up Q on Q, for the year it is 59 crore. Although, we are net cash company, but since the finance line item have now started...

24 | Page

Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance) : There is nothing in the cash outflow, but accounting statement only...Now the CCD issuance part we talked earlier that has component of back stopping arrangement under accounting standard it has to be targeted as a Guarantee.

Saket Kapoor : Thank you Sir

Shweta Dikshit : Thank you. Sir, can we take last question from Aditya A.?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Yes, yes.

Shweta Dikshit : Aditya, please go ahead.

Aditya A. : Yes Sir, just last question. Starting of timeline for Pottangi Bauxite Mines, so in the last call you said by December 2025...

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Pottangi Bauxite Mines starting were planned by June, 2026. That is the timeline given to us. And already we have planned. Our smelter is also getting delayed so the requirement is not there. So, by June of 2026, we will start the mines.

Aditya A. : Understood.

Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T) : Pottangi Mines have got all the clearances. It has got all the statutory clearances as of now. And we are working on to start it.

Aditya A. : Understood. On FY 2024-25, what was our coal sourcing? How much was linkage? E-auction? And captive?

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Our coal requirement is around 7.2 million tonnes, out of that this year our plan is 2 million ton will be captive and rest will be from linkage.

Aditya A. : Okay. Thank you Sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : Thank you

Shweta Dikshit : We take that as the last question? I will hand over to the management for their closing remarks. Thank you so much.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD, NALCO : First of all, let me congratulate the collective, all our shareholders, stakeholders, for having a confidence in us. And, on behalf of

25 | Page
NALCO management I would like to assure that whatever growth we have achieved in this year, 46% growth in EBITDA, 46% EBITDA margin was there, of course that was triggered off due to high Alumina price and high Aluminium prices. But we are taking lot of measures, like this year we have planned for increasing Alumina production, increasing our efficiency, reducing our cost. So, this year also whatever plan we have made, physical performances and financial, we will be targeting around maybe 36-37% EBITDA margin, and whatever revenue generations we had this year, almost we will try to achieve the similar kind of revenue generations and profitability of course may vary depending on the prices of Alumina and Aluminium. But our own internal control increases the volumes, increasing efficiency, increasing technology and cost. We are working hard on it to improve the performance of the company and give maximum benefit to our shareholders. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit : Thank you so much

Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary : With this we come to the end of the Conference Call.

Shweta Dikshit : Yes Sir.

Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary : Thank you

Call: Aug 2025

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al Aluminium Company Limited

(A Government of India Enterprise)

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■■■■■■/ Ref. : NBC/S/4.5 & 4.5(A)/2025/1304

■■■■■■/Dated: 14.08.2025

To,

■■■■■■/The Manager

■■■■■■ ■■■■■■ ■■/BSE Limited,

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Phiroj Jeejeebhoy Towers, ■■■■■ ■ ■ ■■/Dalal Street,

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■■■■ ■■■■ /Scrip Code: 532234 To, ■■■■■■■/The Manager

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Exchange Plaza, Bandra■Kurla Complex,

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■■■■■: 08.08.2025 ■■ ■■■■■■■ ■■ ■■■ ■■ ■■■ ■■ ■■■ ■■■ ■■■

Sub: Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08. 2025.

■■■■■■ /Dear Sir,

Further to our letter dated 08.08.2025 and pursuant to Regulation 30 of SEBI (LODR)

Regulations, 2015, enclosed please find the transcripts of the Earnings Conference

Call held on 08.08.2025 for discussions on Company's business and outlook post

declaration of Unaudited Financial Results for 1st Quarter ended 30th June, 2025.

Neither any Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI) was shared during the

aforesaid Earnings Conference Call nor is mentioned in the enclosed transcripts.

This is for your information and record.

■■■■■■/Thanking you.

■■■■■■/ Yours faithfully,

■ ■ ■ ■ ■■■■■ ■■ ■■■■■■■ ■ ■■■■ ■■■■■ ■■

For National Aluminium Co. Ltd.

(■

■. ■ ■ . ■■■š)/(B. K. Sahu)

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Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

ACS: 9953

Encl.: As above

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

MANAGEMENT: Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, Chairman■cum■Managing Director

Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production)

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technical)

Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak, Director (Finance)

Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance)
Shri Srimanta Panda, EPO■ED (Finance)
Shri Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematix Group: Good morning everyone. On behalf of Systematics Group, we welcome you to the 1Q■FY26 Earnings Conference Call of Nalco Ltd. We are joined today by Mr. Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD and Director (Commercial) and other Functional Directors of the company along with Mr. Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary, to discuss the company's financial and operational performance for the 1st Quarter■FY26.

I would like to thank the management for giving us an opportunity to host this call. At the end of the presentation, we will open the floor for questions and participants can raise their hands if they wish to ask a question. Now I request Mr. Bharat Sahu for his opening remarks and introduction of the management team. Over to you Sir.

Shri Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary: Thank you ma'am. Greetings from National Aluminium Company Limited to all our esteemed investors.

National Aluminium Company Limited
Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025
2 | Page

We had a Board meeting yesterday to consider and approve the Q1 25■26 results. The result is already out. And thank you Systematics Group for arranging and hosting this post■ earning conference call. Before we start, let me have the privilege of introducing our management team, the Functional Directors. Anticlockwise sitting extreme is Shri Srimanta Panda, our EPO■ED (Finance). Sitting next to him is our Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance).

And next to him is Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects and Technical). Sitting in the middle is our CMD and Director (Commercial)■Addl. Charge, Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh. Sitting next to him is Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production) and sitting just next to me is our Director (HR), Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak.

And before taking any further time, first we'll have a brief presentation about the Q1 results, and then we'll invite our esteemed participants to come forward with their questions. Now I'll request my colleague Shri Subha Brata Purohit to have the presentation please.

Shri Subha Brata Purohit, DGM (Mechanical): Thank you sir. Good Morning to all. Welcome to you all to this Earning Conference Call for Q1. So, the results of Q1 have been published yesterday, and it's another quarter of strong results shown by the company.

Now we'll go through the presentation. The agenda of the presentation is similar to the earlier presentations. We'll look at the company update, then we'll go to the physical performance, the financial highlights, then we'll touch upon a little bit on the industry outlook, we'll see the physical highlights of the company, and the ESG performance of the company as well.

So, NALCO is a Navratna CPSE with Govt. of India holding is 51.28%. It represents bauxite, alumina, aluminium power core complex in the country, and it is a global leader in producing bauxite and alumina at the lowest cost. We are the lowest cost producer since about seven to eight years. We have been continuously rated as the lowest cost producer in bauxite and alumina.

Our assets, bauxite and refining assets are at Damanjodi. It's 7.5 million we are producing right now bauxite as per the requirement of our refinery. Our refinery capacity is currently 2.1 million ton. Then, our Smelter and CPP assets are at Angul, again in the State of Odisha. We have also recently started operating our Utkal D&E Coal Mines in January of 2025. Our combined capacity of 4 million ton started.

Then we have a dedicated facility at Vizag Port for export of alumina and metal and import of products. We are also having four wind power plants of total 198 MW capacity in Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh.

Now coming to our physical performance in Q1, we have been operating at almost about

100% capacity, but still we are improving our productivity and still registering higher

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

3 | Page

production quarter by quarter. So, if you see in case of Bauxite, we have achieved 6.6% growth against corresponding quarter last year. In case of Alumina Hydrate, there has been a significant jump of 35% against Q1 due to base effect. Then in case of metal, we have achieved 3% growth and power also 6% growth.

If you come to sales also, in case of Alumina, we have achieved significant jump. This is partly due to base effect as Q1 sales were a little bit less. And in case of metal also, we have achieved growth of 9%.

Here I would like to mention also that in case of domestic sales of metal and alumina, in both cases we have achieved highest ever sales for Q1 of any particular year. And if you

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see the run rate also, we are exceeding our past year productions. So, in case of Alumina, we are running at a run rate of around 23 lakh ton. Aluminium we are running at 4.6 to 4.7 lakh ton and Bauxite also around 76 lakh ton.

Now coming to the financial performance. In the last quarter, the Q4 of 24-25 it was a record breaking performance of the company in the last quarter and the last financial year as well. In Q1 also, the company has shown very strong performance in its results. We can see there is growth of 33% in the revenue and also the PAT has registered growth of 77% against the corresponding quarter of last year. The company has also recommended Final dividend of Rs.2.50 per share in its last Board meeting.

Now coming to the industry outlook. The LME price... (inaudible). There was a downfall in April-25 when LME price fell down to \$2,380 per ton because of the tariff announcements by US President. Since then, the LME price has recovered and it has reached to about \$2,560 per ton. The LME price going ahead are likely to be impacted by the tariff developments, which are still uncertain.

Though the 90 days period has elapsed, but still there are lots of negotiations to go and the tariff rates are far from over. So, the developments, the LME price also will depend on the latest developments on the tariff of US announcements. Then there are new starts in aluminum refining and smelting capacities, primarily in Indonesia and India.

Then, of course, there is rising oil prices and increase in US dollar index recently. The LME price normally moves inversely with the rising oil prices and with the rising dollar index actually, the LME price moves intensely. So, the LME prices will be impacted and there is disruptions in the bauxite supply also. Guinea has cancelled some licenses specifically for bauxite mining. In Ghana also, there is one lease where the license was cancelled. So, for developments in these sectors, the LME price will also be impacted.

Now, coming to the global GDP growth, earlier in April 2025, IMF has projected 2.8% growth. But this time in July 2025, the tariff-related developments have settled a bit as per IMF and they have projected a growth of 3%, which others were for the aluminum sector as well, because aluminum consumption is almost proportional to the growth of the

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

4 | Page

country as well as the globe. So you can see in July 2025, the IMF has projected that there will be 3% growth for the year 2025 and 3.1% growth for the year 2026.

Coming to the alumina sector, the alumina supply was a bit of downside on the last year, but the supply has improved recently and we can see the difference between production and consumption, it is coming a little bit on the surplus side. The alumina prices are also moving accordingly. Coming to the aluminum sector, in the aluminum sector, there is growth, there is a little bit of deficit on the quarter to quarter basis and on the year estimation for the annual also, there is a little bit of deficit side. So the aluminum sector is also dependent on the latest capacity additions. We all know that the capacity at China is capped at 45 million tons currently. So currently China is almost about receiving 43-44 million tons. So the supply side will be limited to that. So in the H2 of this year and the next future years, the LME prices are likely to stay strong.

Now, if you look at the domestic scenario, our country is still the fastest growing economy in the world. Recently, RBI has said that for this year, we are projecting at 6.5% growth. For the next year, 6.7% growth. The country is aiming to be the "Viksit Bharat" by the year 2047. So to reach a 30 trillion

in economy by 2047, the growth rate needs to be more than 7%, which against others were for the aluminum industry in the country. If we see the aluminum consumption pattern, currently the electrical sector is having the largest chunk in the aluminum production. It is having around 48% share and transportation and building and construction sector comes next.

So as the country's GDP growth rises, there will be definitely growth in this sector. And recently, our Ministry of Mines has published a vision document on aluminum, where they have predicted aluminum consumption will reach about 8.5 billion tons by 2030. So there is lots of scope for improvement of demand in the country.

And if you see the Indian aluminum scenario also, the growth rate is about 9%. The aluminum consumption growth is around 9%. And also, there is growth in the production.

So the sector is a booming sector in the country. And the primary producers are also adding capacities to their plants. So this is going ahead well in the future.

If we come back to NALCO, NALCO's strategy is it's an integrated operation. We are integrated with our bauxite mines, our aluminum refining capacity, our power plant, then also we are doing our own captive coal blocks. The company is a zero-debt company which gives leverage to all our upcoming projects, our smelter and power projects, which will require a huge investment.

So the zero-debt position will help the company to fund itself. We are also having raw material security in case of caustic soda. We are having a JV company with GACL, which is supplying caustic soda to the company.

National Aluminium Company Limited
Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025
5 | Page

Then our refinery capacity is going ahead. The smelter capacity also is from the pre-project stages at the moment. If you see our potential plants currently going ahead, the bauxite mines, we are currently running at 7.5 million tons.

And we have already signed the lease deed for Pottangi bauxite mines, which will be operated by this year-end or by quarter one of next year. So, our capacity will increase by 3.5 million tons. Then we are going ahead with our 5th stream refinery expansion, which will increase the capacity by 1 million tons.

The mechanical completion is targeted by this financial year end. And the execution is currently on fast-track mode. We are reaching around 74% to 75% progress, physical progress, in this refinery expansion.

For aluminum smelter and captive power plant, these are at the pre-project stages. And the plants are likely to come, by financial year 2030.

Now coming to the environment part, the company is recognized for its works in the environment management. Our bauxite mines are rated as 5-Star mines. Recently, we are operating two bauxite mines regions, Central and North Block and South Block at Panchpatmali Mines. Both these bauxite mines have been recently rated as 5-Star rating.

We are putting equal emphasis on plantation, restoration, advanced pollution control measures, and biodiversity protections. We are also certified with all the international management certification like ISO 14001, ISO 50001, ISO 9001 and like. And also, we are operating 198 MW wind power plant. We are also utilizing our rooftop solar places. Currently, the capacity is 1020 KW power and we have planned to add 7 MW rooftop solar in the future.

We are also equally responsible to the society we are working in. We have identified important sectors where we are working. The company is working at Damanjodi and Angul.

Damanjodi is one of the most tribal resided population. So, we are focusing on education where we have some flagship schemes like Indradhanush where we

are sponsoring

students, tribal students mostly to reputed residential schools. We have also a scheme of Nalco-ki-Ladli which is in line with Government of India's "Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao" movement where we are providing financial assistance to the girls of various families.

In case of health care, we are operating Mobile Healthcare Units. Eight numbers of mobile health units are in operations currently at Angul and Damanjodi and also Pottangi where we are serving to people of 250 peripheral villages. And we are serving more than 100,000

patients annually. Also, we are operating one OPD facility at Angul where we are serving 18,000 patients annually.

For women empowerment, we are having Self Help Groups like Sakha Foundation for earning and livelihood support.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

6 | Page

Then, there are lots of works on peripheral development. Also, we have adopted the Puri Jagannath Temple and surrounding areas development works. So, these are all the areas where we are working as per our social objectives. Our corporate governance, the company is a Government of India company. So, we are

maintaining all our statutory requirements. There are 10 board level committees. We are having 17 board policies and guidelines. We have been rated as 'very good' in the financial year 2024-25. Also, we have been recognized for our fair treatment to investors, our dividend policies, and transparency in our reporting. So, thank you all. My presentation is over now. Thank you.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO: Thank You....

Shri Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary: Yes. Ma'am, we have already made a brief presentation on the Q1 as well as the different activities of the company. Now, we may allow our esteemed participants to come forward with their questions to the management, please.

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you, sir. We now open the floor for questions. Anybody who wishes to ask a question can indicate that by raising the hand icon button.....

So, till then, I will proceed with a couple of questions from my side. So, first question would be the status of the alumina refinery and what is the status, what is the progress and when are we now expecting the commissioning to happen and post that, what is likely the ramp up plan and what can be the expected volumes post commissioning in FY27 and 28?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO: As far as refinery is concerned, first of all, a very good morning to all, to you and everyone connected here. Very good morning to all and congratulations to all for the wonderful performance of NALCO in Q1.

As far as your question is concerned, for 5th stream refinery expansion, whatever commitment we have given earlier that we will be starting the commissioning, all mechanical jobs will be completed may be by March, 26 and we will try to start all commissioning thing after that and try to start the production by June, 26. That is the commitment we have given earlier also and we stand by it. Progress in the site is good.

All the packages are working well. So, when this refinery comes, may be we start the commissioning and production in June, 26. So, next financial year, we are hoping we will be producing at least 50% of the total capacity because initially the production will be less, may be around 5 lakhs to 6 lakhs to the 10 lakh capacity line. We will be producing around 5 lakhs next financial year, that is 2026-27. After that, it will go to the rated capacity of 10 lakhs.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Co

nference Call held on 08.08.2025

7 | Page

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: And Sir, what is the number that you can see from the existing alumina like you were earlier? We are seeing growth in alumina sales. So, from the existing one, what kind of capacity utilization are you expecting on the existing capacity?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO: Existing capacity, almost we are over utilizing. Our production capacity of alumina is 22.5 lakh ton around, around 22 lakhs ton or 22.5 ton lakh. This year, we are planning to do more than that, maybe 23 lakhs ton we will be doing. So, we will be doing 100% of the rated capacity of the existing line, more than 100%.

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Understood, sir. Thank you. We will take your questions now. We have first question from Amit Murarka from AXIS. Amit, please go ahead with your question.

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: Yeah, hi. Thanks for the hosting the call and the opportunity to ask the question. So, on alumina, generally like we have been reading that the US, Russia

are engaging for de-escalation of the current situation in Ukraine. And that could prompt the removal of the export kind of restrictions on Russian alumina.

So, how do you read the situation? What's your expectation of Russian alumina coming back to the market? Because I believe that could kind of, that could create maybe an overall supply situation. So, just wanted some view on that.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : As far as Russian, you're talking about Russian alumina or aluminium?

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: Yeah, like alumina as well. Both rather, but yeah, like.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : I don't, I don't think Russia have excess of alumina is there. Of course, aluminium is there. Aluminium which they were sending to Europe. Europe is already has imposed the sanctions on Russia. So, Russian aluminium is not able to go into the European market. And with the Indian Prime Minister signing a free trade agreement with UK, a lot of opportunities are there with Indian aluminium industries to go into the UK market. Because UK market is again, market where there are a lot of potential for increase in EVs, solar panels, and other where usage of aluminium will be there. So, that will be a boost for Indian aluminium industry as far as UK is concerned.

As far as US tariffs are concerned, again, that is a concern area. US tariff increased to around 50% from 25%. But our aluminium, which is especially from Nalco, we are not exporting any of the aluminium as of now. We are most, all aluminium is getting consumed in the domestic market. So, Nalco will not be affected by that.

Of course, Vedanta was exporting aluminium to USA. So, that may come down if the tariffs is going to remain at the 50% level. But still, the demand is there in US also. So, they might go in taking aluminium with the higher prices also.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

8 | Page

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: All right. So, specifically on Russian supplies, like how much supply would have been impacted of aluminium, let's say, if you have any number in your mind.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Russian supplies of?

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: Aluminium in the global markets.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Russian supply of aluminium to the global market? I don't think I have the figure right now. We'll have to check what amount of aluminium Russia is exporting. Russia is, what he is asking is alumina. Aluminium, Russia was exporting.

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (P&T): So, aluminium, they have around 1.3 million ton. Total 4 million, they were not producing it. They have reduced it to just half a million tons they have

halted. And they are not the lowest cost of producers. The lowest cost of producers are EGA or this Emirates Global and Bahrain. They will be the first sufferers.

This aluminium trade, anything which is coming down from America, they are the most supplier to America. They were supplying 100% to America. So, they will be the first sufferers. Bahrain and EGA. This is Dubai-based company.

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis : And secondly, on the coal supplies of your captive coal mining, I think you mentioned that the 4 million ton has started. So, how much would you have produced in Q1 of the captive mines?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Q1, almost at the rated capacity we are producing as far as our targets are there. And this year, we will be doing around 4 million ton, we will be completing.

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: Okay. So, during monsoon, then you don't anticipate any issue around with coal supply, right? I think earlier in earlier years, we have seen some...

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : No, no. That is not there. That is not there. No supply disruptions are there. We have a sufficient stock of coals in our power plants and in mines also. Mines also, we are having sufficient stocks.

During monsoon, some interruptions in the production is there. But the dispatches, the

transportation from mines to our power plant, that is going as per requirement because we have sufficient stock in the mines.

Shri Amit Murarka, Axis: Sure. Thank you so much. I'll come back later in the Q&A.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Okay. Thank you.

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematix Group: Thank you. We'll take the next question from Kartikeya. Kartikeya, please unmute yourself and go ahead with your questions.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

9 | Page

Kartikeya: Hi, am I audible?

Ms. Shweta Dikshit, Systematix Group: Yes, you're audible.

Kartikeya: Thank you for the opportunity. So, I actually missed a couple of points from the starting. So, I just wanted to understand what are the timelines for the new bauxite and alumina, bauxite mine and the alumina refinery? And like, what's the cost of production in the alumina refinery we are expecting?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : So, as far as bauxite mines is concerned, we are planning to, already tender is out for MDO and we are planning to start the mines somewhere, may be February, March, 26. Latest by June, 26 we are planning, but we are early with our all dates. May be latest by May, June, 26, we'll be starting the bauxite mines, Pottangi mines.

And alumina refinery

5th stream, I already said, we are planning to start the commercial production from maybe June, 26 onwards. As far as cost is concerned, cost of the alumina produced in this new, our new 5th stream refinery expansion, that will be almost similar to the cost which we are producing now. Because, of course, interest is not there. We are not taking any loan for that. Depreciation will be loaded, but that will be made offset by the industry technology. It is a better technology where the caustic soda consumption will be on the lower side, manpower will be on the lower side, overall manpower, because here in a single line, we will be producing around 10 lakh tons. Now, with four lines at present, we are producing 20 lakh tons. So, that advantage of the volume will be getting with a lesser manpower because manpower is the most costliest thing, which is our fixed cost, as far as fixed cost is concerned.

So, cost will be almost similar kind of, as far as what we are incurring now, as far as alumina is concerned.

Kartikeya : Okay, sir. And just, I wanted to know, what was the alumina realization for this quarter?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Alumina realization for this quarter was around \$35,000. It was around \$400. \$416 dollars average.

Kartikeya: Okay, sir. And, sir, just another question, like, what drove the other expenses for this quarter? The other expenses are quite high. So, I just wanted to understand.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO : Other expenses, of course, what you are telling is Rs.707 crores is on the higher side. This may, I think, RPO obligation is on the higher side. You can just deliberate on that.

RPO, my Director (Production), or maybe my ED (Finance), we had some RPO obligations, as far as renewable power is concerned, which cost us around 70 to 75 crores. That was National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

10 | Page

the additional cost, which we paid, because the norms, government norms have changed. We have to have 30 percent... Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production): Basically, our core project is basically, so we are having our RPO obligation of around 3 percent of our electricity consumption. But now, due to the Ministry of Power guidelines for year 2024-25, we are bound to have obligation of around 29.4 percent for the year 2024-25, and 33 percent for the year 2025-26. So, in that connection, we have purchased this certificate for around Rs.75 crores for the year 2024-25. That has increased the cost.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : And some program...

Shri Srimanta Panda, ED (Finance): There is increased attribute in repair maintenance and the coal transportation cost to captive coal which was 7.2 lakh in the far earlier now this quarter it is 9.89 lakh. So in our presentation of accounts, the transportation of coal is captured in the other expenses not in power and fuel. So that also has added to around Rs.10 to Rs.12 crore. So, these are the major things and little bit of in CSR expenses and RPO obligation. Then the general administrative expenses increase by around Rs.8 crores.

And due to higher volume movement of alumina from refinery to smelter, there is an increase in transportation cost also and a higher export of alumina also that has increased selling distribution expenses.

Kartikeya: Okay. Thank you, Sir.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: We'll take the next question from Aditya Welekar. Please go ahead.

Aditya Welekar: Yeah thank you. Am I audible?

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Yes you're audible. Please go ahead.

Aditya Welekar: Yeah. So just on the 5th stream of alumina refinery, what kind of means in the last call you have guided on volumes of 5 lakh ton from that in FY27. So we are keeping it that guidance unchanged correct? Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes. Yes. In FY27 we'll be aiming for five lakh tons from that because if you are able to start in June, 26 that much volume we will be getting. Yeah. 9 months will be there. Three quarters. It is a 10 lakhs capacity. Three quarters minimum five lakhs we should go.

Aditya Welekar: And just related to that so once the plant stabilizes what kind of utilization can we expect post the full ramp up?

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

11 | Page

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Actually, initially if you start in June, 26 initially some utilization will be on the lower side but slowly maybe within next 6 months we'll be trying to take it to the rated capacity of 10 lakhs tons. It will take maybe 3 to 6 months but since it is only a chemical plant, chemical process plant so it will not take a lot of

time. That's why we are taking five lakh tons for financial year 27.

Aditya Welekar: Understood sir. Just on few numbers in the last call we have given alumina sales volume guidance of 12.8 lakh tons, out of which 12.3 are exports. So those numbers are also unchanged right? Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: This year you are talking for this year?

Aditya Welekar: Yeah. FY26 this year.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: This year, that will increase. Our exports will increase, whatever we have done last year. Last year we have done around, shipment if you talk in terms of shipment 36 shipments. This year we are planning for maybe 41 or 42 shipments. That will increase by maybe five shipments. Because we are increasing the volume, overall production volume will increase.

Aditya Welekar: What will be that sir? Total production volume guidance for this year...?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Last year, Calcined Alumina we have done around 20.7 lakh tons, this year we have planned for 22.5 lakh tons. But we are aiming, we'll be achieving around 23. Maybe around two or two and a half lakh tons more of production will be there. So, in domestic market we are also increasing our presence. Last year we have, sold around 40,000 in the domestic market. This year we are planning you will be selling around maybe 1 lakh or 1,20,000 in the domestic market and the rest will go to the exports. So export maybe around 1 lakh or 1 lakh 50,000 will increase.

Aditya Welekar: Okay. So total sales volume will be 12.8 lakhs total.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: It will be around more than 12.5 lakhs. 12.5 or 12.8 lakhs.

Aditya Welekar: Understood. Sir, my last question is on that brownfield smelter of 0.5 million ton. Any progress on the DPR? we said that we can file a revised DPR.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: As far as brownfield expansion of smelter is concerned, already DPR preparation activities we have started. For DPR preparation we have to have a Consultant. Already appointment of consultant we are doing, within may be next 2 months or 3 month, we'll be having consultant 2 to 3 months, and they will be there for preparing the DPR we are planning next maybe 7 to 8 months we will be ready with the DPR to take it to the Board for the approval. That is the time line? our Director (Project & Technical) is here, he will further clarify.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

12 | Page

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technical): Yes, for this month or this financial year, we'll complete all the DPR preparation and all the activities and one good thing is that the land acquisition which was held up that has taken shape and we have completed all the formalities of land acquisition and now the final stage of land acquisition is taking place. So which we'll be completing in another 4 to 6 months and by this time our all the preparation would be ready. So next financial year we'll start the tendering process and onboarding the parties.

Aditya Welekar: Understood sir. Thanks a lot. I'll get back in the queue.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. We'll take the next question from Shrikant Hemant. Please go ahead.

Shrikant Hemant: Yeah. Hi everyone. Can you hear me?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes.

Shrikant Hemant: Yeah. Hi. This is Shrikant from HSBC. Thanks for the opportunity to ask questions. Three questions for the time being. I'd like to take them one by one. So first one is how much of alumina sales in this quarter were on a spot basis and how much were under long-term contracts?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Whatever, we have sold in exp

ort market, every month,

one shipment is going for long-term and the rest is going on spot. On an average four shipment per month we are doing exports.

Shrikant Hemant: Okay, understood. My second question is on pricing. So for long-term contracts, how is pricing determined? Is it linked to LME aluminium prices?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes, it is linked to the LME price. In that some percentage is decided. On that percentage it is decided. We do a tender, and on that tender basis whoever the tender is going, giving the maximum percentage on the LME, the order is given on that.

Shrikant Hemant: Okay that's very clear. And third what is management's outlook for alumina and aluminium cost of production and can you just remind us about the cost of production in Q1?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: As far as cost of production is concerned, I will request my Director (Finance)...

Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance): So, as far as the cost of production of alumina is concerned and our cost of production is varying around 20 to 21,000. It is not the total cost. So far, the cost of production of alumina is concerned. Our cost of production

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

13 | Page

is varying between 20,000 to 21,000 and out of that is 60% is our variable cost and balance is fixed. Shrikant Hemant: Okay and what's the outlook for this year?

Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance): It will be almost similar kind. We may because of our techno economic performance very good. We expect reduction in our cost because our performance parameter has improved well. The key consumables caustic soda is the other parameter we have a great control over that. So, we expect that our cost will come down at the end of the year.

Shrikant Hemant: Okay this was very helpful. I've got couple more questions but I'll come back later. Thank you.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. We'll take the next question from Saket Kapoor. Saket, please unmute yourself and go ahead.

Saket Kapoor: Thank you for the opportunity.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Your voice is a little distant. Can you come closer to the mic?

Saket Kapoor: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Now am I audible Sir?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes.

Saket Kapoor: Namaskar to the entire team and thank you for the elaborate discussion we are having sir and we hope for the continuity. Sir, on the value added product if you could just throw some light, what is our road map going ahead and how will value added sales will contribute? I think so some investment in the Angul park was also envisaged earlier so where are we? what are we going to invest when are we going to see value added contributing to the top line and bottom line? if you could just give us the road map.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : As far as value added product is concerned, our focus now is increasing the production of wire rods, because wire rod we are producing only around one lakh tons per year yearly. So, we are trying to get one new wire rod mill, so that our whatever Ingot we are selling in the market that we will be able to control and convert into wire rods, that is one target we are taking. Already DPR has been made earlier for that, we are revising the cost estimate and going in for tendering. The whole activity may take around 2 years for the mill to come.

And next is the foil sector – the aluminium foil. That area also we are trying to have some kind of presence where we are going in for appointing one consultant who will be suggesting us what kind of foils to be made, what will be the market and all

that. And, very

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

14 | Page

small investment is required in that maybe around 150 to 200 crores of investment is required. So these are the two areas as far as aluminium metal is concerned where we are targeting next two years or 3 years, 2 and a half years we should have presence, increasing our wire rods and foil segment from our rolled product units.

And even rolled product units, we are going to have one annealing furnace which is coming in the March, 26. So rolled product units may on an average we are producing 2,000 tons per month that will increase to 3,000 tons per month from March, 26 onwards. So that area also will give more valued products from rolled product units.

As far as alumina is concerned, there are the two areas i.e. special grade alumina, fused alumina, these are the areas where value added we can make. We are exploring the market for that. What kind of market is there? The market is there for that. We'll be going in for maybe some kind of conversion or setting up our own units that is also is there in our mind. You have to go in for that.

Saket Kapoor: So how much have we outlined for that, I mean that firstly the wire rod part two years' timeline which you have said how much we will be spending on the same and what would be its revenue contribution Sir? As on today market prices.

Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO: As far as, wire rods is concerned we get a premium of around 10,000 in wire rods. If you see the contribution, the contribution difference is around maybe 5,000 to 6,000 because the conversion we take the conversion cost into account. Rod products we see we get a premium of around 30,000 to 35,000 in the range

of depending on the product. But contribution again there is, I think contribution must be around, I think it must be around 6,000 to 7,000 contribution as far as rolled product is concerned.

So contribution is there in both rolled products and wire rods and more importantly is that because if you are selling ingots we are heavily dependent on the LME. So if you want to insulate yourself from the LME the fluctuations of the LME and get the premium in the market it is very important that we go in for increasing the volumes of wire rods, rolled products and also going into the foil markets. Foil market again has a very good contribution margin.

Saket Kapoor: So my question was what is the CAPEX we are doing to for the wire rod segment, and for aluminium foil. Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD NALCO:

As far as CAPEX of the wire rod mill is concerned.

It is around in between 200 to 300 crores for a capacity of 1 lakh ton mill. For setting a foil plant, again it is a very low capex plant around maybe 50 crores or 60 crores for a maybe 1,000 ton monthly capacity plant. Depends on the capacity what we are setting so wire rod will cost around maybe 250 to 300 crores that is a CAPEX as far as wire rod is concerned.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

15 | Page

Saket Kapoor: And last point Sir on the alumina realization, so what are the current spot market realizations and for this quarter and the ensuing quarter at what prices have we contracted our shipment? If you could just give some color on that.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: As far as current spot prices are concerned that is averaging around \$400. This first quarter was we got around \$460 was the average because some last quarter which balance quarter shipment that order was of the higher volume rate. But whatever spot prices currently we are getting

is somewhere around \$400 and we are expecting that in the coming quarters also that will remain somewhere in between \$400 to \$450.

Saket Kapoor: Right sir. Thank you, sir. I will join the queue and all the best to the team.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : Thank you. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. We'll take the next question from Pallav Agarwal. Pallav please go ahead.

Pallav Agarwal: Yeah. Good morning Sir. So, I had a question on how the aluminium physical premiums have been moving. So, is it more linked to MJ P or you know since we sell a majority of our products in the domestic market, so we should be probably commanding a better premium compared to our peers?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : You are talking about the premiums in the metal sector?

Pallav Agarwal: Yeah.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : That I was telling earlier also as far as premium is concerned, in wire rods we get a premium from our Ingot around 10,000 and our conversion cost if you see is around I think Rs.3,500 to 4,000. The additional benefit of around maybe 6,000 or 7,000 we get in wire rods as far as wire rods is concerned depending on the quality and grade of the wire rods we are producing.

As far as rolled product is concerned road product we get a premium of around in between 30,000 to 35,000, extra premium. But of course, conversion cost is also there. So if you see margins, actual margins after conversion cost it will come around maybe 5,000 to 10,000 in between depending again on the what product we are talking about, sizes and all that. If you're going in the lower sizes 0.3 mm or 0.5 mm the premium is on the higher side but our productivity goes down. If you are producing on the thinner side the productivity goes down and the volume comes down. We have to balance in that.

Pallav Agarwal: Yes sir. We also see you know competitors also trying to push more material in the domestic market. So, is that is there enough demand to block that? physical premiums can sustain at these levels?

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

16 | Page

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Domestic market, what we are seeing in the consumption pattern of the aluminium in the domestic market around 45 to 50% is going into the power sector. Now, the kind of infrastructure development, the kind of power lines, grid lines and government thrust in the electrification is there. The demands will be there, as far as power sector is concerned.

Now, solar panels, lot of solar panels are there again extrusion demand is there in solar panels. Lot of solar panels are coming. EVs, again, in EVs lot of usage of aluminium being a light lightweight metal is replacing the steel. So all these areas infrastructure, other areas in infrastructure development also lot of the demand in the domestic market is still there because you are seeing the domestic GDP growth is around maybe 5% to 6% growth GDP which is projected and the aluminium as far as whatever historically we see aluminium requirement is around 1.5% of the GDP. It is almost there, it grows like that so aluminium requirement will grow at the end of maybe 7 to 8% or 9%.

Pallav Agarwal: Yes sir. Lastly you mentioned that we incurred almost 75 crores in RPO obligations. So are we planning on putting up you know captive solar or maybe increasing the wind power capacity so that we don't have to purchase we can reduce the external RPO purchase.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes of course we have to do that. We are going in for appointing a consultant in a very planned manner. Already 7 MW solar power is under our tendering stage that will come

within next 1 year or one and a half years but that is a small quantity.

Wind power is an area where we have to see or maybe setting up in hybrid mode. Wind and solar both, we are exploring on that. Maybe our plan is by 2030, next four five years we will have to have more of at least 15% to 20% of green power into our portfolio.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Our Director (Projects & Technical) will supplement.

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technical): This is a very good question and going forward everybody and we are working on it in different format and very soon we'll have a fixed plan that how much green would be coming and as our CMD Sir had told this 10 megawatt of solar will come in one year but another 10 megawatt of our wind power will come in one or two months because in Kayathar, it is ready. Now, it is being getting clearances in maybe from September or October, 25, we'll be having 10 megawatt of additional plant and we are working on a hybrid round the clock combination of solar, wind, and battery storage and all we are working on with all the power producers and another three four months' time we'll be fixing up our road map for the next few years.

Pallav Agarwal: Yes, sure sir. Also, Sir, I mean with the captive coal now at 4 million tons, is there any incremental cost savings that can come in or you know most of the benefits are now already in the P&L?

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

17 | Page

Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance): Yes, definitely there is a saving because what we are taking coal from MCL on fuel supply agreement and our own production there is a difference of around 400 rupees we are getting advantages. And transportation cost also because that our mines is very proximate to our CPP so that advantages we are also getting. Both we are getting advantages in our in-house coal supply that is from our own mines.

Pallav Agarwal: Okay. Okay sir. Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. I'll take the next question from Manav Gogia. Please go ahead.

Manav Gogia: Yes. Hi. Very good morning and thank you for the opportunity.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Good morning.

Manav Gogia: So, you had mentioned the cost of production of alumina at 20,000 to 21,000 rupees per ton. Can you provide the same for the aluminium segment as well?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Aluminium our cost is around 1,50,000.

Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director (Finance): 1,55,000 to 1,60,000 it is varying within that range only, the aluminium product, because that is depende d upon our product basket. I am talking about the average cost of metal. The more we go for old product the cost may vary. But the range is within 1,55,000 to 1,60,000.

Manav Gogia: Sure sir. Got it. So, one question if you could provide the nu mber for the landed cost of the caustic soda for the quarter.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: I think it was something cost was 44,000 something...increased slightly. You see the landed cost of causti c soda, if you see Q1 FY2024 25, it was 36,300. This quarter this year, FY25 26, it is 44,301. So, it has increased if you compare to Q1 of last year. If you compare Q4 last quart er.... (inaudible) 44,000 is the price which we are getting now.

Manav Gogia: Sure, sure sir. Got it. Thank you so much. That's all from my end and all the very best. Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. We'll take the next question from Shrikant Hemant. Please go ahead.

Shrikant Hemant: Yeah, thanks again for the opportunity. Three more questions f rom my side. So, first is what is our total

coal requirement and how m uch of this still needs to be purchased externally.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

18 | Page

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : Total coal requirement is around 7.2 million ton. So, we are already producing around 4 MT from our internal and 3 to 3.2 MT we'll be taking from coal India, MCL. Shrikant Hemant: Understood. Very helpful. Second is regarding our bauxite mine s. So, when do the leases for the existing mines expire?

Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma, Director (Production): Presently we are operating two mines and the present validity, is in 2029 and 2031. And we will initiate process for renewal also. So, this is the situation.

Shrikant Hemant: Understood. And the last question is regarding long-term alumina contracts. So is it safe to assume that roughly 75% of alumina exports would be on spot and rest would be on long-term c ontracts. Is that understanding correct?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : I think long-term will be on the lesser side because we had done one long-term tender, we did not get sufficient price, was not very good. So as of now we are aiming to go more on the spot. Maybe it will some where around 80% spot and 20 long-term.

Shrikant Hemant: This was very helpful. That's all from my side.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD : Thank you.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you. A couple of questions from my side as well. So, regarding the brownfield aluminium project where you said t he DPR is currently ongoing. So, have we identified a new technology partner since there were certain challenges with the previous partner.

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technology): Yeah. The new technology supplier, we have already finalized it and in another three four months I ast time. I told the same thing in 3 to 4 months' time we'll onboard the new technology s upplier.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: So, DPR preparation since you said it's ongoing so that would be basis finalization of t he technology supplier right? o r is it something which happens after the technology supplier is identified?

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technology): I didn't get your question can you come again please?

See, DPR preparation, this technology suppliers' input is required. So by the time we are fixing up who will be preparing our DPR, this technology suppliers would be finalized and they'll be onboarded. We have almost finalized the things now we are doing the formalities. Being a PSU, we have to go through a process and very soon we'll be onboarding the technology supplier.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

19 | Page

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Understood. And, so the next question was on the wind capacity that's commissioning that you said 10 MW. So, what platform are we looking at and what is the rated capacity of these turbines? Are we looking at the latest turbines? Are we looking?

Shri Jagdish Arora, Director (Projects & Technology): It was actually a very long project which went into NCLT, but this now 10 MW, 1.5 megawatt is the capacity of each turbine and six such turbines would start producing it. So, we'll be getting clearances from MNRE and State of Tamil Nadu. In this month we'll finalize this and, then we'll start utilizing it. We'll see, what and how is the best possibility of utilizing this.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Okay, understood. So, I missed your, I think a participant asked this question. I missed that point. So, could you just reiterate what is the

export proportion of alumina sales and, do I stand correct in understanding that around 75 or 80% of your export sales are in on the spot basis right?

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: You want to know the volume of export sales as compared to domestic?

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Yes, Alumina.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: If we see this year what I was telling every month, maybe four shipment we are doing export. So that comes to around 1,20,000. In between some month we are doing four shipment, some month five shipment also. Average 1,20,000 and domestic sale will be around monthly if you see monthly domestic sale will be around in 20,000, in between 20,000 to 25,000, maximum 20,000. So that will be around maybe 15% to 20% of, 15% of the total. Volume will be going into domestic market.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Understood. And like 70 to 80% of the export would be on spot basis.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Yes. 80% on spot and maybe 20% will be going on long term basis.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Okay Sir. That's it from my side.

I think we are done from all the participant questions as well. So, I hand over to the management for any closing remarks. Then we can conclude the call.

Shri Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary: Thank you ma'am and thank you all our esteemed participants, analysts and our institutional investors for reposing confidence in NALCO time and again and coming in such a huge number with so many questions, giving insight to our production, our marketing activity it's also about the expansion diversification activities. And we hope and expect the same kind of cooperation in future also and I just hand over the mic to our CMD sir just to close the Investor Call.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 08.08.2025

20 | Page

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, CMD: Once again on behalf of everyone present here all our Directors, I would like to thank all the investors, analysts and everyone connected through VC for going through NALCO's results and giving confidence in NALCO. Whatever your queries I hope we have explained them well. One thing which, I would like to tell on behalf of our Board that as far as NALCO is concerned, NALCO's performance, we are trying to increase the volumes.

We are trying to improve our techno-economics. As far as market is concerned, every time market is not in our hand, the prices, the demands are not in our hand. What is in our hand is to increase the volume, maximize the production and increase the techno so as to reduce

the cost. That already we have taken, very challenging target this year as compared to previous year. We have taken at least maybe 10% higher targets in all the areas and in as far as first quarter is concerned we have achieved all those targets. We are very much sure we will be achieving those targets. So, at the end of the year the financials will be very good.

What advantage we have? We have both upward and downward integration. Upward integration may we have our own bauxite mines, where we're getting very good quality bauxite, sufficient quantity of bauxite. Now we are having our own coal mines from where we at least maybe 60% of coal we are getting, which is again giving advantage to us.

We are having JV with GACL for having caustic soda that is again giving a security as far as caustic soda is concerned. Our power plant as far as power security is concerned that is our own captive power plant where we produce the power at the rate of maybe 3 to 3.5 or 3.10 rupees per unit, that again is giving advantage to us. So, lot of advantages as far as our total integration is concerned.

Now we are going in for expansion

on mode. The refinery will come next year. Our target now is to expedite the expansion of smelter along with the power plant that we are aiming to next 3 to four year, it should come, so that whatever alumina we are producing excess of alumina, should be converted to aluminium.

So, after that only this overall turnover of the company will go above 25,000 to become a Maharatna company, that is our target and with all the things going we are hoping whatever we are planning we'll be able to do it.

So, thank you once again in having confidence in NALCO and sharing all your experiences with us. Thank you. Thank you very much.

Shweta Dikshit, Systematics Group: Thank you sir. Thank you for hosting the call and thank you all the participants for joining in. We now conclude the call.

Shri Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary: Okay, thank you. With this we come to an end of this session. Thank you all.

Call: Nov 2025

National Aluminium Company Limited
(A Government of India Enterprise)
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■■■■■/Ref. : NBC/S/4.5 & 4.5(A)/2025/1883
■■■■■/Dated:10.11.2025

To,
■■■■■/The Manager
■■■■■ ■■■■■■/BSE Limited,
■■■■■ ■■■■■■ ■■■■■■/
Phiroj Jeejeebhoy Towers,
■■■■■ ■■■■■/Dalal Street,
■■■■■/MUMBAI - 400 001
■■■■ ■■■■/Scrip Code: 532234 To,
■■■■■/The Manager
■■■■■ ■■■■■/Listing Department
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National Stock Exchange of India Ltd.,
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Exchange Plaza, Bandra-Kurla Complex,
■■■■■ ■■/Bandra East,
■■■■■/MUMBAI -400 051
■■■■■/Symbol: NATIONALUM

■■■■■/Sub: 07.11.2025 ■■ ■■■■■ ■■ ■ ■■■■ ■■■ ■■ ■■■■■■/
Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call held on 07.11.2025.

■■■■■/Dear Sir,

Further to our letter dated 08.11.2025 and pursuant to Regulation 30 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, enclosed please find the transcripts of the Earnings Conference Call held on 07.11.2025 for discussions on Company's business and outlook post declaration of Unaudited Financial Results for 2nd Quarter ended 30th September, 2025

Neither any Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI) was shared during the aforesaid Earnings Conference Call nor is mentioned in the enclosed transcripts

This is for your information and record.

■■■■■/Thanking you.

■■■■■/Yours faithfully,
■ ■ ■■ ■■■■■ ■ ■■■■■■■ ■ ■ ■■■ ■■■■■■ /
For National Aluminium Co. Ltd.

(■■■. ■ ■. ■■■§) / (B.K. Sahu)
■ ■ ■■■ ■■■■ ■■■ ■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■ /
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
ACS: 9953
Page 1 of 27

"National Aluminium Company Limited
Q2 & H1 FY '26 Earnings Conference Call"
November 07, 2025

NALCO MANAGEMENT TEAM

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh – Chairman-cum-Managing Director
Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak – Director (HR)
Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria – Director (Finance)
Shri Bharat Kumar Sahu – Company Secretary

MODERATOR

Ms. Shweta Dikshit – Systematix Group

National Aluminium Company Limited
November 07, 2025
Page 2 of 27

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Earnings Call of National Aluminium Company Limited, NALCO, post declaration of the financial results for quarter and half year ended September 2025, hosted by Systematix. As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes.

Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star and then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Shweta Dikshit from Systematix Group. Thank you and over to you, ma'am.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you, operator. Good evening, everyone. On behalf of Systematix, we welcome you to the 2Q FY '26 and first half FY '26 earnings conference call of NALCO Limited. I would like to thank the management for giving us this opportunity to host the call.

I now hand over to Mr. Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary, NALCO, to discuss the company's financial and operational performance for the second quarter and first half FY '26. Over to you, sir.

Bharat Sahu: Good evening. Namaste. Greetings from National Aluminium Company Limited and Navratna CPSE under the Ministry of Mines. I take pleasure in introducing NALCO team in today's post-earning call. NALCO management is represented by Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh, Chairman and Managing Director, Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak, Director HR, and Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director Finance. Myself, Bharat Kumar Sahu, Company Secretary of NALCO.

Today, NALCO published an impressive Q2 and H1 results after the Board took it on record in the meeting held in the afternoon. A presentation in this regard is already uploaded in the website in both the stock exchange site as well. And now, I request our CMD, sir, to kindly highlight the results and the outlook of the company. Over to you, sir.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Good evening, everybody. Myself, B.P. Singh, CMD, NALCO, and with me, my Director HR, Dr. Tapas Pattanayak, and Director Finance, Shri Abhay Behuria is here. We are very glad to inform that with the dedicated efforts of all National Aluminium Company Limited
November 07, 2025
Page 3 of 27

the employees of the NALCO, we have been able to record best ever Q2 and H1 performance, both in the terms of production and financial.

Our Q2 performance and H1 performance has been excellent. If you see Q2 performance, like to like Q2, '24, '25, our excavation, bauxite excavation increased by around 13%. Alumina production increased by around 15%, Q2, Q2 compared to last year. And cast metal production also increased by around 3.48%. Our overall revenues from operations increased by 7.27%. And expenses

reduced by around 3.34%.

Overall, if we compare PBT and PAT, we see around 34% increase in PAT is there compared to Q2 last year. If we compare H1 performance of last '24, '25, and H1 performance '25 to '26, there is a substantial jump in that, like excavation has increased by around 6.25%, bauxite excavation, calcined alumina production has increased by 31.33%, cast metal production has increased by 3%. Revenues from operation has increased by 18%. Our profit, PBT, Profit Before Tax has increased by 47% and PAT by around 50.2%. Alumina sales has also increased by around 81%. The major contributor, if we see H1, compare H1 of '24, '25, and '25, '26, has been the increase in volumes. Our alumina volume has increased substantially. And our efficiencies, efficiencies have also increased. The increase in volume has given us around INR700 crores and efficiency has given us around INR300 crores if we see compared to last year H1. So that is the performance and we are continuously striving

to improve the performance of the company. Our expansion plans are also there. Our refinery expansion is there. Almost 80% of the expansion is complete and we are planning next year, June '26, to commission the refinery, 1 million ton refinery, wherein our existing refinery capacity, which is around 2.1 million ton, will become around 3.1 million ton.

And in smelter also we have a plan of expansion that in coming days we are going to plan, which is, we are planning to bring a 5 lakh ton smelter in next three to four, four to five years by 2030. So, we are having a robust, very good result, both in terms of physical and financial.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 4 of 27

Any queries from, any questions from the participants who are there in the conference call? We would like to take on the questions.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. Anyone who wishes to ask a question may press star and one on the touchtone telephone. If you wish to remove yourself from the queue, you may press star and 2. Participants are requested to please use handsets while asking a question.

Ladies and gentlemen, we will wait for a moment while the question queue assembles. Our first question comes from the line of Amit Lahoti from Emkay. Please go ahead.

Amit Lahoti: Yeah, thanks for the opportunity and congratulations on a good set of numbers. So, my first question is on Alumina, where we are doing the expansion project. Are we on track to achieve commissioning in early FY '27 as per the previously guided plan?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: We are not getting you properly. Can you be a bit louder? Our feed stream plan, expansion plan, earlier it was scheduled to be completed in September 25, but it has got slightly delayed and now we have our revised target is June 2026. Already we have revised it earlier. Now we are on track and whatever timelines of June 2026 we have taken; we will commission it in June 2026.

Amit Lahoti: Okay, my second question is we sold more volumes in Q2 than in Q1. What is our inventory management strategy here? Could we see more sales volumes in Q3 as well, more than the production numbers?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: You are talking in terms of Alumina?

Amit Lahoti: Yeah.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Alumina, as far as our Alumina sales are concerned, whatever production we are doing, around 50% of the production is getting consumed in the smelter.

Rest of the production is to be sold in domestic and export market. Of course, export is the main market we are doing the selling.

But our inventory, which we have a carrying capacity of around 75 lakh tons in our Vizag silos and around 35,000 tons in Vizag and 36,000 tons in

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 5 of 27

Damanjodi. So, we cannot store a lot of material there. So, whatever we are producing, we have to sell it.

So, on an average, we are planning those four to five shipments per month will be exporting to outside and our domestic sales will be around in between 10,000 to 12,000 tons in the remaining months.

Amit Lahoti: Okay. And lastly, do we have any hedging volumes in alumina, any hedge in volume

and prices?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: No, we have not gone to that area because most of the product of aluminum is our domestic sales. So, we have not tried to go for the hedging, because our price mechanism is very transparent and based on our LME. So, that we don't feel is required for NALCO now. So, we have not gone into that into hedging.

Amit Lahoti: Okay. Thank you and all the best.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Aditya Welekar from Axis Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Welekar: Yes, sir. Thank you for the opportunity. My question is with respect to our fifth stream of alumina refineries. So, how much are we targeting for FY '27? In our earlier

call, we had said a number of five to six lakh tons. So, is that number intact and can we expect a full ramp up in FY '28?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes. Yes. That will be the full ramp up there and whatever we have planned of 5 lakh tons, that will come, because in June when we will commission, we will be having around eight months to nine months in hand. So, 5 lakh tons is the plan which we are having now also. And FY '28 will be the full ramp up.

Aditya Welekar: Understood. And coming on the smelter expansion. So, in the earlier call, you have said that we will file for DPR in next two months to three months. So, at what stage are we, is the DPR ready now or it is pending?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: No. No. In the earlier call, whatever I have told, that was not two months to three months DPR preparation. That was the appointment of consultant. Our

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 6 of 27

plan as of now is that both for CPP and smelter, our DPR, we have appointed the consultant for CPP and DPR for consultant for smelter is on the process. This month it will be appointed. They will be taking six months to make the DPR.

Our plan is at '26 June, maybe June, July, the DPR will be ready and we will take it to the board. And after board approval, we will start the tendering process and complete the all ordering by '27 March. And after that, the actual groundwork will start. And from there, three years to three and a half years will be the timeline for commissioning of the plant. Means somewhere around 2030 last, December 2030. That is the plan which we are having.

Aditya Welekar: Understood. Understood. So, basically our capex for that smelter will start, will kick start from '27 onwards, right? Is that understanding correct?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes. Start from '27 onwards, yes. In financial year '27, '28 it will come. Correct.

Aditya Welekar: And what will be our guidance?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Three years to four years.

Aditya Welekar: Go ahead. Sorry.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Total capex, total capex involvement.

Aditya Welekar: Yes. So for '26...

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Total capex involvement for smelter. For smelter, the capex required will be around INR17,000 crores to 20,000 crores. And for power plant, it will be around INR10,000 crores to 11,000 crores. So, combined if you see, it will come to around INR30,000 crores.

Aditya Welekar: Right. So, from the first -- from FY '27, on a ballpark basis, what kind of capex means we can expect, we can build in and what will be guidance of capex for '26 -- FY '26?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Hi. Yes. Very good question. If you see the balance sheet and net worth of the company and the cash generation being made from every year. And

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 7 of 27

presently we are having -- end of this September, we are having a cash balance of around -- cash and that is total -- cash and equivalent -- cash equivalent, it is INR7,900. And if you go on earning profit in this rate, then we will have a balance of near about INR20,000 plus.

But we don't think our requirement is INR30,000, okay. There are two models we are now interpreting to go for this capex. One is smelter EPC and power at JV. If you go to the project in EPC mode, we may need at the end of the year, '27, '28 or '28, '29, the requirement of fund will be around INR5,000

crores to INR6,000 crores. Because our cash balance will take care of the intermediate payment. If you go to the second model, EPC on seller and JV, 50% JV power, then we may not require any outsourced support to finance our project. This is out of the projection which we have made.
Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Vikas Singh from ICICI Securities.
Vikas Singh: Thank you, sir, for the opportunity and congratulations

on good set of numbers. Sir, just coming back to our alumina sales. So we probably have brought down the inventory now. So how should we look at the second half total alumina sales vis-à-vis annual guidance? Hello?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes. H2 also our -- whatever our alumina sales, like H1, we have done the sales of around 7 lakh tons. So H2 also, our overall yearly plan was around 12 lakh tons to 12.5 lakh tons. So H2 sales will be around maybe somewhere around 6 lakh tons to 6.5 lakh tons of sales will be there.

Vikas Singh: Noted. And how should we look at the average prices? What prices was the average you have seen in the 2Q for both alumina and alumina?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Average prices if you see in Q2, the average price which we got was around \$380. But as of now -- as of date, the spot prices are around \$320. So H2, we are expecting somewhere, if it is slightly favorable, it will be somewhere in between \$320 to \$340.

Vikas Singh: Okay.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Alumina. And if you total...

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 8 of 27

Vikas Singh: Okay.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Metal our -- if you see metal LME in the Q2 was around INR2,597, around INR2,600. And in the remaining, as of now, the LME is around INR2,850. So the projection is there, it will go to INR3,000 also, but it all depends. We are expecting that in H2, the LME will somewhere be in between INR2,800 to INR2,900.

Vikas Singh: Noted. Sir, any progress we have made in the KABIL joint venture which we have tried in the Argentina or any other rare earth metal? Because there is a lot of buzz that we are looking to some of the rare earth metals. So if you could give us some idea about those segments?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: As far as KABIL is concerned, KABIL, we have got five mines in Argentina and this all five mines non-invasive exploration is complete. We have done the non-invasive exploration. After that, now we have to go for invasive exploration. The results of non-invasive exploration was good. Non-invasive means we do it from the surface, from the top. Now we have to do the drilling and see the actual depth where the lithium is available.

So for that, the appointment of consultant has been done. This consultant is going to appoint an exploration agent which will be done in the next one month or two months. This exploration agent will start the exploration. And next six months, we will be knowing the results at what height, at what depth the lithium is present. After that, it is the responsibility of the exploration agent to set up a pilot plant. They will set up a pilot plant there.

And the result of the pilot plant regarding the grade of lithium and the commercial mining, that will come in the next eight months to nine months. Means next one year, one and a half years, next one year and a half years, we'll be able to know whether the commercial mining there is possible or not. But since there are already operational mines there, the Chinese mines are already operating in the nearby area, we are quite hopeful that the lithium will be there and the commercial mining will be there. But after this exploration,

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 9 of 27

next one and a half years, we'll come to know what level of commercial mining we have to do.

Vikas Singh: Noted. And sir, just one last question. This fifth stream of alumina value will be completing next year. What -- by that time, what would be the total capex you would have invested in this project, basically? So -- and what is now the restated IRR giving the alumina prices are lower, plus the Pottangi bauxite mine update by when you are expecting it to start?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: As far as the total capex is concerned, the total capex is around...

Management: INR5,000.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: INR5,000, INR100 crores,

INR200 crores, INR300 crores alumina projects.

Somewhere around that will come total for alumina. But as of now, we are seeing the alumina prices are on the lower side. Depends on the global scenario of the ability of the bauxite, ability of the alumina, it can go high also. It is very difficult to calculate the IRR. But whatever we are seeing, whatever our cost of production of alumina will be there.

We will be getting at least -- we will be having a positive margin to that.

Minimum we will be getting a 10,000 plus of margin to that of in our export market or in the domestic market. So we will be having a positive margin in alumina. As far as Pottangi mines is concerned, this month itself we are going to order the MDO tender. And our target is June -- by June we have to start the mines.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Kirtan Mehta from Baroda BNP Paribas Mutual Fund.

Kirtan Mehta: The first question was about our refinery expansion. We have mentioned that we have achieved 80% physical completion. Could you highlight what are the key packages pending within 20% completion and what are their timelines? And the second related question was, what is the actual capital spent that we have done so far? And how is our plan for sort of the rest of FY '27, as well as FY '27 on the capital capex spent for the refinery?

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 10 of 27

Brijendra Pratap Singh: As far as the physical completion of the project, around maybe 77%, 80% -- 7%, 78% is done. And a few of the packages like precipitation tank, hydrate filtration, calcination, evaporation, these are the four or five packages which are very critical, and these four or five packages and the rest later is on the electrification. That is the laying of cable and final instrumentation and automation job, which is the last thing to be done.

So, all these timelines what we are taking is almost the structural work, structural action, equipment direction of these critical packages will be over by March, April. And from that, three months for overall electrical layout of the cables and connections and trial and testing. So, that will take maybe three months. So, June we are targeting. In June, we will start the commissioning process. As far as the capex expenditure is concerned, till date we have done around INR4,500 crores of capex expenditure in this project.

Kirtan Mehta: What is the plan for the H2 FY '26, as well as FY '27? If you can break up your capex plan as well.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: What do you exactly need?

Kirtan Mehta: No. I was asking.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: We can explain, till May...

Kirtan Mehta: For the balance in FY '26, how much capex you plan to spend on the refinery and what would be your spend on the refinery for FY '27?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: By end of the FY '2, '26, our capex expenditure, we have already accumulated expenditure is INR4,500 crores, and remaining four months, we are expecting to be spend around INR600 crores to INR700 crores on a refinery part. And the balance since the completion date, what CMDR has told is by June, we will be completing this project. And project closure will be there. The balance 10% to 5% payment will be released in that year, FY '26, '27. By FY '26, '27, the project payment and expenditure will be closed totally.

Kirtan Mehta: Also, you mentioned about that they will earn minimum margin of around 10,000 per ton on this project. How does this compare with our existing alumina refinery, this

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 11 of 27

margin? I mean, what would be the difference between new refinery and existing refinery?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: On our -- Existing will be slightly better, because the depreciation will be not there. We do not -- we will not be having interest. But in this refinery, the cost will be on the lower

side because the manpower requirement will be less. It will be having a better efficiency. The caustic soda cost consumption will be less. The volume with one stream.

Now, in the existing, with four streams, we are making 2.1 million tons. But in the new one, with just one stream, we will be making 1 million tons. So, we will be getting the benefit of increased volumes, increased efficiencies. So, the cost, whatever cost we are incurring now, only slight increase, maybe INR1,000 or INR2,000 tons per ton increase in the cost will be there. So, presently, we are getting a margin -- clear margin of around 12,000 tons, 13,000 tons, 14,000 tons. Maybe that will come down to maybe 11,000 tons in the expansion refinery alumina.

Kirtan Mehta: So, when we say 11,000, it will be the combined operating in EBIT margin that we are talking about, correct? For the combined operation, total revenue in the refinery?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Total margin. Alumina, we are talking about alumina. Alumina cost, whatever our total cost of alumina and whatever real estate we will get, the difference will be there, will be around 10,000 to 11,000.

Kirtan Mehta: Sure, sir. And one last question.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes, yes, sir. Sorry, sir. Please go on.

Kirtan Mehta: One last question from our side. Could you remind us, basically, the sensitivity of our profit to \$100 change in alumina price and \$10 change in aluminum price? Aluminum price, \$100 and \$10 change in alumina price.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yeah, if it's still \$100 [inaudible] whatever realization we have achieved in the H1, and there is a fluctuation of alumina price almost 50 in the last, first of the year, and after [inaudible]. So, we are able to sustain that. No issue.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 12 of 27

But if it is whereas \$100 fluctuation will be there from the present level, that may affect somehow. But our cost, since the gap is much more between our cost of production and the realization. So, we'll not be affected much.

And what will happen now, if we are to support a setback in alumina segment, then our metal price will be definitely higher. It will take care of the shortfall, which we are expecting in alumina. So, as a whole company, as a whole, we'll not be affected much.

Kirtan Mehta: Sure, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Shweta Diks hit from Systematix Group. Please go ahead.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you. So, I have one question regarding the commissioning timelines. When we are targeting commissioning by June, when do we expect the commercial production to begin? What is the likely to be the ramp-up schedule? So, I wanted to understand how we are targeting 5 lakh tons of alumina sales in , incremental alumina sales in FY27?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Commissioning, when we'll start in the commissioning in June, it will take around 2 to 3 months to ramp up the production. To the maybe 60 %-70% level. That's why we are targeting around 50% of the production we'll be achieving in the next year of 10 lakhs, 5 lakhs we'll be doing.

If we start in the June, maybe somewhere in August, September, we'll be able to. Because it is a chemical plant, it doesn't take a lot of time. 3 to 4 months, we can reach to maybe 70%-80% of the rated capacity. If everything is okay. That is our target.

So next year, that's why we are planning, we'll be having full 6 months in hand. After September. That's why maybe we are planning 5 lakh tons of production will come from the refinery, new refinery.

Shweta Dikshit: So, but then we are looking at half a million ton of capacity and expecting it to utilize that half a million ton at almost 100%. So is that, it might be theoretically possible,

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 13 of 27

but does it seem to be practically possible that we achieve

the remaining 6 months,

we go, we achieve almost close to 100%?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Remaining 6 months, maybe we'll be ending up with somewhere around 70%-80%. Depends on how the commissioning goes. That depends. That's why we have planned, we'll be doing around 5 lakhs. Maybe. And as far as sales is concerned, we are targeting domestic markets to increase our sales in the

domestic market.

And we are targeting some long-term buyers. We are splitting on UI to have long-term customers from maybe Dubai [inaudible] or somewhere who have a long-term tie-up with us. So that our, whatever increase in volumes of alumina will be there, that will get absorbed there.

Shweta Dikshit: All right, noted sir. Thank you.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Pinakin from HSBC. Please go ahead. Pinakin, your line has been unmuted. You may proceed with your question.

As we are not receiving a response from the current participant in the queue, we will move to the next participant. Our next question comes from the line of Pallav Agarwal from Antique Stock Broking. Please go ahead.

Pallav Agarwal: Yeah, good evening, sir. So first question was on the divergence between -- hello? Am I audible?

Moderator: Sir, you are audible. You may proceed.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Can you be a bit louder?

Pallav Agarwal: Yeah, so the first question was, you know, on the divergence between aluminium and alumina prices. You know, so normally alumina is probably at a 14%-15% off the spot LME aluminium prices over the long-term.

So, recently we have seen that alumina has been pretty weak, whereas aluminium has continued to go up. So any particular reason, you know, for the weaker alumina prices right now?

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 14 of 27

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Weaker alumina is basically due to the availability of the alumina. In Indonesia, around two or three refineries have started in Indonesia and some smelting capacities have also gone down in a few of the areas. In China also they have restricted their capacities.

In some other areas, some smelters also their capacities have gone down. So that's why the availability of the alumina is more in the market, which has caused to the pressure, price pressure on the alumina.

Pallav Agarwal: Okay. And what about, you know, the alumina, the Chinese alumina refineries, their cost structure is pretty high. So, because probably they're based on imported bauxite from Guinea or some other imported countries.

So, you think that, you know, we've not really seen alumina trading below \$300 for a sustained period of time. So is there a possibility that you can see some recovery in alumina prices, you know, over the medium term?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Of late, normally in the Q3 and Q4, the productions at all places are on the higher side in the recovery of the prices. Historically, we see in the Q3 and Q4, we get better prices. So we are expecting to go somewhere around 350, it should go.

Pallav Agarwal: Sure, sir. Also, you know, on the cost part, are we seeing any inflation in, cost for, you know, CP coke or CT pitch on the aluminum or caustic soda and the alumina side? So can there be an increase in the cost in the second half?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Second half, actually first half itself, the cost was on the higher side, the cost of CP coke and caustic soda has increased. So I think the level that will be maintained on that will be slightly go down also, because if we see from last September price, the CP coke last September was around 30,600. And this September and it was around 42,000.

So it is already on the higher side. And even caustic soda has increased from 37,000 to 41,000. So we are not expecting to further increase. It may slightly go down or remain at the same level.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07

, 2025

Page 15 of 27

Pallav Agarwal: Okay, sir. So lastly, on the coal. So, I think we would be ramping up a captive coal further. So can we expect that the power and fuel costs will remain in the monsoon quarter also? Earlier we used to see a big jump in power and fuel costs in NALCO. So we have now seen that moderating even in the monsoon quarter. So should this trend continue over the next, over the rest of the year?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: If you see power and fuel costs compared to H1, H1, it decreased by around INR53 crores. Where the price of the coal, we got a favorable of around

INR36 crores was there. And due to volume increase of power, that at INR245 crores adverse was there.
But efficiency led to around INR135 crores favorable. So it was almost same, only INR53 crores difference was there compared to H1 last year as far as power and fuel is concerned.

Pallav Agarwal: Yes, sir. So with captive coal increasing...

Brijendra Pratap Singh: In the many years also -- captive coal, of course, compared to last year, this year we are increasing. Last year it was around 2.6 or 2.7 million tons. This year we will be doing around 4 million tons. But the cost of whatever FSA coal we are procuring from MCL, Coal India, that is also not very high. And with the removal of CESS on the coal, we are getting -- we will be getting advantage on the procurement of coal from MCL where we will be getting advantage of around INR67 crores in H2. So almost captive coal and MCL coal will be almost same and maybe reduction of power cost will be further there in H2 with the removal of this CESS.

Pallav Agarwal: Sure, sir. Okay. Thank you so much.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. We have our next question from the line of Sumangal Nevatia from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 16 of 27

Sumangal Nevatia: Yeah. Good evening, sir, and thank you for the chance. Sir, I missed a few details. So, please excuse if it is a repeat. So, my first question is on the refinery, how much have we spent till date as on September?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Already we have told around INR4,500 crores expenditure has been made in our 15 refineries.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. And, sir, on the Pottangi mines?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Pottangi mines, already we are in the process of appointing MDO. This month, we'll be appointing MDO. And our target is June next year we will be starting the mines.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. Okay. So, in case there is delay in the mine conditioning, what is the plan B for the initial few months in case there is a delay?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Already we have a separate project where alternate sourcing of bauxite is there. We are making a parallel conveyor downhill from our existing mines, perforated mines, which will be having a capacity of around 30 lakh tons per year. So, that will get commissioned in April-May next year.

So, till the actual production from Pottangi starts or if it gets delayed by a few months, the production from this alternate sourcing of bauxite will come. So, there will not be a shortage of bauxite for the expanded refinery.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood, sir. So, from the new refinery, what will be the cost? How will be the cost different from the existing refinery? You explained on the profit. If you can just share, what is the cost difference given the employee efficiency and the overall economics?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: You see, in the existing refinery, we have the capacity of 2.1 million tons, which is done from four streams. So, there the manpower cost is very high.

And in the new refinery, only one stream will be doing around 1 million tons.

So, the manpower requirement will be less.

And it is with the latest technology, which is high-pressure digestion technology, where the caustic soda consumption will be on the lower side

and

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 17 of 27

other efficiencies will also further increase. So, what we are expecting that there will not be much increase in the prices.

There will be -- we will be getting advantage of manpower cost and efficiencies in technology and all that. Of course, the excess expenditure on depreciation cost will be there. Interest is not there because we have not taken any loan for that. Some depreciation cost will be added to our production costs. So, maybe it will be almost same or maybe one or two thousand more than the existing price.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. Okay. So, fine. Sir, on the coal mine, what is the production of captive coal in the first half and how much have we bought from outside?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Our annual target is around 4 million tons. So, first half we have done almost around 2 million tons. Somewhere around 2 million tons we have done the production. So, we will be nearing around 2 million tons. 1.96 million tons already we have done. So, we are on the target of doing around 4 million tons. We will be completing in the year end.

Sumangal Nevatia: And sir, our requirement is close to 6.5, 7, is that right? So, remaining 3 million ton annually we are...?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Our requirement is around 7.2 million tons, 7, 7.2 million tons. So, 4 million tons we will be getting from here and around 3 million tons from our FSA, that is MCL, from Mahanadi Coalfield.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. And sir, entirely we are buying from them under FSA. We are not buying anything from the auction, right?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: No, no. e-auction we are not taking of late. We are only taking through that FSA.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. And sir, the cost after the [inaudible] removal, you said for the captive versus the FSA, it is very similar delivered at the plant?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: The delivery cost after including FET, it is around [inaudible]. But presently the coal is being procured through FSA. And the coal being produced internally, National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 18 of 27

captivated, there is a difference of INR300 to INR400. But after removal of the CESS, INR400 per ton. So, I think both the costs will be almost equal.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. Understood. And just one last question, are we buying any power from the grid or it is entirely captive?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Actually, earlier we used to buy power from the grid whenever there is any problem near CPP. But it is a good thing to notice that this year we have reduced purchase power to minimum. Last year we have purchased almost 3,81,000,000 units from Grid Coal, which is a very costly one.

But this year up to September, we have only used 77 lakhs per million units.

Because we have produced more power from our internal CPP plant. So, there is a substantial saving by not purchasing power from the Grid Coal.

Purchasing the power from [inaudible] through our internal source.

Sumangal Nevatia: And going forward, sir, will that go completely or remain at this level? Around 77,000.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: So, last year we have purchased the power. CPP, INR186 crores was 24, 25 and INR186 crores. And this year we have purchased only for INR 50 crores.

So, around INR136 crores of saving in H1 is there compared to last year. As far as purchase power from the grid is concerned.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. And sir, going forward, is it likely to completely become captive or this is the level which will continue?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: We have got a capacity of around 1,200 megawatts. We normally have 10 units running. 10 units installed of 120 megawatts. So, we do an annual overhauling of one unit and we keep one unit in standby.

Sometimes due to some issues, some breakdowns, sometimes we have to shut down the running boilers or maybe turbines. Some issues are the

re. Then only

we do take the power from grid. Otherwise, the total captive power is there.

Sumangal Nevatia: Understood. And sir, just one last. Got it. Got it. And sir, when is the mine lead renewal due for our existing bauxite mine?

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 19 of 27

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Existing bauxite mine renewal, I think it is up to '29. We will have to find out and check it.

Bharat Sahu: 29.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: 29. We have north and central block and south block. So, central block is up to 29 and south block is up to 35, I think. We will have to check up the data.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. So, after the expiry and renewal, what is the increase in royalty cost which will happen?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: If you see the Mineral Conservation Rule, there is a condition that the renewal will be given for another 20 years to the government company. There is a concession in the Mineral Conservation Rule which has been 2015 and thereafter amended.

There is a provision that the government company will be given another 20 years lease. They may charge some extra royalty that is not known to us till now. But there is a certainty that we will be getting that mine. But what premium they will be charging, that is not known till now. That depends upon the government policy.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. Okay. So, for iron ore, it is 150% of existing royalty. So, I just wanted to know.

Management: Yeah. I don't know. Iron ore is there. For Bauxite, it is not -- clarity is not there.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Iron ore, after 2015, any renewal of the mines, 150% extra. But the government is now thinking to change that. There is news that the government is trying to withdraw that additional royalty which they are imposing on iron ore mines.

Sumangal Nevatia: Got it. And sir, any forecast on the employee cost? That has been quite stable. So, what do we expect for this full year and next year, employee cost?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Employee cost, our employee cost, if you see the percentage wise, it is around 18%. And with the retirements coming, few of the senior level people will get retired. It is not going to increase. It will reduce. Maybe it will come down to maybe 15% base. Because how long it will go, reduction will be there. So,

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 20 of 27

the volumes are also increasing. So, it will reduce by maybe 2-3%, not much.

Because we are planning for some recruitment also.

Sumangal Nevatia: Okay. So, around INR1,800 crores.

Moderator: Sir, sorry to interrupt. We request you to please rejoin the queue if you have further questions. Thank you.

Sumangal Nevatia: Got it. Thank you and all the best.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Tushar Chaudhari from Prabhudas Lilladher Private. Limited. Please go ahead.

Tushar Chaudhari: Yeah, good evening, sir. Thanks for the opportunity. Sir, just wanted to know why our metal sales were lower in this quarter? Production was pretty good.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Metal sales were lower due to less demand from the market. The demand from the market due to excessive of rains. The overall demand, especially wire rods and flat products, the demand was very less. And we are having the stocks, which we will try to clear off in this month. So, stocks are there. That is the reason the demand was very less.

Tushar Chaudhari: And has it improved now in this month? I mean, as monsoon has receded, but -- or do you expect it to improve?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Because it is the beginning of the month. So, projections are there that it will improve further.

Tushar Chaudhari: Secondly, sir, what is our spot-to-contract ratio in alumina sales? On contract basis, we sell how much in this contract for alumina in export market?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: We have a term contract and spot contract. So, we have done

two term

contracts. One term contract is for 3 months and one term contract is for 6 months. So, for next three months, normally every month we do a round four shipments -- four to five shipments. So, next three months, two shipments will be term and two or three will be spot. And after that, next three months also, we will be having around one shipment of term, but we are going for one more

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 21 of 27

term if we get better prices. We are targeting at least 50% should be term and 50% should be spot.

Tushar Chaudhari: Okay, but when prices are higher, you usually try for higher spot, right?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Actually, now the LME is on the higher side, and the forecast is that the LME will go high. So, when the LME is high, it is better to go for term, because the term contract is linked to the LME, and now the spots are very low. The spots are on... just we are getting \$310, \$320.

And like this month itself -- this month itself, whatever our term contract is there, from there we will be getting around \$350, but our spot, we are getting around \$320.

Tushar Chaudhari: Okay, okay. And sir, just in connection with the earlier question, what will be our approximate cost of landed coal from captive mines? I don't know what exact, but it will be less than INR2,500.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Sir, it is around 16 to 17 hundred. It is around INR1,600 to IN R1,700 per ton.

Tushar Chaudhari: Okay, okay.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Landed at our power plant.

Tushar Chaudhari: Landed at our power plant. Thanks a lot, sir. Best of luck.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Thank you.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Rajesh Majumdar from 3 60 One Capital.

Please go ahead.

Rajesh Majumdar: Yeah, good evening, sir. I had a few questions. Sir, the aluminum total revenue for the quarter is about INR2880 crores. If you divide that by the aluminum sales, then the realization is about \$2900. Does that mean that the domestic premium was about 10% this quarter? Or am I reading something wrong here?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Just, if you can just again tell about what you want to know?

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 22 of 27

Rajesh Majumdar: I'm saying the aluminum segment turnover is INR2880 crore. If you divide by the volume, it is giving a price of INR2,57,000, which is about \$2,900 plus. Does that mean that the domestic premium was about 10% this quarter? Is that the right way to look at it? Or is there something else?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Aluminum, as far as aluminum metal is concerned, in metal, most of our metal is here selling in the domestic market. This quarter, Q2, if you see, in Q2, the average LME was around 2597. And Q1 was around 2447. So around \$150 increase in LME was there compared to Q1.

Rajesh Majumdar: No, I understand that, sir. But if you divide the segment revenue by the volume, it is much more than that. It is coming close to \$2,900. So does that mean that domestic premium is... If you can give me the domestic realization in rupees per ton for the quarter, then probably we can reconcile the number, because the domestic premium seems to be very high. It's about 10%.

Management: So, fees per ton, if we see for the quarter, I think it will come somewhere around...

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Quarter 2, it is coming around [inaudible]. Quarter 2, that's the domestic realization.

Rajesh Majumdar: Yes.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: And H1 average, if you take H1 average, including your first quarter also, it is around \$246,000.

Rajesh Majumdar: That means that the domestic premium is close to 10%, sir, above the LME. The domestic premium. India premium. You are suggesting about 10% higher.

Management: Yes. Because of custom duty.

Rajesh Majumdar: And how much is the premium now? Will it be around the similar levels or it will be lower?

r? Because normal range is about 6%-7%, the domestic India premium. Will it be at 10% or will it come down a little bit?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: If you see our pricing mechanism, there are a few factors which decide our price. That's the import custom duty we add and some inland transportation

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 23 of 27

costs from port to the location of the supplier, that we also added. Everything if you added, it is around 10%. You are right.

Rajesh Majumdar: So, going forward, also 10% is the right assumption or will it be like slightly lower than this?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: That we cannot disclose it now. That is our pricing policy and we will discuss and review that, what is best possible. We will keep doing that. Seeing the market condition and all other factors.

Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. And secondly, your aluminum volume for the full year will still be 450,000. That means second half we will do much more than the first half in terms of aluminum volumes.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: So full year we are planning for \$470,000. \$470,000 is our total plan for the full year.

Rajesh Majumdar: On the existing spot lines, how much total volume can we go up to maximum?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: The rated capacity is 450 but this year we are planning 470. And the present rate, whatever rate we are going, we are going at the rate of \$470. The \$2,000 add of whatever we have. So if everything goes okay, we will be able to do at least minimum \$470,000.

Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. And sir, secondly, has your aluminum -- alumina cost of production fallen over

the first quarter? Because if you look at the inter-segment sales of alumina, the realization has fallen per ton on similar production. That means that the cost of production of alumina has fallen for some reason.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes. That is true because we have done excellent job in our technical front, which has given us a very good benefit by reduction in the consumption of caustic soda, which is a major input material for our alumina. So definitely, our costs have come down compared to the first quarter.

Rajesh Majumdar: And that is sustainable according to the cost of production.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 24 of 27

Rajesh Majumdar: And sir, one last question from my side. yes, sir what are you saying.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: What I was telling to the caustic soda prices has also gone down. June 25, the price was around 44,000, the present caustic soda price is around 41,000.

Rajesh Majumdar: And how much are we getting from the JV now, from the Gujarat alkali JV? And what is the cost of the caustic soda?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: JV, whatever cost prices we realized from the market, the same price we took from JV also the discovered price from the market.

Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. So you think that the cost savings that you've got in the production cost is more or less sustainable over the balance part of the year.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes, yes is sustainable. Whatever we -- caustic soda the specific consumption which we are getting now is around 96 kg per ton of Alumina production. So that we'll be able to sustain.

Moderator: Our next question is from the line of Manav Gogia from Yes Securities Limited.

Manav Gogia: Yes, hi. Thank you so much, sir, for the opportunity. Sir, my first question comes for the Metal segment. If I look at the aluminum EBIT for this particular quarter, that has gone up sharply on a quarter-on-quarter basis. Could you highlight the factors for the same?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: You are talking about realization?

Manav Gogia: No, I'm talking about the segment results for Alumina?

Management: Can you please repeat your question?

Manav Gogia: For the segment results for the Alumina segment. Hello?

Management: Yes, please continue.

Manav Go

gia: Yes. So sir, for the segment results for the aluminum segment, we have a number of INR1189.37 crores and the top line of INR2,880 crores that's roughly 41%.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 25 of 27

Brijendra Pratap Singh: You're right, you're right. If you compare the quarter 1 of aluminum segment price and quarter 2. The average price for the quarter 1 was around INR2,37,000, whereas it is the quarter INR255,000. There is a jump of INR18,000 in price per ton of aluminum. That is one of the major factors that aluminum realization in the second quarter is better than the first.

Manav Gogia: Okay. So it's much more pricing led rather than on the cost of production side?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: I think also slightly, we have increased on the volumes also. Like first quarter volume was around 1.15. Second quarter, it was around 1.19, slight increase, around 3%, 3.4% but more fees are from the pricing.

Manav Gogia: Sure. Got it, sir. Sir, my second question is, I might have missed the number earlier. Could you give me what is the targeted sales in the second half for the alumina and in the chemical business?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Alumina yearly sales we have planned of around 12.5 lakh tons of alumina sales. So first half, we have done around 7 lakh tons. For the rest of the year, we will be planning around 6, we'll be reaching around 13 sales. So around like 6, 6.5, we'll be selling Alumina. And as far as metal is concerned, metal sales will almost be same, which is there in the first half. 2.26, we have done in the first half. So if we are producing 4.7%, the rest of the things will be sold.

Moderator: Our next question comes from the line of Siddharth Mehrotra from Kotak Securities.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Just a couple of quick questions. Sir, can you just give me some guidance on your employee cost for example, for this year and next year? I see that they are on a declining trend, but what should that number be?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Employee cost, we are at present it is around 18% of the total cost. If you see

the quarterly expenditure as well as employee benefit is concerned, it is around INR440, it was around INR440 crores this quarter. Earlier quarter was also around INR445 crores. So annual, if you see it will go to around maybe somewhere around INR1,900 crores. And for next year it is around 18% of the total cost.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 26 of 27

Siddharth Mehrotra: Got it, sir. And for next year, around say INR1,650 type of crore, that reduction seems possible or higher?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Next year.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Yes, next year. This year, you have seen INR1,700-odd crores.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Next year, we are going to ask some NPAR, but that cost will be offset by our volume because we are adding new first retirements or also there 200 retirements. It will go slightly we go to around maybe 16% -- 10%, 15% will be the total cost.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Okay. So basically, you're saying that we start some sort of declining in there as well, right? Is that understanding correct, sir?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Yes. The declining trend, of course, will be there because whatever our employees are retiring and here on the highest slab of the basics -- basics and salary and whatever we are recruiting they are on the minimum scale. So the average salary will go down.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Understood. Sir, one small clarification. In an earlier earnings call, we had said that we had increased our alumina inventories. So in this quarter, I see that our alumina sales are much higher, so was there a liquidation of these alumina inventories, which sort of led to much higher alumina sales this quarter? Or was there some other reason?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Alumina [inaudible]. You could think about alumina inventory.

Siddharth Mehrotra:

Correct. So was there a liquidation of this inventory, which led to much higher alumina sales this quarter?

Brijendra Pratap Singh: We have increased the production of -- the production of calcined alumina, some H1 production compared to last year H1, it has increased by 31%. Last year, H1 we have done around INR8.84 lakhs. And this year at H1, we have done around INR11.61 lakh more. So, the production has increased substantially that has led to the increase in the sales.

National Aluminium Company Limited

November 07, 2025

Page 27 of 27

Siddharth Mehrotra: No, sir, I understood that point. Let's say, for example, when I'm talking about alumina sales, you're giving me a full year guidance. In the second half, you are saying that we will do 66.5 lakh tons.

In the first half, we've done 7 lakh tons. So, what I'm saying is that this number is higher because of 2Q, which means that -- was there some sort of inventory sales from alumina as well contributing to this.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: It is not there earlier, inventory was there, once our stocks of alumina in the March 2025 was at the minimum level. So whatever sales we have done is on the production, because you see we have done the alumina production of 11.61 lakh tons and metal production -- cast metal production was 2.34, so 2.34 means for that, we require alumina of around 5% -- 4.6% from 11.63% reduced 4.6%. So that's somewhere around 7%, it will come. So 7 lakh we have sold.

Siddharth Mehrotra: Got it sir, got it. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, we will take that as a last question. I would now like to hand the conference over to Shri Bharat Kumar Sahu, Company Secretary, NALCO, for closing comments. Over to you, sir.

Bharat Kumar Sahu: Yes. Thank you, operator. Thanks to Systematix group for taking keen interest in our financials of NALCO, and we always solicit this kind of response and this kind of support from your end, year-on-year basis. Thank you all for giving time to NALCO and participating in this conference call. Once again, thank you, and good bye.

Brijendra Pratap Singh: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of NALCO, we conclude this earnings call. Thank you for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: Feb 2026

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■■■■■■/Dated:05.02.2026

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Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call held on 30.01.2026.

■■■
■■■■/Dear Sir,
Further to our letter dated 30.01.2026 and pursuant to Regulation 30 of SEBI
(LODR) Regulations, 2015, enclosed please find the transcripts of the Earnings
Conference Call held on 30.01.2026 for discussions on Company's business and outlook
post declaration of Unaudited Financial Results for 3rd Quarter and Nine months ended
31st December, 2025
Neither any Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI) was shared during the
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■■■■■■ /Thanking you.
■■■■■■/ Yours faithfully,
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For National Aluminium Co. Ltd.
(■■■ . ■■■. ■■■š) / (B.K. Sahu)
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Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
ACS: 9953
Encl.: As above

Page 1 of 21 National Aluminium Company Limited
Q3 FY '26 & 9M Earnings Conference Call
January 30, 2026
NALCO MANAGEMENT TEAM
Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh – Chairman-cum-Managing Director
Shri Pankaj Kumar Sharma – Director (Production)
Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak – Director (HR)
Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria – Director (Finance)
Shri Anil Kumar Singh – Director (Commercial)
Shri Bharat Kumar Sahu – Company Secretary
MODERATOR
Ms. Shweta Dikshit – Systematix Group

National Aluminium Company Limited
January 30, 2026
Page 2 of 21

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to the Earnings Call of National Aluminium

Company Limited, NALCO, post declaration of the financial results of quarter and 9 months ended December 2025, hosted by Systematix.

As a reminder, all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal an operator by pressing star then zero on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Shweta Dikshit from Systematix. Thank you, and over to you, ma'am.

Shweta Dikshit: Thank you. Good evening, everyone. On behalf of Systematix Group, we welcome you to the 3Q FY '26 and 9 months FY '26 Earnings Conference Call of National Aluminium Company Limited. I would like to thank the management for giving us the opportunity to host this call. I now hand over to Mr. Bharat Sahu, Company Secretary, NALCO, to discuss the company's financial and operational performance for the third quarter and 9 months FY '26. Over to you, sir.

Bharat Sahu: Thank you, ma'am. Namaskar. Good evening. Warm greetings from National Aluminium Company Limited, Navratna. CPSE under the Ministry of Mines. I take pleasure in introducing the NALCO team in today's post earnings call. The team is headed by Shri. Brijendra Pratap Singh, Chairman-cum-Managing Director; Shri P. K. Sharma, Director, Production; Dr. Tapas Kumar Pattanayak, Director, HR; Shri Abhay Kumar Behuria, Director, Finance and Shri A.K. Singh, our newly inducted Director, Commercial.

Today, NALCO registered a landmark results for the quarter and 9 months ended December 2025 after the Board took note of the results in the Board meeting held today. The presentation in this regard is already uploaded in the website and also in the stock exchanges, NSE and BSE. Now I will request our CMD sir to kindly highlight the results and the outlook of the company in the coming days. Over to you, sir.

Brijendra Singh: Good evening to all. Today, we have declared our results Q3 and up to Q3 results as far as our performance, physical and financial performance. Both we have recorded best ever physical performance in Q3 and also up to Q3 and also best ever financial performance up to Q3 and also physical performance. If you see the growth as compared to '24-'25, the growth which we have recorded up to Q3, that is 9 months, '24-'25 if you compare with year '25-'26, 9 months.

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 3 of 21

Income side, we have a growth of 13% and expenditure in spite of our increase in income by 13%, our expenditure has increased by only 6%. EBITDA margin has increased by around 20% and PBT has increased by 25%. That is a 9-month comparison. Volumes of production has increased by 20% in alumina and metal by 3.5% and sales of alumina has increased by 45% and metal by around 5%.

This is the first 9 months performance if you see. If you see quarter-to-quarter performance, our volume has increased by around 4% to 5% in terms of hydrate production, metal production and our metals -- our alumina sales and metal sales has also increased by around 20% and 5%. So there has been a strong both physical and financial performance and main reason of this physical and financial performance has been the increase in the volume of production. We have increased the volumes of production.

If we see the increase in the revenues, our revenues has increased by around Rs.2,000 crores, 9 months revenue as compared to previous 9 months last year. And out of that Rs.2,000 crores, the contribution of alumina is around Rs.1,600 crores and metal around Rs.410 crores. Price has a negative impact of around Rs.871 crores, where alu

mina prices

fell by from around \$562 to around \$385 this year average and there was a negative impact of Rs. 1,652 crores. But metal prices have increased, which has given us a positive impact of Rs.781 crores, that is increase from \$2,538 to \$2,867. So we have increased our revenues and our expenditure has not increased that much and that has increased by only Rs.500 crores. That is, this is the 9-month figure total.

And we have saved in power and fuel, the power, which we imported last year was on the lower side. The saving in the power and fuel was around Rs.142 crores. Employee cost has also gone down by around Rs.118 crores. So the 9 month performance has been very good.

And quarter-on-quarter, if we compare the quarter results, Q3-Q3, this year Q3 and last year Q3, if we compare the income has increased by around Rs. 200 crores and the expenditure has not increased that much, only around Rs. 60 crores, Rs. 70 crores expenditure increase has been there and the profitability has increased from Rs. 2,121 crores to Rs. 2,131 crores. That is the PAT. So the main contribution and the contributing factor has the increase in the volume of

production. In spite of reduction in the prices of alumina, our profitability, we were able to
National Aluminium Company Limited

maintain because of increase in volume and better efficiencies that is the improvement in techno-economic factors, that is caustic soda consumption, CP c oke consumption. Of course, some techno-economics were not very good, but these two major techno-economics have been there. So we are working on that. And further, we are working on increasing the volumes of production, maximizing our efficiencies, which is in our hands and operating the plant in a proper manner so as to maximize our profitability. Thank you.

Bharat Sahu: Ma'am, we may now invite questions from our esteemed participants.

Moderator: Thank you. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. Anyone who wishes to ask questions may press star and one on their touchtone telephone. If you wish to remove yourself from the question queue you may press star and two. Participants are requested to use answers while asking a question. Ladies and gentlemen, we will wait for a moment where the question to assemble. Thank you. The first question is from the line of Amit Lahoti from Emkay. Please go ahead.

Amit Lahoti: Thanks for the opportunity. Congratulations on a good set of numbers. My first question is on alumina contracts. Operators you line is echoing; can you please check. In Q3, how much alumina shipments were linked to LME and how much were spot sales? And what is the spot versus contract mix in Q4.

Brijendra Singh: Okay. That is the only question, some other question?

Amit Lahoti: So yes, so that was the first question.

Brijendra Singh: You want me to answer it?

Amit Lahoti: Yes, please.

Brijendra Singh: Q3, each month, we have done around 4 shipments, all the months. And we had 3 shipments in spot and 1 shipment in LME in Q3.

Amit Lahoti: Okay. And all were of same quantity?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, yes, all shipments are of 30,000 tons. On an average, we do 4 shipments per month. We have done almost on an average 4 shipment. And out of that, one was on term basis that was on basis of LME and all rest of the 3 were spot.

Amit Lahoti: And for Q4, is it going to be the same mix? 75-25?

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 5 of 21

Brijendra Singh: Almost same mix. One shipment we have for LME and the rest is for spot.

Amit Lahoti: Right. And as a follow-up to this, have we started signing long-term contracts for the new refinery?

Brijendra Singh: New refinery, we'll be starting the commissioning process in June and taking around two, three months to finally -- three, four months to stabilize it. We are expecting that around 3 lakh tons of alumina product

ion from there from this year onwards. So we are trying to have some long-term contract, one year or maybe two years. We'll be going in some interested parties are also there.

Middle East, some parties have approached us for long-term contract that is one year, two year, three years. We will be floating some tenders. If we get better offers, we'll be going for it. It only depends on what offer we are getting.

Amit Lahoti: Right. Got it. And my second question is on critical minerals. There were some news articles indicating that we are looking to extract critical minerals from alumina red mud that we end up producing. So what is the plan there? If you could indicate any sort of time lines for visibility of this project?

Brijendra Singh: As far as extraction of critical minerals from red mud is concerned, we are in the process of having a MoU with NML Jamshedpur, where they are in the process of setting up a pilot facilities for making the methodologies for extraction of rare earths from the critical minerals. Already, they will be taking around one and a half to two years to set up this whole technology.

Another is we have one party from Chennai in which we have done the MoU. They have set up their reactor in our mines, and they have taken some of the samples of red mud. They are into the process. Already, they are doing some experiments around that, but results have not come till now. They also will be extracting some critical minerals.

The third is, that is not from red mud, that is from Bayer's liquid. We are having one MoU with BARC, where they are setting up pilot plant that is extraction of gallium from the Bayer's liquid.

These are the 3 projects which we are taking. But as of now, on commercial scale, we don't have any results. From the pilot scale, it will take around one, one and a half years to set up and get some results for the commercial scale extraction.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Amit Lahoti: Right. Okay. Fine. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Aditya Welekar from Axis Securities. Please go ahead.

Aditya Welekar: Thank you for this opportunity. So my question is with respect to our alumina sales volume. So in the last call, we have said that for full year fiscal '26, we will achieve 1,300 KT. And so far in the 9 months, we are already at 1,100 KT. So are we going to raise this guidance of sales volume for alumina? In Q3, we have seen a very good jump in alumina sales.

Brijendra Singh: In Q3, the sales was better. And our target of around maybe 1,250,000 or 1,300,000 whatever we are targeting. But this month, January, it has affected. There is tension in Middle East, which is affecting our exports to Middle East. But this month, January, it was on slightly lower side. But February and March, we'll be trying to make up those losses that were done. But as per plan, maybe 1,250,000 or 1,300,000 we'll be able to reach.

Aditya Welekar: Okay. Understood. Understood. And the second question is with respect to the chemical, means alumina division profitability, means we have seen a drop in that. One part may be due to because of the fall in the alumina prices. But is there any, apart from the decline in alumina sales realization, is there any inflation from the cost side, especially with respect to caustic soda, which has led to the drop in the EBITDA per ton for the Chemicals division?

Brijendra Singh: As far as alumina sales are concerned and the margins from alumina is concerned, of course, there has been reduction in the sales prices from around \$580, it's gone down to around \$380 first 9 months if you compare. Caustic soda, we have improved on caustic soda consumption, specific consumption caustic soda, which last year, which was around 121 kg has come down to around 99 kg. There, we have got a saving. Of course, the prices have increased

from around Rs.39 to, I think, Rs.45, the impact is around Rs.82 crores negative. But overall impact is not there because we have -- there is a saving in Rs.129 crores efficiency. Because we have saved on the efficiency, we have improved our performance. There is a saving of around Rs.129 crores on caustic soda. That is the thing which we have negated the increase in the prices by reducing our consumption. But of course, the prices of alumina, which has gone down, that is only affecting us.

Aditya Welekar: Understood. That's it from I will get back in the queue. Thank you.

National Aluminium Company Limited

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Pinakin from H SBC.

Pinakin: Many, many congratulations for what is a record quarter, and it looks like the records will continue given the LME prices are. Sir, my first question is what would be the blended alumina realization for the company? If we just do the math of segment revenue divided by production volume, it comes to around Rs. 28,864. Would that broadly be correct?

Brijendra Singh: You are talking about realization?

Pinakin: Yes, sir.

Brijendra Singh: Alumina realization. Yes, whatever we will be getting, that will be somewhere around \$320 or \$310 average in Q4.

Pinakin: And at this point of time, sir, it looks like this should be the realization trend, which will continue in fourth quarter as well?

Brijendra Singh: Similar will be continuing in the fourth quarter. We are expecting not more than \$310 or \$320.

Pinakin: Understood. And sir, what is aluminium cost of production this quarter? And how did it change versus the September quarter?

Brijendra Singh: You're talking about aluminium or alumina?

Pinakin: Aluminium, sir.

Brijendra Singh: Aluminium. Our cost range Rs. 150,000 to Rs. 160,000. And in between that Rs. 10,000 range, somewhere it is Rs. 155,000, Rs. 156,000, somewhere it is Rs.153,000. And average cost is coming around within that range only.

Pinakin: Understood. And sir, what is the outlook for cost? Do you expect that to remain stable or move?

Brijendra Singh: Q4, our cost will increase slightly because our CT Pitch, our C P coke cost has gone up. Caustic soda costs whatever we have tendered and ordered in December, that costs have gone up. So Q4 cost will slightly go up, still to calculate. It will overall depend on the efficiencies and our specific consumption. But the prices have increased, around I think, Rs. 7,000, Rs.8,000 CP coke, I think Rs.7,000, Rs.8,000.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Though there is a negative impact on price because we are going to wear that burden. We are improving our techno-economic front also to take care of that additional cost, which will be coming in the fourth quarter through increase in price of input prices. So there will be not much impact on our total cost.

Pinakin: Understood. And sir, my last question is there is a meaningful decline in employee cost on a quarter-on-quarter basis. What drove it? And when would you need to start making provisions for the next series of wage hikes?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: There are two aspects for this cost reduction. If you compare with the CPLY of last year, corresponding period of last year, last year, around Rs.300 -- 300 numbers of employees have been superannuated. And the recruitment of this year is not commensurate with that return. So that is one of the advantage.

Second, we have made some accounting provision towards our PRP, which is not required now because we have calculated actual calculation and whatever excess provision we have made, we have withdrawn this quarter, this quarter 3.

That is also around Rs.50 crores that is impact. Okay. Another Rs.118 crores is total reduction of employee cost if you compare with the corresponding period of last

year,

Rs.50 crores on account of that accounting provision and another because of reduction in the manpower real cost, but that is superannuation of the manpower.

Pinakin: Got it. And sir, about the provisions that you would need to make for the next wage bill, when should we expect June '26 quarter or later or later?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: That is for ours, I think it will be from 1st January '27. Then we'll make it because this is the 26th. This year, we don't require because our pay revision due on 1st January 2027.

Pinakin: Got it. Thank you very much sir.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Pallav Agarwal from Antique Stock. Please go ahead.

Pallav Agarwal: Congratulations on the good results. Sir, first question was a clarification on the aluminium COP. So this figure of 152,000 to 160,000. So this is on an integrated basis, right, with captive alumina, just to clarify.

Brijendra Singh: Yes, this is on the captive alumina. Whatever alumina prices we are manufacturing cost.

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 9 of 21

Abhay Kumar Behuria: We are transferring the alumina to our smelter plant on cost.

Pallav Agarwal: On cost. Okay. And the second one was on how has been the trend of domestic premiums? I think we sell most of our aluminium in the domestic market. So how is the movement in physical premiums been in the third quarter?

Brijendra Singh: The premiums actually totally depends on the LME. Last year, our average LME was around \$2,500. But this year, average LME, we are getting more than \$2,800. So there has been \$300 around \$300 to \$340 increase in the LME is giving us a better premium.

But as far as the premium from ingot to wire rod is concerned, last year, we were getting better. Ingot to wire rod premium last year was around \$10,000, we were getting around 6,000 to 7,000 only. So overall, there is increase in LME. So that is giving us a better premium.

Pallav Agarwal: Sir, what is the right way to look at this? Is it like linked to the MJP or is it like a percentage of the LME or is it on a per tonne basis, what is the right way to look at the premium?

Brijendra Singh: I'd like to look it as on the basis of LME because our pricing, whatever we are doing is on the basis of LME. On the basis of whatever MJP is there, some kind of sometimes we have to give some discounts and all that depending on the MJP.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: We have a pricing policy where we take LME as a base and we add premium as per your version, we take sometimes MJP premium. Then there is some modalities fixed on price. All factors is being taken care of while we do price.

Our pricing mechanism every 3 days, if the LME prices crosses some limit, we do. So that is a transparent policy we have. We are adopting that.

Pallav Agarwal: Okay. And probably the import duty also of 7%?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: See that is a part of our policy, that policy guideline is there. We will follow by that, we'll go by that only.

Pallav Agarwal: Okay. Sure, sir. Also, sir, can we look at any more savings in power and fuel for the fourth quarter or captive coal now we have fully reached the 4 million tons of captive coal production?

Brijendra Singh: Production already we have targeted 4 million tons, which will be reaching. We are going

in the procurement of coal from e-auction and the linkage coal, there will be reduction. And we are looking after that, that up to Q3, the saving has been around maybe Rs.30 crores or something like that.

Q4 also some savings will be there because the effect is going down because the prices of linkage coal has also come down. And the difference at present, if you see the price difference between linkage coal and our captive coal is

around only Rs.200 to Rs.250 per ton.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: After withdrawal of that GST compensation sales, Rs.400 per ton, which is not being paid on the linkage coal. So our difference between the captive coal and FSA coal which is such an agreement...

Brijendra Singh: Is around Rs.300.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rajesh Bhandari from Nakoda Engineers. Mr. Rajesh kindly unmute your mic.

Rajesh Bhandari: Sir, congratulations for good numbers. Sir, you just now mentioned about the coal mining, so when we are having our own mines, when we are mining from our own mines, is that cheaper or taking from outside is cheaper?

Brijendra Singh: Our own captive mines, the landed cost at our power plant, the difference between that coal and the coal which we are taking from outside, is around Rs.200 to Rs.250 depending on the source.

Rajesh Bhandari: Which one is higher, sir? Which one is higher?

Brijendra Singh: The coal which we are taking from outside. Our captive coal is cheaper, around Rs.200.

Rajesh Bhandari: Then why can't we have our own mines, sir?

Brijendra Singh: We already having mines and the rated capacity of the mines is 4 million tons. So we are ramping the production of that mine up to 4 million tons this year. And we are in the process, maybe some more mines in the coming times when we are going for expansion...

Rajesh Bhandari: Yes, yes, yes, that's what I meant. Sir, you said about red mud, some critical minerals. And do we have any plan for new mining for the critical minerals, new mines?

Brijendra Singh: New mines for the critical mineral, whatever there is, that is one JV Company, KABIL is there, they have HCL and MECL, which is having 5 mines in Argentina they have got.

They have done non-invested exploration. Now invested exploration is going on. Maybe it will take 1.5 years to get the results of this exploration. And we'll come to know the amount of lithium that is a lithium mine. What level of commercial mining we'll be able to do.

Rajesh Bhandari: There we will have our partnership?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, yes. NALCO is around 40%. HCL and MECL is 30%.

Rajesh Bhandari: Sir, as you said, alumina prices had gone down. When aluminium prices are high, why should alumina price go down, sir?

Brijendra Singh: You see there is an excess of alumina in the market. In Indonesia, 2 refineries have come up and a few of them are closed down, like Mosul, one has closed down. Iceland, one has closed down smelting capacity has gone down and refining capacity has come up more so. There is an excess of alumina in the market. That's why there is a price reduction and the prices of alumina solely depend on demand supply.

Rajesh Bhandari: Yes, correct. And this is going to remain forever?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, I don't know forever, but this year, it's going to remain. If the smelting capacity is somewhere but of course, Thailand and Indonesia, the smelting capacity is supposed to come up maybe next year, it will stabilize. That may be some reduction in [inaudible] they are now presently having excess of alumina. Some things will be taken care of. But now as of now, this year, the visibility is not there, a similar kind of...

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Another main reason is in addition to CMD, sir. In Thailand, the capacity of smelting is around 60 million plus. So they are now capping their capacity 45 million. That is one of the reasons when they will increase production, it will automatically go up also.

Rajesh Bhandari: Why are you not increasing the capacity of your metal, sir?

Brijendra Singh: Already, we are in the process of it. We are already in the process of appointing one consultant for making DPR and our road map is maybe this year by maybe this year, June, July, August, we'll be finalizing the DPR. After that, 36 months

, we have made our road map. And maybe by end of December '30 or maybe early first half of 2031, we have to make and add another 0.5 million tonne smelting capacity. That is the road map, and we are going ahead with it very aggressively.
National Aluminium Company Limited
January 30, 2026
Page 12 of 21

Rajesh Bhandari: Sir, one last question. Sir, only one question. Finance cost, why it has gone up too high, sir?

Brijendra Singh: Which one?

Rajesh Bhandari: Finance cost.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: That is not the finance cost. Actually, that is the one thing we have made some settlement this quarter. There is a settlement, okay? The interest component of the settlement will be put under finance cost because it comes with adjustment only, okay?

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Manav from Yes Securities Limited.

Manav: First of all, congratulations on the results. And my first question is, if we take a look at Slide 9, where the company has mentioned the LME price trend. I just wanted to get an outlook because it's mentioned that LME prices are expected to average around \$2,670 for aluminium for this particular year. So what's the management's view on the aluminium pricing trend going ahead?

Brijendra Singh: You see, as of now, the LME is somewhere around \$3,200. We were expecting to remain somewhere around \$2,900, \$3,000, but it has increased. And the main reason which we are seeing is some reduction in supply from smelters closing down, capacities of -- China's capacity cap and all that. So there is, of course, demand supply issue. So we are expecting this year, maybe this quarter, it will be somewhere around \$3,000. It should remain \$3,000 LME. And next year also somewhere between \$2,900, \$3,000, \$2,800, \$2,900. Average \$2,900, we can expect that. But obviously, it will be more than \$2,600.

Manav: Got it. And second question is, sir, on the caustic soda, we have had savings of around about Rs.129 crores. Could you give what was the landed costing for caustic soda on a per ton basis? You mentioned 45,000, right?

Brijendra Singh: Landed cost of caustic soda. The 9 months average if you see '25, '26, it was around Rs.42,000, okay? For the next quarter, the cost will go up to Rs.55,000, fourth quarter of this year.

Moderator: The next question is from the line of Pratik Kothari from C R Kothari & Sons. As there is no response, we'll move ahead. The next question is from the line of Vikash Singh from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

National Aluminium Company Limited
January 30, 2026
Page 13 of 21

Vikash Singh: Good evening sir and Thank you for taking my question. Sir, my first question pertains to our alumina input to aluminium output ratio. Has it changed? Because if I just calculate 2 ton of alumina per ton of aluminium, so we have sold almost 80 KT, 85 KT higher than what would have been the residue left after the aluminium production. So, could you just give us some insight into it?

Brijendra Singh: You see our volumes of production of alumina has been on the higher side -- excess alumina. That's why we have increased our alumina export. Aluminium, whatever aluminium we are making around 2 tons of alumina is required per ton of aluminium. So as per requirement is sent to the smelter. So whatever exports we are doing is because of the excess in the production and the volume of the alumina.

Vikash Singh: Sir, there is still 2 tons of alumina per ton of aluminium right?

Brijendra Singh: Yes. Yes. 1.93 tons.

Vikash Singh: Noted, sir. Because there was some additional efficacy you have sold it. If you would have used this ratio, fine.

Brijendra Singh: Actually, what is happening is we have a storage capacity of around 75,000 tons in Vizag, around 45,000 tons in our refineries and around 1 lakh tons in our smelters. So the storage capacity, what storage we have, that keeps on changing. So that determine

s the overall

ratio. That is very important to see what was the storage capacity at the beginning of the year and what is the storage now, okay?

Vikash Singh: So can I assume that we have depleted our storage capacity to a larger extent because that's 50 KT to 80 KT additional, which would have come from there itself?

Brijendra Singh: No, no. That storage capacity almost whatever we had in the beginning of year, our stocks of alumina in the smelter of course, in the beginning of year, the stock was around

somewhere around 15 days. Now we are nearing around 10 to 12 days. 2, 3 days lesser stock in smelter is there. But as far as our Damanjodi, all the silos are full. Vizag also our stock is around 60,000; 55,000 that is the average we maintain in the Vizag. Only in our smelter around 2, 3 days stock means that will be a round maybe around 8,000 to 10,000 approximately.

Vikash Singh: Noted Sir. Sir, my second question pertains to basically just clarification on the statement which we have made that from the new alumina refinery, we said we are expecting 3 lakh National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 14 of 21

kind of the production next year. In our previous call, we were talking about roughly about 5 lakh?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, yes. Previously, we were talking...

Vikash Singh: Has anything changed in time line or it has been delayed something?

Brijendra Singh: We will be starting the commissioning. The total refinery capacity is around 10 lakhs. So since we will be starting the commissioning in June, but it takes 2, 3 months to complete the commissioning process, stabilize the production, maybe after June, September, October, we'll be having maybe going to 60% level of the total rated capacity and full capacity will be going to be around December.

So that's why we are taking a more realistic figure of 3 lakhs. We can have somewhere in between 3 lakh to 5 lakhs. But to be more realistic, it will be around maybe 3 lakhs.

Vikash Singh: And sir, lastly, on our overall capex for this year and next year and also what kind of employee cost addition we are expecting from next year due to wage revision? Any provision which we have started to make or we will make in 4Q?

Brijendra Singh: This year, we are not having any wage revision. Whatever wage revision will happen, that will happen '27 onwards. The employee cost will be almost same this year also. Slightly reduction will be there due to retirement. We will be having around 200 to 250 superannuation, and whatever superannuation is happening is in the senior category people. So of course, there will be again reduction of around maybe Rs.100 crores or maybe Rs.70 crores, Rs.80 crores of reduction in employee cost if you see 9 months or 12 months figure. There will be not any increase due to wage revision impact. That will come from next year onwards.

Vikash Singh: Yes. So on the next year, what kind of wage revision or just can tell me what is the percentage of last time you had given the hike? And is that hike has something to do with your profitability levels as well? If you have a higher profitability, so probably a higher wage hike you have to give or it is not impacted by the profitability?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Our wage revision is due from CPSE, it is from 1st January 2027 onwards, okay?

So next fiscal '26-'27, the impact will be in 3 months. We'll be making provision, some guidelines when the government of India will form a committee for finalization of this agreement. Then we'll make some other provision for 3 National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 15 of 21

months only. But that provision will not be enough, because our retirement and superannuation for '26-'27 will be to a great extent and the high wage people will be retired and the induction will be at the lower level. So overall, there will be no increase in the employee cost.

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Vikash Singh: Noted, sir. And sir, capex for this year and next year, if any?

Brijendra Singh: Capex this year will be around Rs. 1,700 crores. This financial year, what we are expecting is Rs. 1,700 crores. And next year, we are targeting around Rs. 1,800 crores to Rs. 2,000 crores next year. But '27 onwards, from next financial year onwards, it will increase.

Vikash Singh: Yes. On the new smelting facility?

Brijendra Singh: That is this year. We do the ordering and all that by next year, April, May. So '27-'28, that will increase.

Vikash Singh: Noted Sir and All the best for future.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Rajesh Majumdar from 360 One Capital. Please go ahead.

Rajesh Majumdar: Good evening Sir. Congratulations on a very good achievement. Sir, my first question was, if you look at the alumina sales and if you extrapolate the revenue, the average realization for the quarter comes out to be about \$380. And that you are saying for fourth quarter will become between \$310 to \$320. Is that correct?

Brijendra Singh: Fourth quarter will be average \$320.

Rajesh Majumdar: And this quarter is \$380?

Brijendra Singh: No, that was first 9 months was \$380. Q3, if you see, it was \$349. \$380 was for 9 months.
Rajesh Majumdar: Okay. \$350, okay. Right. And what was the average exchange rate for the quarter?
Brijendra Singh: Q3 exchange rate?

Rajesh Majumdar: Yes.

Brijendra Singh: Q3 exchange rate average 87 -- sorry, 9 months, it was 87, Q3 89.

Rajesh Majumdar: Sir, my second question is on the power and fuel. We've seen a reduction this quarter, which will normalize or which should be remain -- like what do you envisage the annual power and fuel cost now that we are getting the coal from our blocks. What should the annual cost of power and fuel which we will stabilize at?

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 16 of 21

Abhay Kumar Behuria: The coming quarter, I think the fourth quarter, the power and fuel cost will be less than the third quarter because third quarter, there is some problem. We have imported some power. So that has added to cost. But that will not happen in the next quarter because all our boiler is in good shape, and we'll be managing maximum power through our internal generation only.

Rajesh Majumdar: So third quarter itself there is a fall of Rs.70 crores. You're seeing a further fall on that?

Brijendra Singh: Pardon?

Rajesh Majumdar: Third quarter itself is a fall of about Rs.70 crores from 2Q. There is a further fall on that.

Brijendra Singh: Q2, there is a reduction and Rs.70 crores...

Management: Q2 to Q3 of current fiscal compared to last year?

Rajesh Majumdar: Q3 over Q2, last Q2.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Last Q2, because our -- that is one reason is there because the Q3, there is no impact of that sales, Rs.400 coal sales, GST compensation sales. It has been withdrawn. That benefit we have got in the third quarter because the withdrawal is July, September onwards, but the benefit in the third quarter, we have got both in the -- that is the linkage coal. That is one of the major reason.

Rajesh Majumdar: Right. And why is there a sharp jump in the operating expenses from Rs.600 crores to Rs.725 crores? And how should we look at this going forward?

Brijendra Singh: Operating expenses, if you see that is increase in coal, increase in the volumes. Volumes are increasing, there will be increase in the consumption of raw material and all that. That's because of the increase in volumes, operating expenditure has increased.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: But if you compare with the revenue, the jump is not in that also, because revenue has increased 13%, our cost expenditure is only 6% total. So operating costs, when you are increasing your volume, raw material consumption, other direct variable cost will automatically increase.

Brijendra Singh: You see last year, our alumina

production was 2,050,000. This year, our average alumina production rate is going to around 2,250,000. Maybe we'll be reaching 23 lakhs. We'll be doing around 2.5 lakhs more alumina this year. So of course, the raw material consumption

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 17 of 21

and all that increases. Even metal production also will be around 10,000 to 12,000 more as compared to last year.

Rajesh Majumdar: And what is the LME premium, my last question that you have got this year -- this quarter on the metal?

Brijendra Singh: This quarter, LME -- Q3 you're telling?

Rajesh Majumdar: Q3, yes.

Brijendra Singh: Q3 average LME was around 2,800. Premium you are telling?

Rajesh Majumdar: Yes, premium.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Premium we don't revise regularly because we have a pricing policy, we fix the premium once and that is inbuilt in our pricing policy itself. So we don't regularly revise that premium. There is a policy mechanism.

Brijendra Singh: How much is our current premium? I think it is \$50, around \$50. Last quarter, premium we have got is around \$50. That is being part of our pricing policy.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: That is part of pricing.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Sumangal from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Sumangal: Yes. Good evening. Thanks for the chance. The first question is on alumina division. You said one shipment is sold, prices are fixed on LME. So this is -- is this as a percentage of aluminium. LME we are selling alumina or this is the Australia alumina FOB price index we are talking about?

Brijendra Singh: Yes. Whatever LME along with one shipment which we are doing that is percentage of LME. Some shipments are around 12%, some is around 11.5% depend on whatever tender prices we are getting.

Sumangal: Understood. And for FY '27, also it is same ratio?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, it's almost same. Whatever long-term tender we are going, it is going on the lower side because LME is increasing. LME is going to be around 32, 33 it is gone maybe more than 3,000. So the percentage is going down.

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 18 of 21

Sumangal: No, for the LME linked volume, we are selling in the same proportion, one-fourth on LME linked?

Brijendra Singh: It's almost average shipment we try to do on term and rest shipment on spot on.

Sumangal: Understood. Sir, we have also started selling in the domestic market. So what is the realization difference between domestic and exports in alumina division?

Brijendra Singh: Realization, if you see domestic and export it is almost same, not more.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: No, there is a difference -- hardly any difference of 1,000, 2,000 because of addition of that export incentive that we added. So twice we added some incentive which do have got hardly this quantity exported. So the price difference is not much that is around Rs.2,000 -- Rs.1,500 per ton.

Sumangal: Understood. And sir, when we are targeting 1.3 million tons volume for this year, we sold 1.1 million so far. So fourth quarter would be just 200,000 tonnes or we can actually destock more?

Brijendra Singh: No, that will be around whatever we have planned, not more than that around maybe 12.5 to 13 totally depend on whatever requirements are there because the disturbance in the Middle East that has affected our exports to Middle East in the month of January. We could do only two shipments. We're trying to increase the shipment in February and March, make up that. It will totally depend on how the conditions are there in Middle East.

Sumangal: Understood. And sir, with respect to aluminium division, can we practically sell or produce more than 470,000 tons. Can we operate at more than 100% utilization?

Brijendra Singh: You see our rated capacity is 460,000 and we are going for 470,000 now. 472,000 in fact, this year, we are trying to reach 472,

000. One area where we are exploring is getting some scrap. If we get some good quality scrap because our hot metal production capacity is 470,000, but our casting capacity is more. We have got additional maybe 50,000, 100,000 tons of casting capacity.

So we can easily increase the cast metal production capacity if we get good quality scrap. We are trying to source the scrap, but now we are not able to get good quality scrap. That's why if we get quality maybe 10,000, 20,000 tons of scrap, we'll be able to increase our cast metal production capacity.

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 19 of 21

Sumangal: Understood. Sir, on the aluminium division, a few companies are hedging volumes on a forward basis. Are we doing anything of that sort or everything is open to spot prices?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Hedging, you are talking about hedging?

Sumangal: Yes. Forward sales.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: No. We have not adopted hedging mechanism now because we don't think our model of business, if you see alumina and metal both. So this hedging, we don't feel this is required now, but we don't have any commitment. Our balance sheet is so strong. We don't have any cash flow commitment. So if the situation comes up to '27, '28, when our capex plan will be in full swing and we have committed cash flow and we need to protect our EBITDA and margin, then we will think of this hedging. Till now, we have not gone through that periphery.

Sumangal: Understood. And sir, with respect to aluminium division, what is the dependence on grid for power requirement? What is the percentage and is it changing over the last few years?

Brijendra Singh: Very less. Power very less, whatever power we require around 800 megawatts that we are totally taking from our own captive source. Sometimes in case of some maybe less breakdowns, some breakdowns we depend on the grid. Almost 96% to 97% of our power grid [inaudible] quarter wise you can take.

Sumangal: How much, sorry, 10%?

Brijendra Singh: I think...no, not 10%. I think it must be less than 5%.

Pankaj Kumar Sharma: Actual, till date up to 9 months we have imported 90 million units.

Sumangal: Okay. And sir, with respect to carbon.

Pankaj Kumar Sharma: Whereas we have generated around 5,773 million units.

Sumangal: 100 million you said, okay. Sir, just one or two more questions . With respect to the carbon cost, CP coke, CT pitch, etcetera, what is the inflation we are seeing and when is it likely to hit?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: CP coke and CT pitch. CP coke price we are expecting that the fourth quarter it will be around Rs.2,000 more what we have in the last 9-month average, it is around Rs.52,000. It will be around Rs.54,000 in the next quarter that is the

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 20 of 21

increase. CP coke there is a huge increase Rs.12,000. But CT pitch, there is an increase of Rs.51,000 to Rs.53,000. CP coke, Rs.43,000 to Rs.54,000 we are expecting.

Sumangal: Okay. So roughly 20% is there and 10% here?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: More than 20% CP coke. Average price was Rs.42,764 and we are expecting in the new contract, it is around Rs.54,600. So there is a huge jump that is Rs.12,000.

Sumangal: And when is this getting reflected from fourth quarter?

Brijendra Singh: Yes, yes. Before it will be reflected.

Sumangal: Is this an annual contract? Or is it a quarterly or monthly?

Brijendra Singh: We do for 6 months. This contract is from January to June.

Sumangal: Got it. And sir, one last question on capex. You said around Rs.1,800 crores to Rs.2,000 crores this year. Is it possible to split how much we are spending on maintenance and how much on the refinery and then how much is left on refinery?

Abhay Kumar Behuria: You are talking about the next fiscal '26, '27.

Sumangal: So this year, you said around Rs.2,000 crores, right?

Brijendra Singh: This year is Rs.1,70

0 crores. '25, '26 around Rs.1,700 crores capex. I think Rs.600 crores to Rs.700 crores in MR that is additional modification and replacement project and the rest is bigger projects.

Sumangal: Rs.1,000 crores is growth and Rs.600 crores is MR?

Brijendra Singh: Within that range.

Sumangal: Okay. And sir, in this refinery, 1 million ton, how much will be left, which will be spent in FY'26, '27.

Abhay Kumar Behuria: Till date we have already spent Rs.5,000 crores. And I think next year, it will be around Rs.500 crores to Rs.600 crores.

Sumangal: Got it. And just if I may ask one more question, sir, we were doing some JV on caustic soda. Is that production? producing and are we getting any cost benefit or the profits are getting factored in...

National Aluminium Company Limited

January 30, 2026

Page 21 of 21

Abhay Kumar Behuria: No, we are not getting any benefit because we are getting a raw material security because we have an agreement with them, joint venture agreement, and we will be procuring Rs.1.5 lakhs from them at the price which will be discovered through tender. Now we are going to review that pricing policy and we will work.

Brijendra Singh: Actually, what is happening since we have assured quantity of 1,50,000 from there, if that quantity is not available, there will be a deficiency in the market and other suppliers will increase their prices. So this JV goes in long way in just curtailing the increase in the prices.

Sumangal: Understood. Got it and Thank you much and All the Best.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question. I now hand the conference over to the management for the closing comments.

Bharat Sahu: Thank you, Team Chorus. On behalf of NALCO, I thank all the esteemed participants who took out their valuable time and participated in this conference call. This shows your keen interest in the business activities of NALCO. Thank you, Team Chorus, for facilitating this post-earnings call for Q3 results of NALCO.

We are also grateful to Team Systematix for hosting the earnings call on quarter-on-quarter basis, and we solicit your cooperation in future also on a continued basis. Thank you all and we look forward to similar cooperation in the future as well. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of NALCO, we conclude this earnings call. Thank you for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2026

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